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THE EDITOR'S ADDRESS TO HIS READERS.

It is a custom so ancient, that I do not know when it had a beginning, for editors of newspapers, magazines, and other periodicals, large and small, to commence their labours with an apology for their intrusion, and an expression of sorrow for their deficiencies. With regard to such a venerable usage, I beg entirely to depart from it. I make no apology, and seek no undue favour. The grand leading principle by which I have been actuated, is to take advantage of the universal appetite for instruction which at present exists; to supply to that appetite food of the best kind, and in such form, and at such a price, as must suit the convenience of *every man in the British dominions*. Every Saturday, when the poorest labourer in the country draws his humble earnings, he shall have it in his power to purchase, with an insignificant portion of even that humble sum, a meal of healthful, useful, and agreeable mental instruction: nay, every schoolboy shall be able to purchase with his pocket-money, something permanently useful—something calculated to influence his fate through life—instead of the trash upon which the grown children of the present day were wont to expend it. Entertaining such a design as this—one calculated to be of such extensive service to mankind at large—those apologies, which Johnson has already condemned as being

"With merit needless, and without it vain"—

would be unutterably ridiculous. Whether I succeed in my wishes, a very brief space of time will satisfactorily determine. I throw myself on the good sense of my countrymen for support; all I seek is a fair field wherein to exercise my industry in their service; and should Heaven, in its mercy, grant me that share of health, which, by its inscrutable Providence, is now denied to so many around me, I do not despair of shewing such a specimen of the powers of the printing press as has hitherto been unexampled in the history of Literature. It may, perhaps, be considered an invidious remark, when I state as my honest conviction, that the people of Great Britain and Ireland have never yet been properly cared for, in the way of presenting knowledge, under its most cheering and captivating aspect, to their immediate observation. The scheme of diffusing knowledge has certainly more than once been attempted on respectable principles, by associations established under all the advantages of an enormous capital, as well as the influence of baronial title, and the endeavour has generally been attended with beneficial results Yet the great end has not been gained. The dearth of the publications, the harshness of official authority, and, above all, the folly of attaching the interests of political or ecclesiastical corporations to the course of instruction or reading, have, separately or conjunctly, circumscribed the limits of their operation; so that the world, on the whole, is but little the wiser with all the attempts which have in this manner been made. The strongholds of ignorance, though not unassailed, remain still to be carried Carefully eschewing the errors into which these highly praiseworthy associations have unfortunately fallen, I take a course altogether novel. Whatever may be my political principles—and I would not be in the least degree ashamed to own and defend them—neither these principles, nor any other, which would assuredly be destructive to my present views, shall ever mingle in my observations on the conventional arrangements of civil society. Nothing could afford me more unmitigated pleasure than to learn that CHAMBERS' EDINBURGH JOURNAL yielded equal edification and delight to the highest conservative party in the state, and to the boldest advocate of an universal democracy; or was read with as much avidity at the cheerless firesides of the Irish Roman Catholic peasantry, as at those of the more highly cultivated Presbyterian cottars of my native land. I have voluntarily, and unprompted, taken in my hands an engine endowed with the most tremendous possibilities of mischief I may have it now in my power to instil the most pernicious opinions on almost any subject, into the minds of three millions of human beings. But I see the straight path of moral responsibility before me, and shall, by the blessing of God, adhere to the line of rectitude and duty.

On account of certain existing laws affecting unstamped periodical publications, coming out at briefer intervals than twenty-seven days, this Journal, as a matter of course, will not be expected to contain any news of general events, or any political or parliamentary intelligence. All information of that character, when wanted, must be sought for in the ordinary sevenpenny stamped newspapers. The matter which I am allowed by law to introduce into my paper is, however, such as will, I trust, be of value to readers in all grades of society. As I happen to be able to spare room, I shall present—but not too hurriedly one upon another—original and select papers on Literary and Scientific subjects, including articles on the Formation and Arrangements of Society; a regular series of papers explanatory of the British Constitution; short Essays on Trade and Commerce; observations on Education in its different branches, with investigations into the properties of our Scholastic and Academic Institutions; sketches in Topography and Statistics, relative to Agriculture, Gardening, Planting, Sheepfarming, the making of Roads, Bridges, and Canals; the establishment of Ferries, the best means of Conveyance by Land and Water Increase of Population; the Uses of Machinery to simplify Human Labour, Manufactures, &c., all indicative of the vast improvements effected in the United Kingdom and America by the skill and perseverance of their inhabitants, and of what still remains to be accomplished. For the express use of the *poor man*, I shall open a continued flow of valuable and correct information for his guidance, should he be disposed or necessitated to emigrate,—neither, on the one hand, buoying him up with false hopes, nor, on the other, discouraging him him by gloomy anticipations For the benefit of poor old men and women who live in cottages among the hills, and who cannot sometimes come to church, because the roads are miry, or because the snow lies deep on the ground, I shall give excellent pithy passages from the works of the great British moralists, the names of which they hardly ever heard of.—For the recreation of those men who reflect deeply on the constitution of man, I shall from time to time present passages from the works of Newton and Bacon, the learned Encyclopædists, and other English luminaries of the present and preceding ages; so that their dignified knowledge may not remain any longer locked up in leather bindings, in presses, but be brought under the view of my readers, as they lie on their sofas in warm and comfortable rooms.—To Artizans I shall present instructive little paragraphs from the best writers on the various branches of their industry, and notices of new inventions in mechanics.—To the Naturalist I shall, in a similar manner, offer agreeable sketches illustrative of his interesting pursuits.—My short extracts, relative to Domestic and Cottage Economy, will, I doubt not, be received with approbation, from their general utility.—I shall give short analytical Reviews of Books, pointing out which ought preferably to be bought In this department I shall be altogether beyond the reach of being purchased by publishers, and shall only consult the benefit of the reader. I anxiously desire to remain on the most amicable terms with all my editorial friends; but I promise them they shall find me a very Davoust in literary warfare. Like that eminent general of division,—who thought nothing of marching a body of thirty thousand men a dozen leagues before breakfast, and capturing his enemy before the men had time to powder their hair, or put the necessary daily whitening on the belts of their cartridge-boxes,—I shall have a dozen fresh publications despatched and gutted before they have time to draw on their red morocco slippers.—To the ladies and gentlemen of "the old school" I shall relate innumerable amusing traditionary anecdotes, not one of which probably they ever heard before; and I shall tell them many curious particulars of old castles, and abbeys, and monks, and abbots, which, I dare say, will entertain them very agreeably in their easy chairs by the firesides With the ladies of the "new school," and all my fair young countrywomen in their teens, I hope to be on agreeable terms; and I have no doubt but that in the end I shall turn out a great favourite. I will now tell them what I in-

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tend to do for them: I shall make a point of giving them every week, if I can find room, a nice amusing tale, either original, or selected from the best modern authors—no ordinary trash about Italian castles, and daggers, and ghosts in the blue chamber, and similar nonsense, but something really good I will also inform them of a thousand useful little receipts and modes of housewifery, calculated to make them capital wives; and, perhaps, I may give them some new insight into the mysteries of sewing maps and footstools, and painting in water colours, and drawing with pencils or chalk, and of singing, and improving their taste in music.

I intend to do a great deal for boys. I have long been of opinion that these "harmless little men" are an exceedingly ill-used people. I was once a boy myself, and I remember how thankful I was when any body explained things to me I was many years the worst scholar in the whole school. I never learned any thing, because no one would give me a reason for there being certain peculiarities in the construction of Latin words. It was ten years after I left school before I saw through the trick of learning this intricate tongue, which I found altogether consisted of paying the most minute attention to the two last letters in the words; often did I think that mankind had entered into a conspiracy to torment boys with Latin. My distaste of this language drove me from the perusal of every kind of books, and I was near turning out an ignorant blockhead. My father, who was an exceedingly intelligent man, at length saw what I wanted: it was instruction under an alluring, comprehensible form. He tried me first with Gulliver,—not a trifling sixpenny Gulliver, which tells only about the little men the size of your finger, but one which tells also of the great tall men the height of a church steeple; and the men who were always apt to fall asleep, and had to be kept awake by flappers and the men who always began to build their house from the roof downwards; and of the horses who could speak and drink tea with each other, at one another's houses, and who had a sort of human beings to act as their servants. A relation of these wonderfully curious things opened up a new world to my awakened senses. Robinson Crusoe and the Pilgrim were soon similarly devoured, and I became a confirmed reader for ever after. This is what I intend to do for boys: I know the kind of things they would like to read about, and a perusal of which would lead them to more abstruse and valuable studies I shall give them lots of nice little stories, every one of which will be true, about travellers who went upon long and painful journeys in Asia and Africa, seeking for knowledge regarding the produce and peculiarities of unknown countries; and how they travelled among the most sublime ruins of empires, of which history scarcely retains a recollection; or across spacious burning deserts and wildernesses, tenanted only by naked savage men, wild beasts of a ferocious character, and snakes of a most frightful size. Or I will describe to them the region in its present degraded condition, in which those miraculous events took place which are recorded in the books of the Old and New Testament; and of who were instrumental in writing these exceedingly ancient productions; and how long they remained unknown to mankind in their present shape; and of how that unfortunate country is now inhabited by an indolent race of men, who wear cambric napkins on their heads instead of hats, and shawls like women; and how they have no chairs in their houses, but sit cross-legged on the floor like tailors, sipping coffee out of cups not much larger than a thimble, and smoking long pipes made out of the branches of cherry-trees. I have yet a great deal more things in store for boys. If they behave themselves, and learn their lessons at school, I shall tell them all about building rabbit-houses on scientific principles; and, perhaps (but their mothers and fathers are to hear nothing of it,) I shall give them an insight into the art of legerdemain. I have yet many nice things in my mind which I am going to tell boys I shall inform them about matters which their papa does not think of speaking to them about, because he is so busy; such as the meaning and uses of many institutions they will have to remembers of when they become big; and, among other things, of how the Scottish and English people, by their good sense and steadiness, have made little paper pictures pass for money in shops, and which are worth twenty round silver shillings with the king's head on them, or a whole capful of penny pieces Or, as I know that boys are fond of voyages at sea, and like to hear about sailors who were wrecked by storms on desert islands, I will give them a number of stories of that description, of which they have at present no idea I will also tell them of still more terrific adventures of seamen who have tried to sail their ships round the northern extremity of America, whose vessels were frozen in among large floating islands of ice, and who had a great difficulty in keeping themselves warm, as well as sustaining life, by eating seaweed, till the ices thawed, and their ships were permitted to return home. Finally, I shall give them accounts of men who were at one time poor little boys like themselves, but who, on paying a daily attention to their studies, and being always honest, and having a great desire to become eminent, and not be mere drudges all their days, gradually rose to be great statesmen, and generals, and members of learned professions, and distinguished authors, and to have fine houses and parks; and that at last they even came to be made kings or presidents of powerful nations.

WILLIAM CHAMBERS.

Edinburgh, 1st *February*, 1832.

ON THE FORMATION OF SCOTTISH SOCIETY.

The necessary labours, and the frivolous pursuits of man, leave him little leisure to inquire into the early state of that system of society of which he happens to be a member; while few are tempted, from their ordinary course of reading, to search into records pregnant with the most instructive details of the former condition of their native country, or illustrative of the rise and progress of that remarkable organization which has elevated Britain to the highest pitch of intellectual superiority For instance, there are not many who can give an explicit account of how the people in the northern part of our island came to speak the generous language which they now employ; how different orders of society originated; or how or why families began to use surnames. Without a knowledge of circumstances of this interesting nature, no Scotsman can properly understand a variety of those institutions which he sees established around him. He will only know that those things had a beginning some time, but when that *some time* was, he cannot rightly tell; and so he will settle down in an ignorant and apathetic contentment, exceedingly prejudicial to his character as a person of intelligence. Before coming to a discussion on these ingenious arrangements which rule the conduct of modern society, it would be best to explain, in a simple manner, some of those preliminary matters to which we allude; and by this procedure, we shall clear the way of several obstacles which interrupt our progress.

Prior to the tenth century, the greater part of Scotland was the residence of a number of different nations of men, who, though governed by distinct heads, owned the same Celtic original, tracing their descent from that great branch of mankind, which, in the most remote times, crossed the Hellespont and overspread the whole of Europe and its islands. Whether named Picts, Scots, or Celts, they all held communication in the Gaelic language, though varying in idiomatic expression At the period to which we refer, there were few towns in Scotland; almost none of those castles whose remains we now see in the country; none of those abbeys whose picturesque ruins ornament many a rural scene; no feudal usages; no lords, no peers, no trade, and little civilization. The kingdom lay a savage blank; kings thanes, priests, and people, spoke the Celtic tongue, and as, is supposed, wore the Highland garb. An astonishing revolution was, however, destined soon to take place, and to alter, by its influence, the whole system of human society.

The reign of Malcolm III. (or *Canmore*, from *cean more*, a great head,) which lasted from the year 1057 to 1093, has usually been ascribed as the era of the great revolution which I mention But it is well understood by antiquaries that the change began somewhat earlier, and lasted much later. Before the reign of Malcolm, the district called Lothian, which, in point of fact, included the shires of Linlithgow, Edinburgh, Haddington, Berwick, and part of Roxburgh, formed a large portion of the Saxon kingdom of Northumbria and was consequently settled by an Anglo-Saxon people, whose tongue and whose usages were thus early settled in the division of country south of the Forth. About the year 1020, this large and fair portion of Scotland was added to the Scottish crown by Malcolm II.; and when Malcolm Canmore came to the throne, he found himself the first ruler of the *whole* of Scotland. The settlement of Anglo-Saxons in Lothian prepared the way for a far wider extension of their race over the country; and the troubles in England prior to, and consequent on, the Norman Conquest, produced a continued influx of foreigners into North Britain The Conquest itself was, indeed, an immediate cause of a prodigious emigration of Anglo-Saxons into Scotland It will be remembered, that Edgar Æthling, the unfortunate prince who was subdued by William of Normandy, fled with his family on the seizure of his country, and bent his way towards the continental territories of his ancestors. Luckily for Scotland, the ship which bore the dejected prince across the seas, was driven by a tempest into the Firth of Forth, where he landed, and was hospitably received by Malcolm, who resided at the time in Dunfermline. The Scottish monarch was already favourably known to Edgar and his family. The result is well known: Margaret, his sister, became the wife of Malcolm, and proved an inestimable blessing, not only to her royal spouse, but to the whole Scottish nation. She taught him the Saxon tongue, the arts of reading and writing, and several other accomplishments. In consequence of her settlement in Scotland, the country became the ready place of refuge to a vast number of Anglo-Saxon chiefs and their followers. It is not easy to discover the extent of change which this influence of a more civilized people produced on the Scotch at this particular period; for, after the demise of Margaret, a large body of her followers are said to have been chased out of the country by the indignant natives. Malcolm, it seems, had the good sense to give an asylum to the fugitives from the south; he, indeed, aided insurrections in England for the purpose; and during his incursions into Northumberland and Durham, carried away so many of the young men and women, that they were seen many years afterwards not only in every village, but in every house within his dominions. It may, therefore, be concluded, that such a large introduction of foreigners must have had a permanent influence on society, and could not be eradicated at any future period.

In the reign of Malcolm Canmore, there were not many settlements of Anglo-Saxon barons who left lines of descendants in the higher ranks. The only two which have been noticed were the Earls of Dunbar and of Lennox, both of whose houses have merged in subsequent times. We have thus to look to a period after the decease of Malcolm for the events which concurred to change the customs of the country. On investigating the remote records of history, it is ascertained that the successive reigns of Edgar, Alexander I, and David I,—embracing a period from 1098 to 1153,—formed the interesting epoch in which the overthrow of Celtic usages took place; but that in that period, the benignant reign of David I. has the chief claim to be considered the most conducive to such an alteration.

David I., whose extreme piety has been well detailed in history, having been educated at the English court of Henry I., and married an English countess, was followed into North Britain by a thousand Anglo-Normans—that is, English gentlemen of Norman extraction, or perhaps of Anglo-Saxon and Norman lineage, to whom he distributed lands in all parts of the country, where they settled with their retainers, and built castles, churches, mills, and hamlets, for the convenience of themselves and their retainers The feudal chiefs, who were thus introduced by David, seem to have soon remodelled the order of things previously existing The barbarous civil code, if code it can be called, dropped in pieces; the greater proportion of those eminently judicious laws now governing the country were established; parliaments and sheriffdoms were organized; guilds and governments of burghs were instituted; the Celtic tongue very soon, and in a most surprising manner, was abandoned; the people in the towns which were built near the castles of the barons, gave it altogether up; speedily, it was only spoken by serfs or *villeyns*; not long after, they also gave it up, because they were compelled, of necessity, to learn the language of their masters; ultimately it was forced to linger only in the wilds of Galloway, Carrick, and the

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Highlands; it was even gradually banished from thence, and in our own times, the only portion of the country which retains it, is the last-mentioned district, and the Western or Hebridean Isles. About the same epoch, there was also an infusion of a Scandinavian Gothic race in Caithness and the northern islands, who helped to destroy the Celtic tongue, and to extirpate its usages Thus, in nearly all directions, the naturalized Scotch, the real owners or tillers of the land, the descendants of the original Irish and Scottish tribes, or of the Romanized Britons, sunk, without striking a blow, before the powerful and intelligent domination of Germans, Normans, or Goths, and have left behind them in the Lowlands no farther traces of their presence than those conferred by the names of places, which are, almost without exception, of a Gaelic original, or by physical memorials of their places of devotion and sepulture.* The most remarkable part of this singular overthrow was the circumstance of those Germans and Normans settling even in the heart of the Highlands, which, it is pretended, were *never* conquered, and these becoming the heads or chiefs of clans, have ever since been reverenced as the descendants of the most ancient aborigines. We shall soon have occasion to notice some of those foreign chieftains, whom the Highlanders have, in this manner, had imposed upon them.

Having now shewn when and how this country lost the impress of its Celtic original, it will be a matter of agreeable recreation to go over a list of patrician and respectable Scottish families, who, in the way we have described, settled in the country. We consider it quite unnecessary, in a publication of this kind, to crowd the pages with authorities, but for the authenticity of the details, we may at once pledge ourselves. The first family which we may notice, was that of the *Morvilles*, who came from Burg in Cumberland, and acquired extensive possessions from David I. in Lauderdale, the Lothians, and Ayrshire Hugh Morville, the first of his race in this country, became Constable of Scotland, an office which descended hereditarily through a long succession of illustrious heirs, both male and female. By Beatrice de Bello Campo, his wife, he acquired still greater possessions, and left a son to inherit his honours, as well as that of principal minister of William the Lion This distinguished man built the Abbey of Dryburgh, and a great many churches. The Morvilles are frequently mentioned in Scottish history, and at one time they had extensive powers. They surrounded themselves with vassals, a number of whom were from England; and from the chief of these foreign servants there sprung not a few of our most respectable landed proprietors, especially in Cunningham, Haddingtonshire, and Tweedale. In the latter, one of these gentlemen named *Edulf*, received lands near Peebles, in which arose a village, taking from him the name of *Eddleston*. The family at length sunk, or lost its name, in Scotland, by the introduction of three female heirs, one of whom married De Quincy, Earl of Winchester; the second a son of the Earl of Albemarle; and the third, John Baliol, the lord of Bernard Castle, in Yorkshire, from whom sprung John Baliol, sometime King of Scots, and a number of distinguished families in Galloway, where the descendants settled, and their families may still be found.—The *Riddels* came at the same time into Scotland, and there was not for many centuries a more respectable family. The first of the race was Gervase Riddel, who came from Ridal, in Yorkshire, and, under David, became one of the earliest sheriffs of Roxburghshire. From this district the family spread into Mid-Lothian, gave a name to a place now or lately called Cranstoun Ridel, near Dalkeith, and originated a great number of families of the name of Riddel in other parts of Scotland. The first of these Riddels also brought Anglo-Saxons with him as vassals, who contributed to swell the population of the country.—The *Corbets* were coeval with the Riddels, and were equally distinguished for the respectability of their rank and character. The first of the name was Robert Corbet, who came out of Shropshire, which was the original country of his race. He settled in Teviotdale, and seems to have been an opulent and liberal man. The family became conspicuous in the reign of William the Lion, and with their vassals helped considerably to Anglicise the country. Several of the name found their way into the north, and settled in Moray, where, perhaps, their descendants still remain The main line of the family became extinct in the thirteenth century. Of the Riddels and Corbets, we shall have something remarkable to mention a little farther on. —The highly honourable and respectable family of the *Lindsays* were among the followers of David. Two brothers of the name of Walter de Lindsay and William de Lindsay, came out of Essex, from a place called Lindsay, and attaching themselves to Earl David, before he ascended the throne, obtained from him, when he became king, extensive possessions in the Upper Ward of Lanarkshire, and Mid and East Lothian One of their descendants, entitled David de Lindsay, settled in Fife, where he held lands under Ermengarde, the Queen of William the Lion, and originated a family of Lindsays, which has, we believe, ever since stood among the chief freeholders in the county. The Lindsays of Queen Mary's reign were descended from a descendant of one of the former-mentioned Lindsays, who obtained lands in Berwickshire In modern times, we find families of the name of Lindsay over the whole of Scotland.—Perhaps it is not generally known that the distinguished Northumbrian house of *Percy* sent a branch into this northern kingdom Alan de Percy, like the Lindsays, attached himself to Earl David, and adhered to this beneficent prince when he became king With the alacrity and spirit of his race he accompanied David to the celebrated battle of the Standard in the year 1138. In return for his valuable service he received the manors Oxenham and Heton, in Tiviotdale. The line of family which Alan de Percy re established, became munificent endowers of Melrose Abbey; but after sustaining an honourable name for three generations, the family became extinct for lack of heirs. The name of Percy is not common in Scotland, and any which possess it must be descended from the immigrant of modern times.—The *Somervilles* fall the next to be mentioned; but we must stop for the present.

* How the English language now used in the Lowlands of Scotland comes to have an infusion of what are called *Scottish* words, will be explained in a subsequent article.

EMIGRATION

It has been mentioned in our prospectus, that the furnishing of valuable and correct information on the subject of Emigration from Britain shall, if possible, be a prominent object in the design of the present publication. The reason for this may be soon stated. The works of a respectable character, which profess to enlighten us on so momentous a topic, are generally so expensive, or otherwise so difficult to be obtained, that they seldom come within the reach of the humbler classes, who, it is evident, are those to whom information can only be of practical benefit. Under this impression, it becomes our willing office to present, as far as in our power, a variety of details on a point so important to the interests of a large mass of our readers. In looking about for some branch on which to begin with, we do not see any so likely to yield satisfaction as that relative to emigration to Canada and the United States of America; and of these countries we do not perceive any account which contains so much good, sound information, especially of a recent date, as an article "On the Agricultural Condition of Canada and part of the United States," drawn up by Adam Fergusson of Woodhill, just published, among other papers, under the auspices of the Highland Society The directors of this beneficial institution having been apprised by Mr. Fergusson of his intention to visit these places, it appeared to them a favourable opportunity of obtaining such information as might prove beneficial to rural economy, and the useful arts at home. The result has proved the correctness of those views. Mr. Fergusson visited America in the course of last year, 1831, and has now presented a statement which cannot be too highly prized. He gives us an outline of his excursion through the provinces of Lower and Upper Canada, and his visit to the States, the author everywhere giving a distinct view of the state and appearance of the country, the nature of soils, the crops which the lands produce, the price and rent of farms, and the market value of all kinds of stock. The author never *palavers* on any subject, but comes at once to the point; and that is what gives his paper its greatest value. No sort of abridgment is thus necessary in offering our readers a specimen of the production, and so we hurry to let the traveller speak for himself.

"To those ignorant of the geographical position, there is something in the term *Lower*, strongly indicative of a superiority in climate, which is by no means borne out by actual circumstances. Winter, in the Lower Province, wears a more severe and protracted form, than it does on the great table-land above. Many decisive facts in confirmation of this might be adduced. I shall only mention that wheat cannot here withstand the severity of winter, requiring to be sown in spring, and occasioning thereby both loss and inconvenience to the farmer in wet and late seasons; while quails, or Virginian partridges, it may be observed, which abound in the Upper, are totally unknown in the Lower Province.

"The soil is generally a fertile clay, which has hardly been yet brought, in any instance, to the test of what it may produce. It is generally occupied in small possessions, which continue, with the exception of some large seignories and church-lands, to fritter more and more away, from the absence of a check in the law of primogeniture, and a want of enterprise in the people, which might lead them to counteract this effect, by entering on new land. The population is chiefly French, and the religion Roman Catholic. The *habitans* are industrious, frugal, and contented; but their condition, to say the least, is almost stationary, and the habits or practices of their fathers are far too scrupulously revered.

"I had an opportunity of seeing and conversing with several British emigrants, who either occupy or possess farms in Lower Canada, and the uniform conclusion, to which all of them came, was an advice to look at the Upper Province before I formed an opinion upon the eligibility of a settlement I am quite aware that several of these individuals are prospering, in a measure which might possibly be curtailed, if too many farmers of a like stamp should become located beside them, but I am equally satisfied that no such jealousy influenced the advice I received, and that the established conviction of all who are experimentally acquainted with Canada, is in favour of the Upper Province, as a settlement for British agriculturists. Those emigrants who have obtained land near Quebec or Montreal, and who are industrious and active, profit, of course, very handsomely by the vicinity of these cities.

"Dairy produce brings in excellent returns, and everything finds a market; and although mere locality cannot avail so much as formerly, when steam navigation was unknown, still great advantages remain to the occupier of land near large towns. It is to be remarked too, that the greater supply of farm produce, occasioned by the introduction of steam-boats, has materially increased the consumption, and has thereby compensated to the farmer the fall in price, which necessarily followed.—Fresh butter, which sold in 1817, for 1*s*. 6*d*. per pound in Montreal, may now be had for 6*d*. In summer it is a perishable article, and must be sold when it comes to market. But hay, straw, potatoes, &c., and the very soil itself, are becoming, in the vicinity of Montreal, what an Angus farmer termed to me, 'mischievously dear;' and those who are in possession of farms in that vicinity will reap an abundant harvest.—My Angus friend, who seemed to be in the enjoyment of very easy circumstances, affords a proof, among hundreds, of what an industrious and steady man may do for himself in Canada. He came out in 1817, was wrecked in the Gulf of St. Lawrence, suffered many hardships, and finally landed at Montreal, devoid of every resource, save his own hands and good spirits. He soon found employment, and in due time took a lease of a farm, which he finds to succeed extremely well His wheat and potatoes, he says, are excellent; oats, inferior. He cultivates green crops, taking mangel wurzel instead of turnips, which suffer from the fly. He uses horses in preference to oxen; he has iron ploughs, and follows what he called a sort of rotation,—1st, Wheat; 2d, Green crop; 3d, Clover; 4th, Timothy for hay; and 5th, Pasture. Several farms are at this time to let in this quarter. The rent expected is 10*s*. or 12*s*. per acre.

"The Canadian farmers pursue the old Scottish practice of infield and outfield, taking crop after crop of grain from their fields, until nothing but weeds remain, and looking to Nature for that renovation which their own industry ought to have effected.

"It may appear almost incredible, but I was assured of the fact, that it was by no means unusual, as winter occupation among the *habitans*, to drive out dung from their farm-yards, and deposit it upon the glassy surface of the St. Lawrence, there to await the breaking up in spring, as a riddance from what they consider a worthless incumbrance.

"On tracing a route upwards from Montreal, the eye of an emigrant is speedily arrested by the junction of the Uttawas, or Grand River, falling into the St. Lawrence. I did not visit the settlements of this district, and do not therefore speak of them from personal observation; but they are well known to be valuable, extensive, and increasing. The Uttawas has, of late years, attracted the notice of Government, as a safe route for troops and stores to the Upper Province, in the event of war with the United States. In surveying its banks, and applying its course to this purpose, extensive tracts of fine land have been located, and several very promising settlements have been established. Of these, I may notice Perth, Richmond, and Lanark, the two former chiefly composed of retired officers and reduced soldiers; the latter, of families from the manufacturing districts in the west of Scotland, who came out in 1820, and all, I believe, as communities, doing well. All of these were assisted and fostered by Government. A military road communicates between Uttawas and Kingston, upon Lake Ontario, a distance of 240 miles. The Rideau Canal passes through a part of the country between this line of road and the St. Lawrence.

"The soil of this part of Canada is good; but the country is flat, the lakes shallow, and the streams frequently sluggish, which must be necessarily accompanied, for a time, with fever and ague to a greater extent than more airy and better watered situations present. There can be no doubt, however, that the settlements already formed, and to be formed in this quarter, will prosper. Government has done much for them by public works, which can scarce fail to benefit the country, whether they do or do not effect the objects for which they were planned; and the steam communication upon the Uttawas with Montreal is already in operation.

"Returning to the St. Lawrence, we enter the Upper Province, the Uttawas here forming the boundary line. As we ascend the river, we find numerous settlers, and thousands of acres well adapted for the farmer. One of the first settlements we meet with is the Glengarry district, an extensive tract of good land, enjoying the advantages of water carriage. The language, the customs, the native courage of their Celtic sires, still distinguish the clan, though at the same time, we are afraid, accompanied by some of those less profitable traits which stamp the Highlander as more at home in wielding the claymore, or extracting mountain dew, than in guiding the ploughshare to slow but certain results. The farms are but indifferently improved, considering the advantages they have enjoyed; and much valuable time is expended in the depths of the forest, in a demi-savage life, cutting and preparing timber for the lumber merchant, which, if steadily devoted to the cultivation of the land, would certainly be attended with infinitely greater benefit, both in a physical and moral point of view.

"Very conflicting opinions exist in Canada regarding the lumber-trade, and the subject was frequently discussed at this period, from the late proposal of ministers to lower

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the duties upon Baltic timber. It is certain that a large circulation is occasioned by the trade, perhaps a million sterling, in one way or another, and that it employs, during winter, many who may gain perhaps 20*l.* for their winter labour when nothing else could be done.

"To go minutely into the statistics of even the banks of the river, would far exceed the limits to which I must necessarily restrict myself Suffice it to say, that a constant succession of eligible situations present themselves for estates and farms. I was much pleased with the Matilda district, and consider it capable of great improvement. The soil is a fine mellow sandy loam, sometimes perhaps rather light, but admirably adapted for turnip husbandry and fine-woolled sheep, with numerous beautiful situations for a residence, the noble St. Lawrence ever forming a prominent feature, its surface varied by lovely wooded islands, similar to those we so justly admire on many of our British lakes. In approaching Kingston, or the east end of Lake Ontario, the river Guananoque falls into the St. Lawrence, and, at its mouth, is the establishment of Messrs. M'Donell, two brothers who came about eight years ago to the colony, and who, by steady enterprise, without original capital, have realized considerable wealth, while, along with it, they have secured the respect and esteem of all who know them. They have here, what is called in America, a valuable water privilege or fall, and have erected flour and saw-mills to a large extent. Last season they sent down to Montreal, 24,000 barrels of flour; and a friend of mine who was their agent, informed me that one of the brothers having resolved upon becoming their own agent in Montreal, it would be a loss of some hundreds a-year to his house in commission. They have a very clever cooperage worked by water, similar to the steam cooperage at Glasgow, and the articles turned out are uncommonly reasonable, substantial, and neat. I regretted much not having it in my power to form an acquaintance with these spirited colonists, more especially as they farm likewise to a large extent. The farm at Guananoque extends to 1200 acres, and the mansion-house and barns are commodious and handsome.

"Having received very encouraging accounts at Kingston, of the country along the Bay of Quinty, a deep inlet of Lake Ontario, formed by a peninsula called Prince Edward's Island, I made an excursion into that district. The scenery was pleasing, in many places very fine; and settlements are forming on every hand. The soil is partly clay, partly loam and sand, sufficiently rich to yield fifteen crops of good wheat, with impunity, in a period of twenty years. Granite, limestone, and schistus, or clay-slate, are successively met with. Wherever a stream or creek of any importance falls into the lake, there we find a mill-seat and a village growing up, the embryo, in many cases, of considerable towns.

"To the patriot or philanthropist, it is highly gratifying to remark, how the wants of the farmer and the interests of the trader or mechanic co-operate in the rapid progress of general improvement and civilization. Holywell, Sophiaburgh, and Belville are all thriving villages of this description; and many individuals are to be met with in each, who, from the humble situation of merchants' clerks, &c. are rapidly acquiring independence. The last is the county town of Hastings, which has already three churches, a court-house, and projected jail; a valuable mill-power, and fine situation for houses; the high road from York to Kingston passes through it, and, altogether, it seems destined to become a place of some note. I was really astonished at the frequent calls which the steam-boat made for produce, and, ere we reached Kingston, our deck was absolutely heaped with flour barrels."—*Agricultural Journal.*

—*To be continued.*

LADY JEAN.

The Yerl o' Wigton had three daughters,
Oh, braw wallie! they were bonnie!
The youngest o' them, and the bonniest too,
Has fallen in love wi' Richie Storie.

Old Ballad.

The Earl of Wigton, whose name figures in Scottish annals of the reign of Charles II., had three daughters, named Lady Frances, Lady Grizel, and Lady Jean—the last being by several years the youngest, and by many degrees the most beautiful. All the three usually resided with their mother at the chief seat of the family, Cumbernauld House, in Stirlingshire; but the two eldest were occasionally permitted to attend their father at Edinburgh, in order that they might have some chance of obtaining lovers at the court held there by the Duke of Lauderdale, while Lady Jean was kept constantly at home, and debarred from the society of the capital, lest her superior beauty might interfere with, and foil, the attractions of her sisters, who, according to the notion of that age, had a sort of *right of primogeniture* in matrimony, as well as in what was called *heirship*.

It may be easily imagined that while the two marriageable ladies were enjoying all the delights of a third flat in one of the *closes* of the Canongate, spending their days in seeing beaux, and their nights in dreaming of them, Lady Jean led no pleasant life amidst the remote and solitary splendours of Cumbernauld, where her chief employment was the disagreeable one of attending her mother, a very infirm and querulous old dame, much given (it was said) to strong waters. At the period when our tale opens, Lady Jean's charms, though never seen in the capital, had begun to make some noise there; and the curiosity excited respecting them amongst the juvenile party of the vice-regal court, had induced Lord Wigton to confine her ladyship even more strictly than heretofore, lest perchance, some gallant might make a pilgrimage to his country-seat in order to behold her, and, from less to more, induce her to quit her retirement, in such a way as would effectually discomfit his schemes for the pre-advancement of his elder daughters He had been at pains to send an express to Cumbernauld, ordering Lady Jean to be confined to the precincts of the house and the *terrace-garden*, and to be closely attended in all her movements by a trusty domestic The consequence was, that the young lady complained most piteously to her deaf old lady-mother of the tedium and listlessness of her life, and wished with all her heart that she were as ugly, old, and happy as her sisters.

Lord Wigton was not insensible to the cruelty of his policy, however well he might be convinced of its advantage and necessity; he loved his youngest daughter more than the rest; and it was only in obedience to what he conceived to be the commands of duty, that he subjected her to this restraint. His lordship, therefore, felt anxious to alleviate in some measure the *désagrémens* of her solitary confinement; and knowing her to be fond of music, he had sent to her by the last messenger, a theorbo lute, with which he thought she would be able to amuse herself in a way very much to her mind,—not considering that, as she could not play upon the instrument, it would be little better to her than an unmeaning toy. By the return of his messenger, he received a letter from Lady Jean, thanking him for the theorbo, but making him aware of his oversight, and begging him to send some person who could teach her to play.

The Earl, whose acquirements in the philosophy of politics had never been questioned, felt ashamed of having committed such a solecism in so trivial a matter; and, like all men anxious to repair or conceal an error in judgment, immediately ran into another of ten times greater consequence and magnitude;—he gratified his daughter in her wish.

The gentry of Scotland were at that time in the custom of occasionally employing a species of servants, whose accomplishments and duties would now appear of a very anomalous character, though at that time naturally arising from the peculiar situation of this country, in respect to its southern neighbour. They were, in general, humble men who had travelled a good deal, and acquired many foreign accomplishments; who, returning to their native country after an absence of a few years, usually entered into the service of the higher class of families, partly as ordinary livery men, and partly with the purpose of instructing the youth of both sexes, as they grew up and required such exercises, in dancing, music, writing, &c., besides a vast variety of other arts, comprehended in the general phrase of *breeding*. Though these men received much higher wages, and were a thousand times more unmanageable than common serving men, they served a good purpose in those days, when young people had scarcely any other opportunities of acquiring the ornamental branches of education, except by going abroad. It so happened, that not many days after Lord Wigton received his daughter's letter, he was applied to for employment by one of these useful personages, a tall and handsome youth, apparently five-and-twenty, with dark Italian-looking features, a slight moustache, and as much foreign peculiarity in his dress, as indicated that he was just returned from his travels. After putting a few questions, his Lordship discovered that the youth was possessed of many agreeable accomplishments; was, in particular, perfectly well qualified to teach the theorbo, and had no objection to entering the service of a young lady of quality—only, with the proviso that he was to be spared the disgrace of a livery. Lord Wigton then made no scruple in engaging him for a certain period; and next day saw the youth on the way to Cumbernauld, with a letter from his Lordship to Lady Jean, setting forth all his good qualities, and containing among other endearing expressions, a hope that she would both benefit by his instructions, and be in the meantime content on their account with her present residence.

Any occurrence at Cumbernauld, of higher import than the breaking of a needle in embroidering, or the miscarriage of a brewing of currant wine, would have been quite an incident in the eyes of Lady Jean; and even to have given alms at the castle-gate to an extraordinary beggar, or to see so much as a stranger in the candle, might have supplied her with amusement infinite, and speculation boundless What then must have been her delight, when the goodly and youthful figure of Richard Storie alighted one dull summer afternoon at the gate, and when the credentials he presented disclosed to her the agreeable purpose of his mission! Her joy knew no bounds; nor did she know in what terms to welcome the stranger: she ran from one end of the house to the other, up stairs and down stairs, in search of she knew not what; and finally, in her transports, she shook her mother out of a drunken slumber, which the old lady was enjoying as usual in her large chair in the parlour.

Master Richard, as he was commonly designated, soon found himself comfortably established in the good graces of the whole household of Cumbernauld, and not less so in the particular favour of his young mistress Even the sour old lady of the large chair was pleased with his handsome appearance, and was occasionally seen to give a preternatural nod and smile at some of his musical exhibitions, as much as to say she knew when he performed well, and was willing to encourage humble merit. As for Lady Jean, whose disposition was equally lively and generous, she could not express in sufficiently warm terms, her admiration of his performances, or the delight she experienced from them. Nor was she ever content without having Master Richard in her presence, either to play himself, or to teach her the enchanting art. She was a most apt scholar,—so apt, that in a few days she was able to accompany him with the theorbo and voice, while he played upon an ancient harpsichord belonging to the old lady, which he had rescued from a lumber room, and been at some pains to repair. The exclusive preference thus given to music, for the time, threw his other accomplishments into the shade, while it, moreover, occasioned his more constant presence in the apartments of the ladies than he would have been otherwise entitled to. The consequence was, that in a short time he almost ceased to be looked upon as a servant, and began gradually to assume the more interesting character of a friend and equal.

It was Lady Jean's practice to take a walk prescribed by her father, every day in the garden, on which occasions the Countess conceived herself as acting up to the letter of her husband's commands when she ordered Master Richard to attend his pupil. This arrangement was exceedingly agreeable to Lady Jean, as they sometimes took out the theorbo and added music to the other pleasures of the walk. Another out-of-doors amusement, in which music formed a chief part, was suggested to them by the appropriate frontispiece of a book of instruction for the theorbo which Master Richard had brought with him from Edinburgh This engraving represented a beautiful young shepherdess, dressed in the fashionable costume of that period,—a stupendous tower of hair hung round with diamonds, and a voluminous silk gown with a jewel-adorned stomacher, a theorbo in her arms and a crook by her side,—sitting on a flowery bank under a tree, with sheep planted at regular distances around her. At a little distance appeared a shepherd with dressed hair, long-skirted coat, and silk stockings, who seemed to survey his mistress with a languishing air of admiration, that appeared singularly ridiculous as contrasted with the coquettish and contemptuous aspect of the lady. The plate referred to a particular song in a book, entitled "A Dialogue betwixt Strephon and Lydia, or the proud Shepherdess's Courtship," the music of which was exceedingly beautiful, while the verses were the tamest and most affected trash imaginable. It occurred to Lady Jean's lively fancy, that if she and her teacher were to personify the shepherdess and shepherd, and thus, as it were, to transform the song to a sort of opera, making the terrace-garden the scene, not a little amusement might be added to the pleasure she experienced from the mere music alone. This fancy was easily reduced to execution; for, by seating herself under a tree, in her ordinary dress, with the horticultural implement called a rake by her side, she looked the very Lydia of the copper-plate; while Richard standing at his customary respectful distance, with his handsome person, and somewhat foreign apparel, was a sufficiently good representation of Strephon. After arranging themselves thus, Master Richard opened the drama by addressing Lady Jean in the first verse of the song which contained, besides some description of sunrise, a comparison between the beauties of nature at that delightful period, and the charms of Lydia, the superiority being of course awarded to the latter. Lady Jean, with the help of the theorbo, replied to this in a very disdainful style, affecting to hold the compliments of lovers very cheap, and asseverating that she had no regard for any being on earth besides her father and mother, and no care but for these dear innocent sheep, (here she looked kindly aside upon a neighbouring bed of cabbages,) which they had entrusted to her charge. Other verses of similar nonsense succeeded, during which the representative of the fair Lydia could not help feeling rather more emotion at hearing the ardent addresses of Strephon than was strictly consistent with her part At the last it was her duty to rise and walk softly away from her swain, declaring herself utterly insensible to both his praises and his passion, and her resolution never again to see o.

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speak to him. This she did in admirable style, though, perhaps, rather with the dignified gait and sweeping majesty of tragedy-queen, than with any thing like the pettish or sullen strut of a disdainful rustic; meanwhile Strephon was supposed to be left inconsolable Her ladyship continued to support her assumed character for a few yards, till a turn of the walk concealed her from Master Richard; when, resuming her natural manner, she turned back, with sparkling eyes, in order to ask his opinion of her performances; and it was with some confusion, and no little surprise, that on bursting again into his sight, she discovered that Richard had not yet thrown off his character He was standing still, as she had left him, fixed immovably upon the spot, in an attitude expressive of sorrow for her departure, and bending forwards as if imploring her return. It was the expression of his face that astonished her most; for it was not at all an expression appropriate to either his own character or to that which he had assumed. It was an expression of earnest and impassioned admiration; his whole soul seemed thrown into his face, which was directed towards her, or rather the place where she had disappeared; and his eyes were projected in the same direction, with such a look as that perhaps of an enraptured saint of old at the moment when a divinity parted from his presence. This lasted, however, but for a moment; for scarcely had that minute space of time elapsed, before Richard, startled from his reverie by Lady Jean's sudden return, dismissed from his face all trace of any extraordinary expression, and stood before her (endeavouring to appear) just what he was, her ladyship's respectful servant and teacher. Nevertheless, this transformation did not take place so quickly as to prevent her ladyship from observing the present expression, nor was it accomplished with such address, as to leave her room for passing it over as unobserved. She was surprised —she hesitated—she seemed, in spite of herself, conscious of something awkward—and finally she blushed slightly. Richard caught the contagion of her confusion in a double degree; and Lady Jean, again, became more confused on observing that he was aware of her confusion. Richard was the first to recover himself and speak. He made some remarks upon her singing and her acting—not, however, upon her admirable performance of the latter part of the drama; this encouraged her also to speak, and both soon became somewhat composed. Shortly afterwards they returned to the house; but from that moment a chain of the most delicate, yet indissoluble sympathies began to connect the hearts of these youthful beings so alike in all natural qualities, and so dissimilar in every extraneous thing which the world is accustomed to value.

After this interview there took place a slight estrangement between Master Richard and Lady Jean, that lasted a few days, during which they had much less of both conversation and music than for some time before. Both observed this circumstance; but each ascribed it to accident, while it was in reality occasioned by mutual reserve. Master Richard was afraid that Lady Jean might be offended were he to propose any thing like a repetition of the garden drama; and Lady Jean, on her part, could not, consistently with the rules of maidenly modesty, utter even a hint at such a thing, however she might secretly wish or long for it. The very consciousness, reciprocally felt, of having something on their minds, of which neither durst speak, was sufficient to produce the said reserve, though the emotions of "the tender passion" had not come in, as they did, for a large share of the cause.

At length, however, this reserve was so far softened down, that they began to resume their former practice of walking together in the garden; but, though the theorbo continued to make one of the party, no more operatic performances took place. Nevertheless, the mutual affection which had taken root in their hearts experienced on this account no abatement, but, on the contrary, continued to increase. As for Master Richard, it was no wonder that he should be deeply smitten with the charms of his mistress; for ever as he stole a long, furtive glance at her graceful form, he thought he had never seen, in Spain or in Italy, any such specimens of female loveliness; and (if we may let the reader as far into the secret) he had indeed come to Cumbernauld with the very purpose of falling in love. Different causes had operated upon Lady Jean. Richard being the first love-worthy object she had seen since the period when the female heart becomes most susceptible—the admiration with which she knew he beheld her—his musical accomplishments, which had tended so much to her gratification—all conspired to render him precious in her sight. In the words of a beautiful modern ballad, "all impulses of soul and sense had thrilled" her gentle and guileless heart

> ——hopes, and fears that kindled hope,
> An undistinguishable throng,
> And gentle wishes, long subdued,
> Subdued and cherished long,

had exercised their tender and delightful influence over her; like a flower thrown upon one of the streams of her own native land, whose course was through the beauties, the splendours, and the terrors of nature, she was borne away in a dream, the magic scenery of which was alternately pleasing, fearful, and glorious, and from which she could no more wake than could the flower restrain its course on the gliding waters The habit of contemplating her lover every day, and that in the dignified character of an instructor, gradually blinded her in a great measure to his humbler quality, and to the probable sentiments of her father and the world upon the subject of her passion. If, by any chance, such a consideration was forced upon her notice, and she found occasion to tremble lest the sentiments in which she was so luxuriously indulging, should end in disgrace and disaster, she soon quieted her fears, by reverting to an idea which had lately occurred to her—namely, that *Richard was not what he seemed*. She had heard and read of love assuming strange disguises. A Lord Belhaven, in the immediately preceding period of the civil war, had taken refuge from the fury of Cromwell in the service of an English nobleman, whose daughter's heart he won under the humble disguise of a gardener, and whom, on the recurrence of better times, he carried home to Scotland as his lady. This story was then quite popular, and at least one of the parties still survived to attest its truth. But even in nursery tales Lady Jean could find examples which justified her own passion. The vilest animals, she knew, on finding some beautiful dame, who was so disinterested as to fall in love with them, usually turned out to be the most beautiful princes that ever were seen, and invariably married and made happy the ladies whose affection had restored them to their natural form and just inheritance. Who knows, she thought, but Richard may some day, in a transport of passion, throw open his coat, exhibit the star of nobility glittering on his breast, and ask me to become a countess!

Such are the excuses which love suggests to reason, and which the reason of lovers easily accepts; while those who are neither youthful nor in love wonder at the hallucination of their impassioned juniors. Experience soon teaches us that this world is not one of romance, and that few incidents in life ever occur out of the ordinary way. But before we acquire this experience by actual observation, we, all of us, regard things in a very different light. The truth seems to be, that, in the eyes of youth, "the days of chivalry" do not appear to be "gone;" our ideas are then contemporary, or upon a par with the early, romantic ages of the world; and it is only by mingling with mature men, and looking at things as they are, that we at length advance towards, and ultimately settle down in, the *real era* of our existence. Was there ever yet youth who did not feel some chivalrous impulses—some thirst for more glorious scenes than those around him—some aspirations after lofty passion and supreme excellence—or who did not cherish some pure first-love, that could not prudentially be gratified?

The greater part of the rest of the summer passed away before the lovers came to an eclaircissement; and such, indeed, was their mutual reserve upon the subject, that, had it not been for the occurrence of a singular and deciding circumstance, their appeared little probability of this ever otherwise taking place. The Earl of Home, a gay and somewhat foolish young nobleman, one morning after attending a convivial party where the charms of Lady Jean Fleming formed the principal topic of discourse, left Edinburgh and took the way to Cumbernauld, on the very pilgrimage, and with the very purpose which Lord Wigton had before anticipated Resolved, first to see, then to love, and lastly, to run away with the young lady; his Lordship skulked about for a few days, and at last had the pleasure of seeing the hidden beauty over the garden-wall, as she was walking with Master Richard. He thought he had never seen any lady who could be at all compared to Lady Jean; and, as a matter of course, resolved to make her his own, and surprise all his companions at Edinburgh with his success and her beauty. He watched again next day, and happening to meet Master Richard out of the bounds of *Cumbernauld policy*, accosted him, with the intention of securing his services in making his way towards Lady Jean. After a few words, of course he proposed the subject to Richard, and offered a considerable bribe, to induce him to work for his interest. Richard at first rejected the offer, but immediately after, on bethinking himself, saw fit to accept it. He was to mention his Lordship's purpose to Lady Jean, and to prepare the way for a private interview with her. On the afternoon of the succeeding day he was to meet Lord Home at the same place, and tell him how Lady Jean had received his proposals. With this they parted. Richard to muse on this unexpected circumstance, which he saw, might blast all his hopes, unless he should resolve upon prompt and active measures, and the Earl of Home to enjoy himself at the humble inn of the village of Cumbernauld, where he had for the last few days enacted the character of "the daft lad frae Edinburch, that seemed to ha'e mair siller than sense."

On the morning of the tenth day after Master Richard's first interview with Lord Home, that faithful serving-man found himself jogging swiftly along the road to Edinburgh, mounted on a stout nag, with the fair Lady Jean seated comfortably on a pillion behind him. It was a fine morning in autumn, and the road had a peculiarly gay appearance from the multitude of country-people, mounted and dismounted, who seemed also hastening towards the capital. Master Richard, upon inquiry, discovered that it was the *market-day*, a circumstance which seemed favourable to his design, by the additional assurance it gave him of not being recognized among the extraordinary number of strangers who might be expected to crowd the city on such an occasion. The lovers approached the city by the west, and the first street they entered was the suburban one called Portsburgh, which leads towards the great market place of Edinburgh. Here Richard, impatient as he was, found himself obliged, like many other rustic cavaliers, to reduce the pace of his horse to a walk, on account of the narrowness and crowded state of the street This he felt the more disagreeable, as it subjected him and his interesting companion to the close and leisurely scrutiny of the inhabitants. Both had endeavoured to disguise every thing remarkable in their appearance, so far as dress and demeanour could be disguised; yet as Lady Jean would not conceal her extraordinary beauty, and Richard had not found it possible to part with a slight and dearly-beloved moustache, it naturally followed that they were honoured with a good deal of staring Many an urchin upon the street threw up his arms as they passed along, exclaiming, "Oh! the black-bearded man!" or, "Oh! the bonnie leddie!"—the men all admired Lady Jean, the women Master Richard—and many an old shoemaker ogled them earnestly over his half-door, with his spectacles pushed up above his dingy cowl. The lovers, who had thus to run a sort of gauntlet of admiration and remark, were glad when they reached an inn, which Richard, who was slightly acquainted with the town, knew to be a proper place for the performance of a *half-merk marriage*. They alighted, and were civilly received by an obsequious landlady, who conducted them into an apartment at the back of the house. There Lady Jean was for a short time left to make some arrangements about her dress, while Richard disclosed to the landlady in another room the purpose upon which he was come to her house, and consulted her about procuring a clergyman. The dame of the house, to whom a clandestine marriage was the merest matter of course, showed the utmost willingness to faciliate the design of her guests, and said that she believed a clerical official might be procured in a few minutes, provided that neither had any scruples of conscience, as "most part of fouk frae the west had," in accepting the services of an Episcopal clergyman. The lover assured her that, so far from having any objection to "a government minister," for so they were sometimes termed, he would prefer such to any other, as both he and his bride belonged to that persuasion. The landlady heard this declaration with complacency, which shewed that she loved her guests the better for it; and told Richard that, if he pleased, she would immediately introduce to him the Dean of St. Giles, who, honest man, was just now taking his *meridian* in the little back garret parlour, along with his friend and gossip, Bowed Andrew, the waiter of the west port. To this Richard joyfully assented, and speedily he and Lady Jean were joined in their room by the said Dean,—a squat little gentleman, with a drunken but important-looking face, and an air of consequentiality even in his stagger, that was partly imposing and partly ridiculous. He addressed his clients with a patronizing simper, of which the effect was grievously disconcerted by an unlucky hiccup, and in a speech which might have had the intended tone of paternal and reverend authority, had it not been smattered and degraded into shreds by the crapulous insufficiency of his tongue Richard cut short his ill-sustained attempts at dignity, by requesting him to partake of some liquor. His reverence almost leaped at the proffered jug, which contained ale. He first took a tasting, then a sip,—shaking his head between—next a small draught, with a still more convulsion-like shake of the head, and lastly, he took a hearty and persevering swill, from the effects of which his lungs did not recover for at least twenty respirations. The impatient lover then begged him to proceed with the ceremony; which he forthwith commenced in presence of the landlady and the above-mentioned Bowed Andrew; and in a few minutes Richard and Lady Jean were united in the holy bands of matrimony.

To be concluded in our next.

I regret exceedingly that the Tale of Lady Jean has been under the necessity of being halved. Such a circumstance has occurred through a miscalculation of the quantity of letter-press it would occupy.—W. C.

BIOGRAPHIC SKETCHES.

DR. ADAM.

Perhaps no country in the world, in proportion to its size, has produced so many eminent men, who have risen from the humble ranks of life as Scotland; and no species of reading with which we are acquainted, can yield such striking instances of the value of honest perseverance, under the most adverse circumstances, as the biography of the individuals who have so distinguished themselves. A most instructive lesson of this nature is afforded us in the life of the late Dr. Adam, at one time rector of the High School of Edinburgh, and the author of a number of meritorious classic works, well known to every young man who attends our schools and colleges.

"Alexander Adam, LL.D., was born at the hamlet of Coates of Burgie, in the parish of Rafford, and county of Moray, about the month of June, 1741. His father John Adam, rented one of those small farms which were formerly so common in the north of Scotland. In his earlier years, like many children of his own class, and even of a class higher removed above poverty, he occasionally tended his father's cattle. Being destined by his parents, poor as they were, for a learned profession, he was kept at the parish-school till he was thought fit to come forward as an exhibitioner, or, as it is called in Scotland, a bursar, at the University of Aberdeen. He made this attempt, but failed, from the alledged inferiority of his acquirements, and was requested by the judges to go back and study for another year at school. This incident did not mortify the young student, but only stimulated him to fresh exertions He was prevented, however, from renewing his attempts at Aberdeen, by the representations of the Rev. Mr. Watson, a minister at Edinburgh, and a relation of his mother, who induced him to try his fortune in the metropolis. He removed thither early in the year 1758, but, it appears, without any assured means of supporting himself during the progress of his studies For a considerable time while attending the classes at the college, the only means of subsistence he enjoyed consisted of the small sum of one guinea per quarter, which he derived from Mr. Alan Macconochie, (afterwards Lord Meadowbank), for assisting him in the capacity of a tutor. The details of his system of life at this period, as given by his biographer, Mr. Henderson, are painfully interesting. 'He

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lodged in a small room at Restalrig, in the north-eastern suburbs; and for this accommodation he paid fourpence a-week All his meals, except dinner, uniformly consisted of oatmeal made into porridge, together with small beer, of which he only allowed himself half a bottle at a time. When he wished to dine, he purchased a penny loaf at the nearest baker's shop: and, if the day was fair, he would despatch his meal in a walk to the Meadows or Hope Park, which is adjoining to the southern part of the city; but, if the weather was foul, he had recourse to some long and lonely stair, which he would climb, eating his dinner at every step. By this means all expense for cookery was avoided, and he wasted neither coal nor candles; for, when he was chill, he used to run till his blood began to glow, and his evening studies were always prosecuted under the roof of some one or other of his companions.' There are many instances, we believe, among Scottish students, of the most rigid self-denial, crowned at length by splendid success; but there is certainly no case known in which the self-denial was so chastened, and the triumph so grand, as that of Dr. Adam. Ere he had yet reached his twenty-first year he was employed as a teacher in George Watson's Hospital at Edinburgh, an institution designed for the support and education of a certain number of boys. In 1761, when he was exactly twenty, he stood a trial for the situation of head teacher in this establishment, and was successful. In this place he is said to have continued about three years; during which period, besides discharging the duties of his office, he was anxiously engaged in cultivating an intimacy with the classics—reading, with great care, and in a critical manner, the works of Herodotus, Thucydides, Xenophon, Cicero, and Livy. At the same time he began to make a collection of books connected with the studies which he afterwards prosecuted with so much success. His views were now directed towards the Church, and it is said he was on the eve of being licensed as a preacher of the Gospel, when suddenly a prospect opened before him of becoming assistant, with the prospect of being eventually the successor of Mr. Matheson, rector of the High School It would appear that his pretensions were fortified on this occasion by the influence of Mr. Kincaid, Provost of Edinburgh, whose son he had for some time attended as tutor. It was not till 1771 that the increased infirmities of Mr. Matheson threw the whole of this charge into the hands of Mr. Adam; the retired rector was then permitted to draw the whole of the salary given by the town, (about 30*l.*) besides 20*l.* given by Mr. Adam out of the school fees, the remainder furnishing a scanty provision for the man who performed the duty.

"The time when Adam assumed this respectable office was very fortunate. Every department of knowledge in Scotland, was at this period adorned by higher names than had ever before graced it; and hence the office of Master in the principal elementary school of the country presented to a man of superior qualifications a fair opportunity of distinguishing himself. This oppurtunity was not lost upon Mr. Adam. He devoted himself with singular assiduity to his laborious duties; and, under his auspices, the school gradually increased in numbers and reputation. Soon after his appointment, he began to compose a series of works adapted to facilitate the study of the Latin language. His Rudiments of Latin and English Grammar were published in 1772, and, though composed in a style which appeared to the generality of teachers as a dreadful schism and heresy, met with the approbation of a discerning few, whose praise was sufficient to overbalance the censure of the multitude. The mind of Dr. Adam was that of a liberal; that is to say, he had more regard for new things with the appearance of much utility, than dread of forsaking old things, of which a small degree of good was ascertained with a great deal of evil. It had occurred to him that the hitherto universal practice of teaching children Latin in the language which they were yet to learn, was a solecism. He therefore had composed his grammar in English. Experience has now shewn the propriety of this course; and the same system, we believe, must speedily be adopted in all other foreign and dead languages.

"The next work of Dr. Adam is entitled, A Summary of Geography and History, but the date of the first edition is not mentioned by his biographer. In 1791 he published his excellent compendium of Roman Antiquities. For the copyright of this work he received 600*l.* His Classical Biography made its appearance in 1800, and half of the above sum was given for the copyright. Dr. Adam's last, and perhaps his most laborious work, was his Latin Dictionary, published in 1805. Towards the beginning, his illustrations are brief, but, as he proceeds, they gradually become more copious. It was his intention to add an English-and-Latin part, and to enlarge the other to a considerable extent. In this favourite plan he had made some progress at the time of his death.

"The latter part of Dr. Adam's life was considerably embittered by the political aspect of the times. It scarcely requires to be explained, that the extreme danger in which the institutions of this country were placed by the French Revolution, caused the ban of the government, and of the major portion of society, to fall upon all who had given tokens of disaffection to the existing state of things, or even of a theoretical prepossession in favour of the abstract idea of liberty. The character of Dr. Adam's mind, as already hinted, was that of a liberal in politics He thus became so obnoxious a person, that many of even those who had been his pupils could pass him by upon the street without notice It is testified, however, by his eloquent biographer, Mr. Henderson, that his character 'derived a lustre of no common kind from his deportment amidst the harassing obstructions which were raised up against his philological lessons, and from his firmness during the rage of political terrorism. He had to cope with prejudice in all its most malignant forms; yet in maintaining a contest, under which the powers of an ordinary mind would have sunk, he never absented himself from his official avocations for a single day While he thus fulfilled his duties to the public, he also continued with the utmost calmness, his extensive classical researches. This composure of mind he must have derived from no other source than a full conviction of the rectitude of those principles upon which he set out, and of the propriety of his conduct. Such a conviction must have been strengthened, and in a great measure formed by the previous habit of proving to himself, by a course of rigid self-examination, the expediency or impropriety of every act before it was committed. Exertions of this sort can only be made by a most vigorous mind. When they have been improved into regular habits, however, the great affairs of human life, become plain and easy. But how few ever attain such habits! and how seldom does the mind submit to such discipline, without much apparent effect!" We learn from the same source, that, by dint of his uncommon self-command, Dr. Adam in a great measure withdrew himself from all pretensions to a political character. He had even the fortitude to abstain in a great measure from reading newspapers; a species of publication in which, as he remarked with a pathos that must appeal to every free heart, he felt scarcely any interest after the period of the French Revolution. His modesty at length had its reward, and gained back to respect those individuals who had formerly regarded the venerable grammarian with suspicion, and perhaps with worse feelings.

"On the 13th of December, 1809, Dr. Adam was seized, in the High School, with an alarming indisposition, which had all the appearance of apoplexy. Having been conducted home, he was put to bed, and enjoyed a sound sleep, which appeared to have arrested the progress of the disease, for he was afterwards able to walk about his room. The apoplectic symptoms, however, returned in a few days, and he fell into a state of stupor. His last words marked the gradual darkening of the ray of life and intellect beneath this mortal disorder. He said, 'It grows dark, boys—you may go,' his mind evidently wandering at that moment to the scene where he had spent the better part of his life. This *crepusculum* soon settled down into the night of death; he expired early in the morning of the 18th of December, 1809."—*Scottish Biographical Dictionary.* Blackie and Son, Glasgow.

PLAGUE. CHOLERA.

In the course of the last five hundred years, the island of Great Britain has been visited by PLAGUE about twelve times, at every appearance assuming peculiar characteristics, and of a virulence more or less fatal to human life. In nearly every instance, the pestilence came out of the East, from whence it progressed to the most westerly parts of Europe. During the reign of Edward III. England was visited by a most destructive pestilence, which had swept away nearly a third of the inhabitants in every country which it attacked. It was more fatal in large cities than in the country; and about fifty thousand souls are said to have perished of it in London alone. During the reign of Elizabeth, another plague visited this island. Infection was caught by the English soldiers in France; and the bad diet and fatigue of the men, adding force to its operation, it swept off vast numbers: the remainder coming home to England, they brought the infection with them, and again the city of London was subjected to its ravages. In that city alone, twenty thousand persons died in one year of this dreadful malady. A still more fatal plague visited the metropolis in the reign of James I., when in one year thirty thousand are computed to have died of it, though the whole population was then little more than one hundred and fifty thousand. In the succeeding reign of Charles I., another plague found its way to London, and committed great havock; the Parliament had in consequence to be assembled at Oxford; but it soon after visited that place. All these plagues are, however, trifling in comparison to one which visited England in the year 1665, during the reign of Charles II., and which seems to have swallowed up all recollections of the preceding. De Foe has written a history of this truly terrific pestilence, as it took place in London, but, unfortunately, he has so much dressed it up in the garb of romance, that his details are unworthy of implicit credit. The most faithful account we have of the great plague in London, is one drawn up by a person called William Boghurst, an apothecary, as it appeared under his own experience; it is now to be found in manuscript in the British Museum, among the papers of Sir Hans Sloane.

Speaking of the "Evil Signs or Presages of the Plague," the writer says, "Among these were spots of different colours, hiccough, vomiting, carbuncles or buboes, shortness of breath, stoppage of urine, drowsiness and thirstiness, contraction of the jaws, and large and extended tumours. Almost all that caught the disease with fear, died with tokens in two or three days. About the beginning, most men got the disease with fuddling, surfeiting, overheating themselves, and disorderly living.

"Tokens appeared not much till about the middle of June, and carbuncles not till the latter end of July, but were very rife in the fall about September and October, and seized most on old people, adult, choleric, and melancholy people, and generally on dry and lean bodies. Children had none. If very hot weather followed a shower of rain, the disease increased. This plague was ushered in with seven months' dry weather and westerly winds.

"Those that married in the heat of this disease (if they had not had it before) almost all fell into it in a week or a fortnight after it, both in city and country, of which most died, especially the men.

"Black men of thin and lean constitutions were heavy laden with this disease, and died, all that I saw, in two or three days. People of the best complexions and merry dispositions had least of the disease; and if they had it, fared the best under it. Pregnant females fared miserably. Strength of constitution was no safety. Death made the strongest assault upon strong bodies All that I saw, that were let blood in the disease, if they had been sick two, three, four, five days, or more, died the same day. More of the good died than of the bad; more men than women; and more of dull complexions than fair.

"In the summer before the Plague, in 1664, there was such a multitude of flies, that they lined the insides of houses and if any thread or string did hang down in any place, it was presently thick set with flies like a rope of onions. and swarms of ants covered the highways, that you might have taken a handful at a time. Also the small-pox was so rife in our parish, that betwixt the church and the pond in St. Giles's, which is not above six score paces, above forty families had the small-pox.

"The Plague fell first upon the highest grounds; for our parish is the highest ground about London, and the best air, yet was the first infected. Highgate, Hampstead, and Acton, also shared in it.

"Those that died of the Plague, died a very easy death generally: first, because it was speedy; secondly, because they died without convulsions. They did but of a sudden fetch their breath a little thick and short, and were presently gone. So that I have heard some say, 'How much am I bound to God, who takes me away by such an easy death!'

"One friend growing melancholy for another, was one main cause of its going through a family, especially when they were shut up, which bred a sad apprehension and consternation on their spirits.

"Many women giving suck freed themselves of the Plague by their children sucking it from them; but some continued well some days, sometimes weeks, and then fell into the disease after their children were dead.

"The wind blowing westward so long together from before Christmas until July, about seven months, was the cause the Plague began first at the west-end of the city, as at St. Giles's, St. Martin's, Westminster. Afterwards it gradually insinuated and crept down Holborn and the Strand, and then into the city, and at last to the east-end of the suburbs; so that it was half a year at the west-end of the city before the east-end and Stepney were infected, which was about the middle of July. Southwark, being the south suburb, was infected almost as soon as the west-end.

"The disease spread not altogether by contagion at first, nor began only at one place, and spread further and further, as an eating, spreading sore doth all over the body, but fell upon several places of the city and suburbs like rain, even at the first, as St. Giles's, St. Martin's, Chancery Lane, Southwark, Houndsditch, and some places within the city, as at Proctor's Houses.

"Of all the common hackney prostitutes of Lutener's Lane, Dog Yard, Cross Lane, Baldwin's Gardens, Hatton Garden, and other places, the common criers of oranges, oysters, fruit, &c; all the impudent, drunken, drabbing bayles and fellows, and many others of the Rouge Route, there are but few missing.

"Authors speak of several kinds of plagues, which took only children, others maids, others young people under thirty; but this of ours took all sorts, yet it fell not very thick upon old people till about the middle or stuck of the disease, and most in the decrease and declining of the disease.

"Cats, dogs, oxen, horses, sheep, hogs, conies, all wild-beasts, hens, geese, pigeons, turkeys, &c., and all wild-fowl were free from infection.

"Great doubting and disputing there is in the world," says this author, "whether the plague be infectious or catching or not; because some think if it were infectious, it would infect all, as the fire heats, and heats all it comes near; but the plague leaves as many as it takes; thus are they gravelled at such arguments, and cannot solve their doubts; and Van Helmont thinks all people catch it by fear: and generally every one is apt to judge by his experience; for if they have been in never so little danger, and yet have escaped without catching it, they presently think the disease not infectious; and if any one may draw his conclusion from this, I have as much reason almost as any to think it is not infectious, having passed through a multitude of continual dangers *cum summo vitæ periculo*, being employed all day till ten o'clock at night, out of one house into another, dressing sores and being always in the breath and sweat of patients, without catching the disease of any, through God's protection; and so did many nurses who were in the like danger: yet I count it to be the most subtle, infectious disease of any, and that all catch it not by fear neither, (though this doth much, as Helmont thinks,) for then children and confident people would not have the disease; but we see many of them also have it, and children especially most of any."

Such is an accurate account of the peculiarities of the plague in London. If that city and other towns in England thus suffered by these loathsome distempers, Scotland was not exempted from similar visitations. Till a comparatively recent period, this part of the island was continually suffering by "plagues, pestilence, and famine;" *dearths*, or scarcities of provisions, being ordinarily preliminary, or attendant on disorders of this nature. In the same manner that London was the chief seat of the plague in England, so Edinburgh usually suffered beyond all other towns in Scotland We find that in the reign of James IV., in 1513, (the year before the fatal battle of Flodden), Edinburgh was visited by a severe plague. On its appearance, the whole town was thrown into consternation, and the magistrates having imprudently ordered all the shops and booths to be shut for fifteen days, and neither doors nor windows to be opened within that time, but on extraordinary occasions, the malady, from such confinement of air, got leave to riot almost at will among the houses Having at length exhausted itself, as much

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from the want of materials to operate upon as any thing else, it was gradually stayed, and at length disappeared. Edinburgh was not again attacked with pestilence till the year 1645, in the reign of Charles I., much about the time it affected London, Oxford, and other places This instance of plague is still spoken of with horror by the people of Scotland. It stalked across the land as a destroying angel. All business and intercourse was suspended The jails were everywhere opened, and their unhappy inmates released. Nothing stayed the visitation or modified the asperity of this dreadful scourge. The evils it produced were soon awfully enhanced by a famine, which either prepared victims for its approach, or smote them on its departure. To crown the national calamity, the country was at the very time cursed by the presence of a civil war, carried on between Charles and his Scottish subjects, and which tore society asunder. Edinburgh, Leith, Glasgow, and all the provincial towns, became objects of the utmost commiseration; the metropolis, however, and its seaport, Leith, suffered most. To such an unparalleled degree was this city spoiled by these complicated ravages, that, after the battle of Kilsyth, when Montrose threatened to reduce it to ashes, unless certain painful conditions were granted, it could with great difficulty raise sixty men capable of bearing arms! It seems that on this and similar visitations of plague to Edinburgh, the persons affected were, if possible, hurried out of the town to an hospital on the Borough-moor,—spacious downs south west from the city.

Leith, we have said, suffered jointly with Edinburgh, though at the time numbering only from four to five thousand inhabitants. This devoted town, in eight months, namely, from April till December, 1645, lost about 3000 individuals by plague; so that, as the record affectingly mentions, "the number of the dead was greater than that of the living." This prodigious mortality soon filled both the churchyards, and the bodies were hence buried in all directions in the vicinity. No coffins on these melancholy occasions were used. As soon as the last breath of the sufferers gave token of death, they were swathed in the blankets in which they happened to be lying, and committed to the earth. This, indeed, has been substantiated in recent times, by the bones of these unfortunate plague-stricken individuals being occasionally dug up, along with shreds of old fashioned plaiding, when trenching the gardens and other grounds in the neighbourhood. The great famine followed, as usual, and reduced the town to the most pitiable condition; and such was the dearth, that the Scot's Parliament gave the local authorities the power of seizing grain or food wheresoever it could be found.

The whole history of the plague, its course, and its character, are shrouded in impenetrable mystery. The disease used to enter at one end of a street and clear all before it on one side, leaving the other free of its visit for a season. It used also to be stopped by water courses, sometimes of the most trifling nature; thus, at Peebles, it took off nearly all the inhabitants on the western side of a gutter which runs across the main street, (now covered up), while those on the other side were not affected. Though in general no respecter of persons, it seems to have attacked those who had a predisposing cause of some kind, there having been some people who, notwithstanding a constant contact with it for months, never took it at all. When the plague occurred in Dundee, early in the sixteenth century, all the infected were compelled to retire from the town, and either reside in the suburbs or bivouack in the fields without the walls. A massive fragment of the ancient wall of the town, containing the gateway of what is called the East Port, still remains in one of the streets of Dundee. Upon the top of this, Wishart, the celebrated reformer, is said to have preached to those infected with the pestilence, who lay upon the ground below. It has survived all the rest of the wall, and was lately repaired at a considerable expense, out of reverence to the memory of Wishart. In a wild and secluded spot in Teviotdale, a considerable mound of earth is shewn, under which it is said the plague was buried. There is a singular and awful distinctness in the tradition connected with this spot. It was originally, say the people, a cottage, which contained the large family of a door shepherd. At the present time, no trace of a place of habitation is discernible; it is a plain ordinary-looking hillock, upon the surface of which the sward grows as green, and the field-daisy blooms as sweetly, as if it were not, what it is, the tomb of human misery and mortal disease. The plague was introduced into this house by a piece of finery which the shepherd's wife purchased from a wandering pedlar, and wore for some time upon her head. She was speedily seized with the dreadful distemper, and took to her bed. Some of the children also beginning to feel affected, the shepherd himself went to the nearest farm-house to seek assistance. The inhabitants of this place, alarmed in the highest degree for their own safety, rose in a body, and, instead of attempting to relieve the infected family, spread the intelligence to the neighbours, who, being equally apprehensive with themselves, readily joined them in the dreadful decision, that mercy to individuals should be postponed to a regard for the general health With this resolution, and disregarding the intreaties of the poor shepherd, they went *en masse*, and, closing the door upon the unfortunate family, proceeded to throw up earth round and over the cottage till it was buried at least five feet beneath the surface. All the time of this operation, about half a day, the inmates, aware of their fate, cried dreadfully; and it was not till a large turf had been laid upon the top of the chimney, and a deep stratum of earth deposited over all, that their wailings were heard finally to subside The shepherd is described as having for some time gone round and round the place like one demented, uttering fearful cries, and invoking heaven to save his family, till at last, being driven away by the people, he departed from the awful scene in a state of distraction, and was never more heard of or seen in the district.

At Linlithgow, there is preserved a curious relic of the plague—namely, a coffin or box, which was used in conveying all the persons who died of that distemper to their last abode. It possesses no peculiarity of appearance, except that it seems calculated to contain a body of the largest size, and that the bottom is a lid, moving on hinges, with a pin, which serves by way of lock. The tradition of the town bears that the bodies of the dead were conveyed to their graves successively in this general coffin, and when brought over the hole, permitted to drop in, by merely withdrawing the pin. This indecorous mode of interment, so opposite to the ordinary customs of the Scottish people, presents us with a dreadful idea of this disorder, and of the hardening effect which its ravages gradually produced upon the feelings and ordinary sympathies of humanity. In Edinburgh, various superstitious ideas were cherished among the common people respecting the plague, which scourged the city in 1645. Throughout the Old Town, various places used to be shown where it was said the plague was shut up, and one in particular was pointed out as its burial-place. The former were certain old houses in Beth's Wynd, Mary King's Close, &c., the doors and windows of which were either almost or altogether buried beneath the adjacent ground, or covered up with such a thick layer of dust and mud, as it appeared they could only have contracted during the lapse of several centuries. When the old pest-houses of Beth's Wynd were removed in 1808, to make way for the extension of the Advocate's Library,—for that storehouse of learning now occupies the site of the said dwelling-places of superstition,—serious apprehensions were entertained by the gossips of the wynd, lest the plague should burst forth from its place of confinement, and do as much mischief in the neighbourhood as before it had been bound over to keep the peace. No result of any importance followed the destruction of the houses, however, except that beneath the floor of one of them, two workmen found a pot full of gold and silver coins, which had probably been buried there by an infected person, under the dread of being spoiled during his illness (which is said to have been often the case,) by the cleansers, and never recovered by the unfortunate owner. We have not learned that any other valuables were found in these houses at their demolition; but can, with not the less safety, avouch that it was customary, when a house was shut up for the plague, to leave the whole of the furniture within. We were once informed, by an aged lady who had lived a good deal more than eighty years in Edinburgh, that when she was a girl, there were some house in the close where she resided (Allan's, first east from the Exchange,) said to be shut up on account of the plague, with all the furniture within, precisely in the same state as it had been left by the owners when they died. Though it was known that coin, plate and other things of value were deposited in one or more of these houses, they had been permitted to remain undisturbed for a century, and might have continued shut for a much longer period, but for a particular circumstance. When the Highland army came to Edinburgh in 1745, many of the soldiers, at the risk of military punishment, as is well known, committed such acts of rapacity as to give that gallant enterprise but too much of the appearance of a predatory invasion Some, hearing of the treasures supposed to be concealed in the pest-houses of Allan's Close, and entertaining no fear of an enemy so long dead as the plague, resolved to break them open, and possess themselves of whatever they found—an innocent species of plunder, as they thought, which neither "ta law nor ta prince" could be expected to visit with the punishment promised to the robbery of the living. They did break open the houses, and, as was expected, found many valuable articles, though, contrary to the anxious apprehensions of the neighbours, no fatal consequences ensued. The plate which was all marked with engraven coats-of-arms, and the other things worth taking, were divided among the adventurers; and after the spell was thus broken, the houses were inhabited by poor people, who willingly encountered all the danger that could be supposed to remain, for the sake of a free habitation. What was very remarkable, one of the Highlanders, when the army afterwards visited Glasgow, lodged in the house of a relation of our informant, who discovered, by the arms engraved on a silver drinking cup in the man's possession, that the plundered house from which it was taken had belonged to his ancestor, and accordingly made an effort to take by force, and finally was glad to purchase, the said piece of plate, which he retained all his life afterwards as a family piece. The old lady from whom we derived this singular story, had also a tradition, that the ancestress of a certain wealthy family in Edinburgh had accumulated a vast quantity of money and things of value, by attending those who were dying of the plague, which she was enabled to do with perfect safety on account of her having had the distemper before, and being, therefore, incapable of taking it again. The sick-nurses and cleansers, it seems, were usually the heirs of the dead, and many of them, like this person, laid the foundations of vast fortunes, which were, however, it was remarked, for the most part dissipated by their immediate successors In Stirling, such were the ravages of the distemper, that all the magistrates and town-council died The executioner also died. A mound is shown in the churchyard of Stirling as the burial place of those who perished. It is said to be a vault of stone-work, but is now covered over with soil Two particular men, who alone performed, or could perform, the duties of attending the sick, became, as is known from authentic records, proprietors of much more than the half of the town; yet, so little does this seem to have affected the distribution of property in the long run, that the only descendant of any of those two men, known to exist some years ago, was an old woman who did not possess an inch of land, built or unbuilt; and there has been, ever since the oldest inhabitants can remember, just as plentiful a variety of "lairds" at Stirling, as any other town of its extent. The memory of the circumstance is preserved by certain tenements and pieces of ground, which, though now in the hands of various proprietors, still retain the names of those who inherited them in the singular way mentioned.

One of the most picturesque anecdotes of the plague which we have collected in Edinburgh, bears that, during the calamitous period, when the town was abandoned to the rapacious and the dying, the awful silence which pervaded the streets, quite as much by day as through the night, used only to be broken, in the dusk of the evening, by a cart going through the city, attended by a man, who rung a bell, and cried with a loud and solemn voice, "Throw out your deid!" Scarcely any thing could be conceived more awful than such a ceremony, performed under such circumstances. The place in Edinburgh, where "the Plague was buried," is situated in Leith Wynd This ancient, though much modernized street, as may be known to some readers, is skirted on one side by a fragment of the wall of the city. In the inside of this memorial of a former age, the soil rises almost to the very top, and is, for the most part, employed in the capacity of a garden. Towards the bottom of the wynd, a small part of the ground seems enclosed as a sort of bleaching green, being bounded on the west by a peculiarly tall house, in which there was once a Roman Catholic chapel, (burnt by the Protestant mobs of 1779.) From the wynd, the place is marked by a bulge, and peculiar blackness in the external wall, as if occasioned by the press and nature of the mould within—and by one or two spectre-like trees, which throw their dismal forms half over the rampart, apparently bleached by the dews which would have nourished them in their younger days, and not bearing any leaves even in summer. Beneath these trees, which seem to have been brought to their marrow-bones by the dreadful juxtaposition, "lies the Plague." It was buried here, says an old female informant, "by candle light, at three o'clock in the morning, by Mr Gusthart, minister, long ago of the Trinity or College Kirk, in presence of two witnesses, and not without ceremonies, such as praying and the like,"—the aversion of the Scottish Church to the burial service having been apparently done away with in the extraordinary case of "the Plague." What "the Plague" was, this worthy lady did not well know; but she promised to enquire. At a second visit, she informed our ignorance, that it was a thing which long ago used to come into people's houses, in the shape of long silken threads, palpable to the eye, but not to the touch, and which, flying about hither and thither in the air, cut the breaths of all with whom it came in contact. That her account of the funeral of the plague was true, she was quite certain, for she herself had been at the sewing-school, when a girl, with two Misses Gusthart, who were the grand-daughters of the minister, and who told her the story. Her great-grandfather, moreover, who died at a most advanced age, while she was very young, "had *seen* the Plague!" So there was no occasion for incredulity.

Although popular tradition points to Leith Wynd as the place of burial of many who died of the plague in Edinburgh, and although such be quite correct in point of fact, as this place formed part of the churchyard of the neighbouring collegiate church, it is fully more consistent with record to mention, that many of those who died of the distemper were buried in the Greyfriars' churchyard, in large graves, "seven fute wyde, and verie deepe." Many were also buried at the small remote chapel of St. Roque, to the south of Burntsfield Links. We are informed, by historical evidence, that this had been from early times a place of sepulture for those who were carried off by the Edinburgh plagues. Why this religious establishment should have been selected for a purpose of this kind is not adverted to by the historians of Edinburgh; and it is left for us to mention that St. Rocque, or Rochus, was long esteemed by our ancestors as the patron saint of those afflicted with pestilence. In the Breviary of Aberdeen, one of the earliest specimens of Scottish typography, we have some curious particulars regarding him. He was of foreign birth, and flourished in the fourteenth century. There is no end of the miracles he is said to have wrought, both before and after his death. "Vale, Roche angelice," concludes the Breviary, "voce citatus famine optimisti deifice a cunctus pestem pellere." At the Reformation this sainted physician lost his reputation,—the revenues of his chaplain were seized, and his chapel demolished; still the force of ancient custom remained, and the people of Edinburgh continued to inter their plague-stricken relations in the little burying-ground. But we are probably tiring our readers with these melancholy memoranda of times to which the present has too lamentable a resemblance, so we pass on to the plague of our own days.

The spasmodic cholera of modern times is evidently one of those oriental plagues which, though greatly modified in its effects, and different in its mode of attack and symptoms, has been in the same manner generated in the pestilential jungles of Hindoostan, and in the same manner has progressed a distance of eight thousand miles towards the north-west, laying every principality and power successively under contribution to its insatiate appetite. All that is known of plague and cholera is a number of isolated facts, often of a contradictory nature, and no way capable of forming a body of evidence on which any correct theory can be founded Cholera is certainly far more capricious than plague. It will travel against the wind at the rate of more than a hundred miles a-day. It despises the temperature of the atmosphere, and will malignantly frolic under a frost which withers every species of vegetation

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Sometimes it keeps to a line of road, or a river, captivating town after town, as they happen to fall in its way; and at other periods it will skip over two or three towns at a time, just stooping here and there to pick up a victim, as it were, out of the mere wantonness of mischief. In our opinion, he would be a cowardly and short-sighted man who would leave a town because cholera threatened an invasion. If he fly, he may either meet it or overtake it, while all the time it has never come near the house he has left. Going to the country is utterly useless, for it may pounce upon you in an instant, though you were immersed in the innermost recess of a mountainous wilderness. In a city you are surrounded by an innumerable body of the most intelligent physicians, all acting in concert, and each contributing his solitary fact to swell the mass of useful knowledge on the subject. Under a visitation of plague, mankind might always be allowed to repine; but under a visitation of cholera, they have much to comfort them. Its general selection of victims from among the dissolute and famished, in which it entirely differs from plague; its general aversion of those of regular habits who enjoy good food and raiment; its putting to death only a third or a half of those it attacks; its premonitory symptoms or warnings; its liability to be cured by certain specific remedies; the safety with which medical men may attend it; the great chance of escaping it by retaining a perfect cheerfulness of disposition; but, above all, this remarkable fact, that in most countries which it has visited, it has not increased the amount of mortality in the aggregate, reckoning in a whole year; for it seems, in some measure, only to take those persons who would catch any sort of epidemic that happened to be going. Taking these and other peculiarities of cholera into account, it may be safely pronounced an exceedingly modified species of plague. Having already exhausted itself on the continent of Europe, it is now passing over the island of Britain, always keeping onwards towards the west. Whether, on arriving at the shores of the Atlantic, it will venture to cross that spacious sea, of three thousand miles in breadth, and will land, re-invigorated by its voyage, among the nations of America, is a problem that cannot be long in being elucidated. These lines will probably never meet the eye of a living soul in that great Western World, otherwise we would beseech its inhabitants instantly to prepare, with the manliness and intelligence of men descended from a British ancestry, for the reception of this hated scourge; and in using those means for its prevention and cure, placed by the good providence of God within the scope of their comprehension, will, in the end, we trust, oblige it to pass innocuously over their settlements.

This article has been necessarily drawn to an extraordinary length, and leaves us to regret the space which it has occupied; we, therefore, without one word of comment, conclude by offering the following advice to families, regarding the means to be used to prevent and cure the cholera now in progress, extracted from the works of the best medical practitioners:—

Cleanliness.—Personal Cleanliness is strongly recommended, and a careful removal of every source of filth which may render the air impure. Great care should also be taken to ventilate rooms and houses.

Diet.—Indigestible articles of diet, such as undressed fruits, should be avoided.

Temperance.—The abuse of spirituous liquors tends greatly to lessen the influence of remedial means, and consequently to render the disease more fatal. Temperance is therefore strongly enjoined.

Symptoms of the Disease.—The disease is preceded by languor, coldness, giddiness, and slight bowel complaint. It usually comes on with purging, vomiting, and cramp; then follow smallness of the pulse, and coldness of the skin; the features become sharp and contracted; and the eye sinks. These early symptoms are more or less felt from one to three days before the attack.

Remedial Means.—It is of the utmost importance that the premonitory or early symptoms should be attended to, and medical assistance procured as early as possible; but as the disease may occur under circumstances where medical advice cannot be immediately obtained, the following measures may be safely and beneficially employed:—All means tending to restore the circulation and maintain the warmth of the body, should be had recourse to without delay. The patient should always be immediately put to bed, wrapped up in hot blankets, and the warmth of the body should be sustained by the application of bags, containing hot salt or bran, to different parts of it. For the same purpose, stone bottles or tin canisters, filled with hot water, should be employed. Two tea-spoons full of the flour of mustard-seed mixed with half a tumbler of warm water, to be given to excite full vomiting; afterwards, a wine glass full of brandy or whiskey, mixed with hot water, will be useful. If the disease continues, from 20 to 40 drops of laudanum may be administered, along with two tea-spoons full of magnesia in peppermint water. If there be pain of the stomach, a mustard poultice ought to be applied over it. Should the symptoms not abate in a hour, or an hour and a half, the draught, with laudanum, may be repeated.

Haarlem.—We paid a sovereign for an hour's enjoyment of the organ in the Cathedral of St. Bavon, which is admitted to be the finest in the world. It has eight thousand pipes and sixty-eight stops. The largest pipe is thirty-two feet long, and sixteen inches in diameter. One of the pieces we heard represented a band with every variety of music, another, a storm of rain and thunder, the effect of which was astonishing. The loud peals of thunder seemed to roll over the building, while drops of rain beat violently on the roof. The storm gradually exhausted itself, and all was calm.—*Elliot's Letters from the North of Europe.*

Fowls.—It is, perhaps, seldom that fowls can be kept conveniently about a cottage; but, when they can, three, four, or half-a-dozen hens, to lay in *winter*, when the wife is at *home* the greater part of the time, are worth attention. They would require but little room, might be bought in November and sold in April, and six of them, with proper care, might be made to clear every week the price of a gallon of flour. If the labour were great I should not think of it: but, it is *none;* and I am for neglecting nothing in the way of pains, in order to ensure a hot dinner every day in winter when the man comes home from work. As to the *fatting* of fowls, information can be of no use to those who live in a cottage all their lives; but it may be of some use to those who are born in cottages and go to have the care of poultry at richer persons' houses. Fowls should be put to fat about a fortnight before they are wanted to be killed. The best food is barley-meal wetted with milk, but not wetted too much. They should have clear water to drink, and it should be frequently changed.—*Cobbett's Cottage Economy.*

Smoking.—The smoke of tobacco drawn into the mouth, without being inhaled into the lungs, acts powerfully on the nervous system, and produces the effects of a stupefying narcotic: hence its use among the lower orders. The chewing of tobacco has the same influence; and if the saliva be swallowed, its effects are powerful and dangerous. The powder of tobacco, called snuff, drawn into the nostrils, produces on those unaccustomed to its use immediate but momentary intoxication, along with much sickness. This baneful plant is supposed to have been introduced into England by the fleet of Sir Francis Drake, in 1586.—*Lardner's Cabinet Cyclopedia.*

Anecdote of Mr. Jeffrey.—The present Lord Advocate for Scotland was the son of an under-clerk of Session, and was born in the upper part of a house in the Lawnmarket, very near the spot where the celebrated David Hume is said also to have first seen the light. The house happened to take fire at the time when the future Lord Advocate was only about a year old, and in the hurry of saving other things, the child in the garret was for a long time forgotten. When it was almost too late he was remembered, and an honest man, by trade a slater, volunteered his services in rescuing the infant from his perilous situation. With much difficulty, and no little danger, he was brought forth from the burning house, and delivered into the arms of his anxious friends. Thus was a life, which assuredly has been of some importance in Scottish literary and political history, preserved by the courage of a poor tradesman. It is pleasant to have it to record, that many years after this event, when Mr. Jeffrey had commenced his career at the bar, the poor slater, happening to get involved, by no misconduct of his own, in a ruinous series of legal troubles, applied for advice to Mr. J., who, in gratitude to his disinterested preserver, exerted himself in such a way as completely to extricate him in a very short time. We believe we may safely add, that this conduct on the part of the Lord Advocate is no more than what all who know him would expect from him under such circumstances.

The Mussulmaun's Sabbath.—As a religious rest, the Sabbath is but partially observed with Mussulmauns. The Soonies, I have remarked, pay much more attention to its institutions than the Sheahs; but with either sect, the day is less strictly kept than might have been expected from people who really seem to make religion their study and the great business of their lives. Both sects have extra prayers for the day besides the usual Namaaz, which the religious people perform with great punctuality, whether they carry their devotions to the great mosque, or offer their prayers in due form in their own abode. On the Sabbath they make it a point to bathe and change their apparel; the public offices are closed, and the shops partially shut until mid-day; the rulers,—as Kings or Nuwaubs,—distinguish the day, by not receiving their courtiers and the public visiters, as on other days. Charitable donations are likewise more bountifully dispensed from the rich to the poor on Friday. These observances serve to convince us that they believe in the constituted Sabbath; still there is not that strict respect for the holy day which could satisfy the scrupulous feelings of a Christian; the servants are quite as much employed on Friday as on any other day; the dhurzie (tailor,) dhobie (washerwoman,) and indeed the whole establishment of servants and slaves, male and female, find their work undiminished on the Sabbath. The ladies amuse themselves with cards or dice, the singing women even are quite as much in request as on other days; and all the amusements of life are indulged in without once seeming to suspect that they are disobeying the law of God, or infringing on their actual duties. Indeed, I believe they would keep the day strictly, if they thought doing so was a necessary duty: but I have often observed, that as Friday is one of their "fortunate days," works of any importance are commenced on this day; whether it be building a house,—planting a garden or a field,—writing a book,—negociating a marriage,—going a journey, making a garment, or any other business of this life which they wish should prosper. With them, therefore, the day of rest is made one of the busiest in the calendar; but I must do them the justice to say, that they believe their hearts are more pure after the ablutions and and prayers have been performed. And that as nothing, however trifling or important, according to their praiseworthy ideas, should ever be commenced without being first dedicated to God,—from whose mercy they implore aid and blessings on the labour of their hands,—they set apart Friday for commencing whatever business they are anxious should prosper. This was the excuse made by the pious Meer Hadjee Shaah.—*Mrs. Meer Hassan Ali's Hindoostaun.*

The Wasp.—The manners of wasps are truly curious; but we are not about to enter upon a particular description of them. It is one quality only that we would at present mention—the power of the wasp to make *paper*. The substance of which the wasp's nest is made is actually paper; and the wasps knew how to make paper long before man did. And it is particularly worth notice, that at this very time, a new method of making paper is said to have been discovered,—namely, to make the paste (or pulp) for the paper with the fibres of rotten wood. A French gentleman, M. Brad, says, he was determined to try whether he could not devote to some useful purpose a substance which seemed so useless. He took a large quantity of rotten wood, and removed the knots and parts from it. This was then put into an oil-mill, and ground; it was watered, and afterwards put into sacks to drain off. The paste thus formed was taken to a paper manufactory and after going through the usual process, about 500 of greyish paper were produced, fit to be written on, although no glue had been applied to it. By pasting a number of sheets together he formed a pasteboard sufficiently solid and light for ordinary uses. The wasp is a paper maker, and a most perfect and intelligent one. Whilst mankind were arriving by slow degrees at the art of forming this valuable substance, the wasp was making it before their eyes, by very much the same process as that by which human hands now manufacture it with the best aid of chemistry and machinery. While some nations carved their records on wood, and stone, and brass, and leaden tablets, others more advanced wrote with a pointed instrument on wax; others employed the inner bark of trees; and others the skins of animals rudely prepared—the wasp was manufacturing a firm and durable paper. Even when the papyrus—the flag growing on the banks of the river Nile in Egypt—was by a process of art made to serve for paper, the wasp was a better artizan than the Egyptians; for the early attempts at paper-making were so rude that the substance produced was almost useless, having no firmness of texture. The paper of the papyrus was formed of the leaves of the plant, dried, pressed, and polished. The wasp alone knew how to reduce vegetable fibres to a pulp, and then unite them by a size of glue, spreading the substance out into a smooth and delicate leaf. This is exactly the process of paper making. It would seem that the wasp knows, as the modern paper-makers know, that the fibres of rags are not the only materials used in the formation of paper. She employs other vegetable matters, converting them into a proper consistency by her laborious exertions. In some respects she is more skilful even than our paper-makers; for she takes care to keep fibres of a sufficient length by which she renders her paper as strong as she requires. Many manufacturers of the present day cut their material into small bits, and thus produce a rotten article. One great distinction between good and bad paper is its toughness; and this difference is produced by the fibre being long, and therefore tough, or short, and therefore easily pulled to pieces.

A Judgment of God.—It was upon one of these occasions, when Jeroboam stood by his altar at Beth-el, that God sent a prophet from Judea to rebuke the idolatrous monarch, and to predict the overthrow of that very altar, by a prince of David's line called Josias. Jeroboam, incensed at the insolence of the speaker, stretched out his hand to arrest him, but he had scarcely done so when the arm withered, and he was unable to draw it back. Alarmed, rather than conscience-struck by the judgment, Jeroboam entreated the prophet to pray for him, which was done, and the use of his arm restored; but the king took no further notice of the prophet's rebuke, except by inviting him to his house with the promise of a reward. This however the stranger declined, declaring that God had positively forbidden him to eat or drink within the bounds of the impious kingdom, and that even to return by the way which he had followed in coming was prohibited. He accordingly mounted his ass, and leaving the assembly to think what they might, took a new direction homewards.—*History of the Bible.*

Unnatural Characters in Fiction.—No character can enter a human imagination which is not within the compass of Nature's possibility, but there is much in Nature which has never entered the imagination. What imagination ever conceived any thing so outrageous as Jack Mitford's acknowledgment that his love of gin was so great, that if his soul were on one table and a gin-bottle on the other, he would barter the former for the latter?

Cats.—We are informed by Browne, in his *Natural History of Jamaica*, that cats are considered a very dainty dish among the negroes; and Gœthe, in his *Rifleman's Comrade*, says,—"At Palermo, some of the soldiers caught a cat belonging to a convent, and having skinned the carcass, it was cut into pieces, and soaked twenty-four hours in vinegar, then anointed with garlic and honey, until the strong flavour had left it, after which it formed an excellent *fricassee*. To be serious," continues our author, "I can assure my readers that the flesh of a well-fed cat is extremely good. It is indeed, (presuming her to be properly dressed,) not only agreeable in taste, but actually a dainty; and it is imagination and prejudice alone which protect the feline race amongst us from the uses of the gastronomic art."—*Brown's Anecdotes of Quadrupeds.*

—[The people of Palermo have a right to exercise their own taste in cooking and eating the gigots of cats, and I shall not quarrel with them for doing so; for my part, I prefer to stick to our good old Scottish fare, and would recommend all my readers to do the same.]

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RETROSPECTIVE REVIEW.

I AM fond of a walk through an ancient library, in which the long dim vista is partially illuminated by coloured streaks of light darted through the painted windows, so as to leave the room, here and there, in gloomy shade. How awful and sublime it is to plant one's self in the midst of this dignified silence, with a sombre Gothic roof overhead, and where, all around you, is built up the concentrated knowledge of man! How solemn the reflection, that, here, you stand the only living soul—the only being that breathes, and has power to speak, and can use a pen with his fingers; while, standing so near you, there are thousands of disembodied authors, whose mortal frames have long since sunk into the dust, to which you yourself must ere long be also carried! How transcendent was the idea! how Godlike was the invention! of transferring the greatest minds of the past and passing ages into books; so that, at the distance of hundreds of years, their successors on this ever-shifting stage are enabled to receive their instructions as fresh as from their living lips. How sweet and edifying is the converse which may be held amidst the chequered lights of such a chamber, with the sages of other years! How superior is such an enjoyment to those procured from many of the vain frivolities of the passing world! With what thankfulness do I lay down my friendly monitor!—with what reverence do I commit the instrument of his instruction to its little receptacle, there to remain till again consulted by some similar visitor, probably a century after I shall have joined the spirit with whom I have been meditating There is something agreeable to the feelings of a living visitor, in these occasional researches amongst the volumes of almost neglected libraries. In the delight of drawing forth and consulting some volume, upon which the dust of years has been permitted to repose, the visitor, if himself engaged in the task of diffusing knowledge by the press, is apt to reflect that, when his works are perhaps consigned to a place in the range of volumes, he may be indebted to some similar enthusiast for the compliment of having *his own dust* swept away, and his instructions brought once more into actual use. While he is gratifying, as he half supposes, the unseen spirits of the place, he reflectively gratifies himself.—Having lately sauntered, in the mood of mind now described, through a large library of neglected books, I was impressed with the idea, that, to take up a dust-covered volume at random, and communicate to the present generation some part of whatever wisdom it contained, would not only be an act of homage from the living to the dead, in itself highly commendable, but might be attended with much benefit At the bottom of a neighbouring pilaster lay a tattered volume, of old-fashioned appearance, which seemed to be so much despised, as not to be conceived worthy of a place on the shelves; this, I thought, is a favourable specimen with which to commence my experiment. I therefore took it up, brushed off its coat of dust, and found it to be entitled, "Thoughts, Moral and Divine, upon Various Subjects, by Wellins Callcott, Gent., London." The reader will be able, after perusing the following extract from its pages, to say whether my resolution be one worthy of being pursued any farther: but, in the meantime, I must express my own admiration of the fine strain of moral feeling which pervades the passage which follows, as well as the simple grandeur of its style. Probably, every successive week, I shall present to my readers a short piece of solemn or pious composition, equally calculated to fill their minds with virtuous or sacred reflection The subject is *Honour*.

"The nearest way to honour, is, for a man so to live that he might be found to be that in truth he would be thought to be. 'Tis honourable to support the glory of one's ancestors, by actions which correspond with their reputation; and it is also glorious to leave a title to one's descendants which is not borrowed from our predecessors; to become the head and author of our own nobility; and (to use the expression of Tiberius, who was desirous of hiding the defect of birth in Curtius Rufus, though otherwise a very great man) to be born of one's own self.

"True honour is seated in the soul. It rises from a generous heart, and flows with a natural and easy descent into all the different traces of life and channels of duty, refreshing, invigorating, and adorning all the faculties of the soul, the language of the tongue, the very air of the face, and motions of the body. It displays itself in a natural unaffected greatness and firmness of mind, improved by a train of wise and religious reflections, and generous actions, in which personal virtue and real merit truly consist The Jewish Cabalists had a pretty allegory to express this truth, as founded in the original make and frame of nature. They tell us, that when Moses describes the great river of Eden branching out into four streams, we are to understand by paradise the mind or soul of man The river was this original fountain of truth and virtue, arising from the very root and essence of the soul, and branching out into the four cardinal virtues, and all the other lower degrees and kinds of virtue—even the inferior morals of affability, politeness, good nature and good manners; and that, in short, there lies hid in the root of every human soul, however defaced by ignorance and deformed by vice, a fund of good, an oracle of truth, which, when assisted by a happy concurrence of external causes, such as, particularly, the structure of the organs and the texture of the blood and spirits, will, by due culture and discipline, naturally exert itself into a train of great, generous, and beneficent actions, suitable to the original grandeur and dignity of its nature. This, in the present debased state of human nature, lies very often buried under the ruins of ignorance and vice, like valuable coins, medals, statues, pillars, and other beautiful ornaments of architecture; or, to speak more properly, that order, symmetry, and proportion, which were as the soul of the structure, lie buried under the ruins of a once famous and magnificent building. Hence it comes to pass, that many an excellent genius is lost to the world—lies hid amongst the rubbish of mankind; who, with proper assistance, due culture, and in a happy situation, might have done honour to human nature, and been a public blessing to mankind. A man of honour, considered in this light, performs not only all the acts of virtue in public and private life, but does them with a peculiar propriety and dignity of behaviour, as the connoisseurs in writing, painting, music, architecture, or even dress, execute even the justest designs, not only with proportion and truth, but with such decorations, embellishments, and graces, as naturally flow from a fine taste, and an improved understanding This alone, in high life, makes glorious princes, illustrious heroes, gallant commanders, vigilant magistrates, and honourable counsellors; and, in the lower degree of social life, indulgent husbands, tender fathers, affectionate friends, merciful landlords and masters, faithful tenants and servants; and executes all the relative duties of life with justice and honour. This is the true and real virtue, the only proper foundation of all the honourable distinctions among men in all the different stations of life. The bulk of mankind are caught by noise and show. The pompous sound of titles and glitter of ornaments strike their senses, attract their attention, raise their admiration, and extort from them all that reverence and regard which are due only to eminent and distinguished merit; while real virtue and true honour pass silently through the world, unheeded and unregarded, but by the happy discerning few who are sensible of its merit, or enjoy the blessed communication of its influence When those glorious spirits, whom Providence has appointed to be our guardians and protectors in this present state of imperfection and probation, survey the disordered state of human nature, agitated by blind passions, prejudiced by false opinions, into erroneous conclusions and wild pursuits, they view us with the same light, and with the same emotions of compassion and charity, as Monroe did his lunatic patients in Bedlam, who miscall and misapply almost every instance in which their duty and happiness is concerned. To those blessed intelligences, the silent life of a generous, compassionate, beneficent man, is more truly honourable than the pageantry of princes, the pomp of conquerors, and all the glorious impertinence of state. To them, an obscure good man, doing secret acts of charity, relieving the distressed, comforting the miserable, and approving himself, by habits of piety and devotion, to the great Author of his being, appears more truly glorious than the conqueror at the head of an hundred thousand men. To them the man of Ross appears in a fairer light in the Book of Remembrance, and will ever make a much more illustrious figure at the last great day, than Alexander, or Cæsar, or William the Conqueror, though a Christian. For to do good, to be lovers of mankind, to alleviate the distresses, and promote the peace and happiness of our fellow-creatures, is the highest honour, the noblest ambition, that can enter into the heart of man. But the greatest part of mankind judge quite otherwise. Noise and show, title and equipage, glitter and grandeur, constitute the whole idea of honour; and whoever can command an interest sufficient to procure, and an affluence sufficient to support them, becomes thereby not only a man of honour, but even a subordinate fountain of honour to others."

BURNS'S "JOLLY BEGGARS."

THE scene of the "Jolly Beggars" was an hostel in Mauchline of the lowest possible description, to which beggars and vagrants resorted for lodging and food. It was adapted for the entertainment of such characters only, and no other sort of persons ever entered it, excepting, perhaps, such wags as Burns himself, when bent upon amusement, and desirous of seeing the lowest scenes which human nature can exhibit.

At the time Burns composed his poem, there were several houses of this kind in the country. At that period there were infinitely more beggars than at present, and their lodging-houses were of course more numerous. Begging might be said to have been then a much better trade, partly on account of the greater hospitality of the times, and partly by reason of its professors being generally useful in retired places, as news-venders, as tale-tellers, and occasionally as smugglers The "randie gangrel bodies" of 1785 were therefore a more opulent and riotous class than those of the present degenerate days They could afford to spend between ten and twenty shillings in a week upon the pleasures of a lodging-house, and to sit at their liquor from Saturday night till Tuesday or Wednesday morning; not that a lodging-house was preferred before other places of abode—as indeed a farmer's stable, loft, or outhouse with a good supper before bed, and their "parritch" in the morning when they rose, was invariably a more delectable object, as being perfectly eleemosynary—but it was generally made a fixed point among them, to taste the luxuries of "Poosie's" hovel at least once a-week, if funds were answerable, in order to refit for the next

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campaign, and see their friends. The regularity of their meetings may be authenticated from Burns's own words: "In Poosie Nansie's held *the* splore;" the use of the definite article indicating that it was a constant custom.

The person who supplies the information contained in this article happened, about the year 1794, to be personally intimate with the scenes so inimitably described in the poem, it being part of his duty as a citizen-constable, to visit, every night, the house to which the Jolly Beggars resorted, to see that every thing was quiet and orderly. To the admirers of the Cantata it may be interesting to have a more minute account of this scene in every particular than Burns has given; and though his sketch must fall infinitely short of the poet's outline, he will at least pledge himself to give a faithful transcript of his own recollections.

Poosie Nansie's cottage was a ruinous hovel of one story, with the thatch broken in several places, so that the family were sometimes blessed with the dews of Heaven in the most direct manner. From without, the house appeared to have two windows, one at each side of a low oval-shaped door; so that the contour of the whole bore no small resemblance to the visage of a cat; the two chimneys rising from the roof being supposed to represent the erect ears of the animal. On entering, you were not troubled with the ceremony of an inner-door, nor was there any extent of lobby to traverse. About one yard forward from the outer-door, on turning the corner of a small projection, the whole scene lay exposed to view. One end of the tenement was the room common to all. The price of lodging in this part of the domicile was one penny. The accommodations were of course by no means elegant. Here there was no form of beds; but merely a common heap of straw, of which a couch could be made by the guests themselves, according to their own pleasure, or the means they possessed of dressing it The straw was squalid to the utmost degree, and cnopped so small, by long service, that it was more like chaff than straw. However, a covering of "orra duds" made it quite as pleasant as if it had been less equivocal in its appearance. The chimney stood out from the gable of this apartment, like a pulpit, and almost as large. Here in the evenings, an immense fire was lighted, where Poosie herself—an old, bearded dame—was eternally engaged in cooking, and round which all the wretches gathered, to drink their "dear Kilbagie," &c. The furniture consisted of the merest fragments,—*stools*, originally quadruped, degraded into tripods, and even in some instances, into bipeds,—a long deal *table* with turned legs, one limb *tethered* to the other to keep the whole from straggling, and propped into a horizontal position by supplementary peats,—*pots* that, in the course of time, had come to answer completely the fanciful description of the Irishman, "wanting feet, ears, and cheeks, with a hare-lip into the bargain,"—even the articles of *stoneware* seemed to be in the most dilapidated condition; the most of them had ceased to be vessels of quantity, and become mere shreds of plain surface; or if a hollow was attained, it was only at the expense of a larger vessel; for instance, a cup was perhaps fashioned out of the larboard side of a tureen.

Such was the apartment of Poosie Nansie's house in which lodging was to be had at the low price of one penny. This was the House of Commons: now for the House of Peers! The House of Peers was the *spence*, or better part of the dwelling, in which the more respectable sort of beggars were deposited, apart from the vulgar throng. A division was accomplished by means of a partition formed of straw, curiously wattled and mixed with clay. The accommodations here were considerably superior to those of the meaner apartment. Here there were actually beds! — beds formed of straw, it is true, but yet possessed of the inestimable advantages of a species of covering like horse-rugs. Here there were also chairs, generally with bottoms, and sometimes even with backs. One side of the Chamber of Peers was entirely occupied by two ranges of beds in tiers; and "the kipples" in this part of the house were covered with a firm footing, and filled with receptacles like "chicken-cavies" ranged all round, which were accessible from below by an infirm trap-stair, fashioned like a hen's ladder The price of lodging in this magnificent quarter was twopence.

But what avails it to describe the mere externals of the immortal Poosie Nansie's hostelry, if its internal economy, its wonderful inmates, and its glorious "splores," are to remain undelineated? Oh, for the pen of Burns, to fill up the exquisite outline which he has left us,—to paint a Saturday night scene in all its depth and breadth of colouring, and with that minute faithfulness of touch so necessary to a general comprehension of the whole! Alas, the only hand that could do it justice is torpid and forgetful of its cunning! The sun himself is set, and a dim "gloamin" alone remains, capable of throwing but little light upon the subject We have promised, however, to do our best.

As the approach of night calls home all the creatures of animated nature to rest and enjoyment, so, in these good old times, did Saturday night, the sunset of the week, bring to roost all the stray sons of poverty, bent upon compensating, by the festivity of one night, the contumelies, the wanderings, the hunger, cold, pain, and abstinence, of the rest. On that evening, therefore, whole fleets of mendicants might be seen thronging the roads, bound for Poosie Nansie's, to "haud the splore," and pouring in at all the "town-ends" in Mauchline. The oval-shaped door we have described received them within its *crater*, as the bung-hole in the genie's cask, in the *Arabian Night's Entertainments*, received the vapour into which the fisherman had caused him to dissolve himself. Then would there be recognitions of acquaintance, and the most ceremonious shaking of hands imaginable; for they were always ceremonious, till such time as the ice of politeness was thawed by the genial warmth of a few preliminary drams; when, of course, there was a greater community of friendly feeling throughout. But not more wonders in the dissolution of ceremony did Poosie's Kilbagie achieve, than did her large pulpit-looking fire round which they gathered, in respect of relaxing with equally potent heat the cripple limbs of the company. It was truly amazing to witness the miracles wrought by Poosie's wonderful fire. The miserable wretch who perished with the rheumatism, and walked double through the week was cured in an instant, as if the demon of the disease had fled from his bones on coming within the influence of a spell. The "po-or ou-ld bli-nd man," who had howled forth the terrible circumstances of his condition, vexing the ears of the lieges, for six long days, suddenly opened his eyes to the blessings before him, as if he had only awoke from a long sleep. The "poor sailor lad," too, who had lost an arm with Rodney, on the glorious 12th of August, 1782, seemed suddenly to forget all the effects of the engagement, and, in the twinkling of a handspike, the long deceased limb sprang from the jacket, into all its pristine health and vigour. More astonishing resurrections than even that took place. Legs accustomed to "limp wi' the spavie," recovered their vigour and proportion. Legs grew down from trunks formerly detruncated, and arms sprang from shoulders erst apparently stumps. Immense blotches that, in week days, excited the commiseration of the charitable, in the character of plague spots upon the skin, at once disappeared, "and, like the baseless fabric of a vision, left not a wreck behind." The man "with a brown leg and a blue one," who had "had the black scurvy in Jamaica, and come home a poor helpless object," became in a moment the soundest and liveliest man in the company; and the wretch who trembled through the week between two crutches, as if every part of his body were taking leave of the other, now shivering with the ague, and at other times agonized by the cramp, threw by his wooden friends and was "himself again." In short, the transformations and cures accomplished at Poosie Nansie's fireside, were miraculous and manifold. Suffice it to say, that the blind saw, the deaf heard, the dumb spoke, (nay, "ranted and sang,") the lame walked—and *all drank*. In the latter department, there was not a single inefficient member.

No sooner were the window shutters of night all fairly closed in, and every thing snug, than the festivities of the evening commenced. Tea was paraded by the females of the company, and drunk from *luggies*, *caups* and *tinnies*, all of them vessels not easily broken. Fowls and pieces of meat were sometimes produced from secret wallets, and bacon ham was no unusual dish; all of which were hastily prepared by frying,—for they had no delicacy of taste in cooking. To these were added savoury messes, consisting of cold meat, eggs, hares, and other articles of food the most incongruous in association, seasoned highly with salt, pepper, onions, and occasionally garlic. As soon as the feast was pretty well over—for it never could be said to be altogether done—the fiercer debaucheries began, and the hostess was in perpetual demand for supplies of more liquor. Nansie did not retail spirits herself, but procured what was wanted from a neighbouring shop, where she was allowed a small emolument for her custom. which she contrived to increase not a little by cheating her guests of an enormous commission (in kind) for her trouble Kilbagie was then sold so low as one penny per gill;* of course it was quite possible to get completely intoxicated for four pence. Over this stuff they were wont to carouse till midnight, when the mirth and fun generally grew so fast and furious, that nothing could contain them, and their joy could only find vent in the confusion of a dance, or a squabble. If the former amicable method chanced to be adopted, the floor was cleared in an instant for action. The whole of Nansie's furniture was promiscuously huddled into a corner, and to it they set, men, women, and children, like a parcel of infuriated Bacchanalians, tossing their limbs wildly about, and using gesticulations, and *setting* into attitudes, that no language can paint. After tiring of this exercise, they would again sit down to deep debauch, and drink till morning light, about which time all that had survived the soporific effects of the liquor, were commonly engaged in a Polymachia, or battle general; which exertion was for the most part quite as effectual in laying the company low, as the Kilbagie. They seemed to fight themselves out, in short; and one by one dropped from the scene, till not a combatant was left. All were on the floor, dead, flat, and peaceable. Sunday morning, which, rising in Scotland, finds all nature reduced to a state of perfect calm, usually found the inmates of Poosie Nansie's hotel in the same circumstances. All was quiet; but it was the quiet of desolation The whole apartment seemed strewn with the ruins of the human race,—"reliquiæ Danaum,"—a heterogeneous chaos of carcasses, heads, arms, women, children, wooden legs, and other fragments of humanity, together with the no less disabled pieces of Nansie's furniture, that were in every respect analogous to the strange beings who used them on the preceding evening.

Through the course of Sunday, it was observed that the inmates of Nansie's mansion were wonderfully quiet and orderly. If the weather was good, many put off the day by sitting upon turf seats at the door, smoking and talking; while the children lay half naked upon the green, amusing themselves with every species of feat and play, like Nereids sporting on the azure wave. In proportion as the debauch or battle of the preceding evening had been fierce and fatal, the conversations of Sunday were harmonious, and the harmony universal. Whatever were the injuries received in the fray, none of them were remembered. It seemed to be then the general wish that an amnesty should be agreed upon, and no revenge taken for former aggressions. At the close of night, however, the splore was again commenced with considerable briskness. But the festivities of this evening never reached within many degrees of their Saturday-night jollifications, in intenseness of enjoyment, or obstreperousness of mirth,—partly for the sake of decorum, partly on account of low finances, and principally because their spirits, which, suppressed through the week, burst out into the most violent expression on Saturday night, were so far exhausted by the first overflow, that little material remained to be expended upon the second. On Monday morning, it was a rich sight to see the crapulous wretches take their departure from Mauchline, with empty wallets, sore heads, and sneaking aspects,—so completely spent in every respect by the excesses they had committed, that their wretched appearance looked a thousand times more wretched; and what had formerly seemed only ruins of humanity was now the wreck of ruins.

* Kilbagie was the greatest distillery of spirituous liquors at that time in Scotland. There were then so few others, that more usquebæ was produced there, than at all the rest together. It was not of the best quality; but it was the cheapest to be had—and that was a sufficient reason for its being a favourite with Poosie Nansie's clubs.

OLD SCOTTISH MODE OF DISCOVERING MURDER.

In tracing the customs of our ancestors, we alternately pity their superstitious usages, and are amused at the credulity of the legislature, in continuing absurdities which would now be scoffed at even by children. There was a superstitious notion once exceedingly prevalent, regarding the discovery of the murderer by the touch of the dead body. In Germany, this experiment was called *bahr recht*, or the law of the bier, because, the murdered body being stretched upon a bier, the suspected person was obliged to put one hand upon the wound, and the other upon the mouth of the deceased, and, in that posture, call upon heaven to attest his innocence. If, during this ceremony, the blood gushed from the mouth, nose, or wound, a circumstance not unlikely to happen in the course of shifting or stirring the body, it was held sufficient evidence of the guilt of the party. The same singular kind of evidence was admitted in the Scottish Criminal Courts, at the short distance of little more than a century. Fountainhall relates a most dreadful instance of this perversion of jurisprudence The case was that of Philip Stanfield, tried upon the 30th November, 1687, for cursing his father, (which, by the Scottish law, is a capital crime, Act 1661, chap. 20,) and for being accessary to the murder. Sir James Stanfield, the deceased, was a person of melancholy temperament; so that, when his body was found in a pond near his own house of Newmilns, he was at first generally supposed to have drowned himself. But the body having been hastily buried, a report arose that he had been strangled by ruffians, instigated by his son Philip, a profligate youth, whom he had disinherited, on account of his gross debauchery. Upon this rumour, the Privy Council granted warrant

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to two surgeons of character, named Crawfurd and Muirhead, to dig up the body, and to report the state in which they should find it Philip was present on this occasion, and the evidence of both surgeons bears distinctly, that he stood for some time at a distance from the body of his parent; but, being called upon to assist in stretching out the corpse, he put his hand to the head, when the mouth and nostrils instantly gushed with blood. This circumstance, with the evident symptoms of terror and remorse exhibited by young Stanfield, seems to have had considerable weight with the jury, and is thus stated in the indictment:—"That his (the deceased's) nearest relatives being required to lift the corpse into the coffin, after it had been inspected, upon the said Philip Stanfied touching of it, (*according to God's usual mode of discovering murder,*) it bled afresh upon the said Philip; and that thereupon he let the body fall, and fled from it in the greatest consternation, crying, 'Lord have mercy upon me!'" The prisoner was found guilty of being accessory to the murder of his father, although there was little more than strong presumptions against him. It is true, he was at the same time separately convicted of the distinct crimes of having cursed his father, and drunk damnation to the monarchy and hierarchy. His sentence, which was to have his tongue cut out, and hand struck off, previous to his being hanged, was executed with the utmost rigour. He denied the murder with his last breath. "It is," says a contemporary judge, "a dark case of divination, to be remitted to the great day, whether he was guilty or innocent. Only, it is certain he was a bad youth, and may serve as a beacon to all profligate persons."

ORIGIN AND PROGRESS OF THE ART OF PRINTING.

The exceedingly ingenious invention of printing with metal types, on paper, was first brought to light in Germany, a country lying near the heart of the continent of Europe, and most remarkable in the history of mankind for having furnished not only this, but some other very important improvements in the mechanical arts. Until this invention took place, in the course of the fifteenth century, no nation in the world possessed a distinct knowledge of its neighbour, or was even acquainted with its own internal properties All communications had to be effected by means of writing, or by special messengers, and the knowledge gleaned by one generation ran always a risk of being lost to those which came after it, for want of a permanent medium of communication. To investigate properly, says Hansard, the origin of printing, it is necessary to carry our research to a period far more remote than that at which the art became applicable to the making of books. The early inhabitants of the earth would naturally desire to perpetuate their useful discoveries, as well as the important events of their time; and it may be therefore fairly presumed, that they had some mode of communicating their ideas to succeeding generations before the invention of an alphabet. The scanty traditions received concerning the antediluvians do not enable us to come to any determination relative to their proficiency in communicating the transactions of their time; whether, therefore, they employed stamps of any kind, or had any means whatever of transmitting knowledge, except by oral tradition, we have neither history nor relics to inform us. But that period which immediately followed the Deluge, and which some chronologers have termed the second age of the world, affords convincing proofs of the art of forming impressions being then practised; and most probably with a view to propagate science—to inculcate special facts—and as a general means of preserving to posterity certain useful memorials. Purposes such as these, it is reasonable to conclude, were contemplated by the ancient Chaldeans when they stamped, or printed, their tiles or bricks with various figures, hieroglyphics, or inscriptions. In some instances, these ancient specimens seemed to have been sun-baked; yet, for the most part, they appear kiln-burnt to a surprising degree of hardness, even to partial vitrification. Of such materials was built the original city, and celebrated tower of Babylon; and although a period of four thousand years has rolled away since the construction of the superb metropolis, whose name they bear still, even to the present day do the Babylonian bricks, which have supplied the antiquary and orientalist with so many curious subjects for reflection and discussion, continue to be found. The great city—"whose towers, whose temples, and whose palaces, were built with brick dried in the sun, or baked in the furnace," and whose walls were ornamented with animals modelled to resemble life, richly painted in their natural colours upon the bricks of which they were composed and into which they were afterwards burnt—what inexhaustible emotions must the spectacle of operose splendour presented by the real pile, at the zenith of its glory, have excited! And what must reasoning creatures think of human grandeur, looking now at the bald and desolate site that once boasted such a display of sumptuous edifices—such a gorgeous scene of civic ostentation!

[The foregoing is offered as the first of a series of short papers on the origin, progress, and *perfection* of the art of printing with metal types. This has been one of the noblest inventions of man, and, I think, by far too little is generally known of it. The mass of curious and instructive particulars before me on this interesting subject is very considerable, consisting of the very best works and papers on printing. I design to trace the invention through its preliminary stages—to describe how it was finally brought to light—the first books printed—the earliest foreign and British printers—the original and improved presses—the modern improvements—ending with what may be called the sublimation of the art, in printing sheets by steam at the rate of some thousands in the hour. In the latter department I shall be assisted by an intelligent practical printer.]

LADY JEAN.

Concluded from No. I.

When the ceremony was concluded, and both the clergymen and the witnesses had been satisfied and dismissed, the lovers left the house, with the design of walking towards into the city. In conformity to a previous arrangement, Lady Jean walked first, like a lady of quality, and Richard followed closely behind, with the dress and deportment of her servant. Her ladyship was dressed in her finest suit, and adorned with her finest jewels, all which she had brought from Cumbernauld on purpose, in a mail or leathern trunk—for such was the name then given to the convenience now entitled a portmanteau. Her step was light, and her bearing gay, as she moved along,—not on account of the success which had attended her expedition, or her satisfaction in being now united to the man of her choice, but because she anticipated the highest pleasure in the sight of a place whereof she had heard such wonderful stories, and from a participation in whose delights she had been so long withheld. Like all persons educated in the country, she had been regaled in her infancy with magnificent descriptions of the capital,—of its buildings that seemed to mingle with the clouds,—its shops, which apparently contained more wealth than all the world beside,—of its paved streets, (for paved streets were then wonders in Scotland,)—and above all of the grand folks who thronged its Highgates, its Canongates, and its Cowgates—people whose lives seemed a perpetual holyday, whose attire was ever new, and who all lived in their several palaces. Though, of course, Edinburgh had then little to boast of, the country people who occasionally visited it did not regard it with less admiration than that with which the peasantry of our own day may be supposed to view it now that it is something so very different. It was then, as well as now, the capital of the country, and, as such, bore the same disproportion in point of magnificence to inferior towns, and to the country in general. In one respect, it was superior to what it is at the present day,—namely, in being the seat of government and of a court. Lady Jean had often heard all its glorious peculiarities described by her sisters, who, moreover, sometimes took occasion to colour the picture too highly, in order to raise her envy, and make themselves appear great in their alliance and association with so much greatness. She was, therefore, prepared to see a scene of the utmost splendour—a scene in which nothing horrible or paltry mingled, but which was altogether calculated to awe or to delight the senses.

Her ladyship was destined to be disappointed at the commencement, at least, of her acquaintance with the city. The first remarkable object which struck her eye, after leaving the inn, was the high *bow*, or arch, of the gate called the West Port. In this itself there was nothing worthy of particular attention, and she rather directed her eyes through the opening beneath, which half disclosed a wide space beyond, apparently crowded with people. But when she came close up to the gate and cast, before passing, a last glance at the arch, she shuddered at the sight then presented to her eyes. On the very pinnacle of the arch was stuck the ghastly and weatherworn remains of a human head, the features of which, half flesh half bone, were shaded and rendered still more indistinctly horrible by the long dark hair, which hung in meagre tresses around them. "Oh, Richard, Richard!" she exclaimed, stopping and turning round, "what is that dreadful looking thing?"—"That, madam," said Richard, without any emotion, "is the broken remnant of a west country preacher, spiked up there to warn his countrymen who may approach this port, against doing any thing to incur the fate which has overtaken himself. Methinks he has preached to small purpose, for yonder stands the gallows, ready, I suppose, to bring him some brother in affliction."—"Horrible!" exclaimed Lady Jean; "and is this really the fine town of Edinburgh, where I was taught to expect so many grand sights? I thought it was just one universal palace, and it turns out to be a great charnel-house!"—"It is indeed more like that than any thing else at times," said Richard; "but, my dear Lady Jean, you are not going to start at this bugbear, which the very children, you see, do not heed in passing."—"Indeed I think, Richard," answered her ladyship, "if Edinburgh is to be all like this, it would be just as good to turn back at once, and postpone our visit till better times."—"But it is not all like this," replied Richard; "I assure you it is not. For Heaven's sake, my lady, move on. The people are beginning to stare at us. You shall soon see grand sights enough, if we were once fairly out of this place. Make for the opposite corner of the Grassmarket, and ascend the street to the left of that horrible gibbet. We may yet get past it before the criminals are produced."

Thus admonished, Lady Jean passed, not without a shudder, under the dreadful arch, and entered the spacious oblong square called the Grassmarket. This place was crowded at the west end with rustics engaged in all the bustle of a grain and cattle market, and at the eastern and most distant extremity with a mob of idlers who had gathered around the gibbet in order to witness the awful ceremony that was about to take place. The crowd, which was scarcely so dense as that which attends the rarer scene of a modern execution, made way on both sides for Lady Jean as she moved along; and wherever she went she left behind her a *wake*, as it were, of admiration and confusion So exquisite and so new a beauty, so splendid a suit of female attire, and such a stout and handsome attendant—these were all alike calculated to inspire reverence in the minds of the beholders. Her carriage at the same time was so steady and so graceful, that no one could be so rude as to interrupt or disturb it. The people, therefore, parted when she approached, and left a free passage for her on all sides, as if she had been an angel or a spirit come to walk amidst a mortal crowd, and whose person could not be touched, and might scarcely be beheld—whose motions were not to be interfered with by those among whom she chose to walk—but who was to be received with prostration of spirit, and permitted to depart as she had come, unquestioned and unapproached. In traversing the Grassmarket, two or three young coxcombs, with voluminous wigs, short cloaks, rapiers, and rose-knots at their knees and shoes, who, on observing her at a distance, had prepared to treat her with a condescending stare, fell back, awed and confounded, at her near approach, and spent the gaze, perhaps, upon the humbler mark of her follower, or upon vacancy.

Having at length passed the gibbet, Lady Jean began to ascend the steep and tortuous street denominated the West Bow She had hitherto been unable to direct any attention to what she was most anxious to behold,—the scenic wonders of the capital. But having now got clear of the crowd, and no longer fearing to see the gallows, she ventured to lift up her eyes and look around. The tallness and massiveness of the buildings, some of which bore the cross of the Knights Templars on their pinnacles, while others seemed to be surmounted or overtopped by still taller edifices beyond, impressed her imagination; and the effect was rendered still more striking by the countless human figures which crowded the windows, and even the roofs of the houses, all alike bending their attention, as she thought, towards herself. The scene before her looked like an amphitheatre, filled with spectators, while she and Richard seemed as the objects upon the arena. The thought caused her to hurry on, and she soon found herself in a great measure screened from observation by the overhanging projections of the narrower part of the West Bow, which she now entered With slow and difficult, but stately and graceful steps, she then proceeded, till she reached the upper angle of the street, where a novel and unexpected scene awaited her. A sound like that of rushing waters seemed first to proceed from the part of the street still concealed from her view, and presently appeared round the angle, the first rank of an impetuous crowd, who, rushing downward with prodigious force, would certainly have overwhelmed her delicate form, had she not dexterously avoided them, by stepping aside upon a projecting stair, to which Richard also sprung, just in time to save himself from a similar fate. From this place of safety, which was not without its own crowd of children, women, and sage-looking elderly mechanics, with Kilmarnock cowls, both, in the next moment saw the massive mob rush past, like the first wave of a flood bearing either *along* or *down* every thing that came in their way Immediately after, but at a more deliberate pace, followed a procession of figures, which struck the heart of Lady Jean with as heavy a sense of sorrow as the crowd had just impressed with terror and surprise. First came a small company of the veterans of the city guard, some of whom had perhaps figured in the campaigns of Middleton and Montrose, and whose bronzed inflexible faces bore on this melancholy occasion precisely the same expression which they ordinarily exhibited on the joyful one of attending the magistrates at the drinking of the king's health on the 29th of May. Behind these, and encircled by some other soldiers of the same band, appeared two figures of a different sort. One of them was a young looking, but pale and woe-worn man, the impressive wretchedness of whose appearance was strikingly increased by the ghastly dress which he wore. He was attired from head to foot in a white shroud, such as was sometimes worn in Scotland by criminals at the gallows, but which was, in the present instance, partly assumed as a badge of innocence. The excessive whiteness and emaciation of his countenance suited well with this dismal apparel, and, with the wild enthusiasm that kindled in his eyes, gave an almost supernatural effect to the whole scene, which rather resembled a pageant of the dead than a procession of earthly men. He was the only criminal; the person who walked by his side, and occasionally supported his steps, being—as the crowd whispered around, with many a varied expression of sympathy—his father. The old man had the air of a devout Presbyterian, with harsh, intelligent features, and a dress which bespoke his being a countryman of the lower rank. According to the report of the bystanders, he had educated this, his only son, for the unfortunate Church of Scotland, and now attended him to the fate which his talents and violent temperament had conspired to draw down upon his head. If he ever felt any pride in the popular admiration with which his son was honoured, no traces of such a sentiment now appeared. On the contrary, he seemed humbled to the very earth with sorrow; and though he had perhaps contemplated the issue now about to take place, with no small portion of satisfaction, so long as it was at a distance and uncertain, the feelings of a father had evidently proved too much for his fortitude, when the event approached in all its dreadful reality. The emotions perceptible in that rough and rigid countenance were the more striking, as being so much at variance with its natural and characteristic expression; and the tear which gathered in his eye excited the greater commiseration, in so far as it seemed a stranger there. But the hero and heroine of our tale had little time to make observations on this piteous scene, for the train passed quickly on, and was soon beyond their sight When it was gone, the people of the Bow, who seemed accustomed to such sights, uttered various expressions of pity, indignation, and horror, according to their respective feelings, and then slowly retired to their dens in the stairs and booths which lined the whole of this ancient and singular street.

Lady Jean, whose beautiful eyes were suffused with tears at beholding so melancholy a spectacle, was then admonished by her attendant to proceed. With a heart deadened to all sensations of wonder and delight, she moved forward, and was soon ushered into the place called the Lawnmarket,

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then perhaps the most fashionable district in Edinburgh, but the grandeur and spaciousness of which she beheld al most without admiration The scene here was, however much gayer, and approached more nearly to her splendid preconceptions of the capital than any she had yet seen. The shops were, in her estimation, very fine, and some of the people on the street were of that noble description of which she had believed all inhabitants of cities to be. There was no crowd on the street, which, therefore, afforded room for a better display of her stately and beautiful person; and as she walked steadily onwards, still *ushed* (for such was then the phrase) by her handsome and noble-looking attendant, a greater degree of admiration was excited amongst the gay idlers whom she passed, than even that which marked her progress through the humbler crowd of the Grassmarket. Various noblemen, in passing towards their homes in the Castle Hill, lifted their feathered hats and bowed profoundly to the lovely vision; and one or two magnificent dames, sweeping along with their long silk trains, borne up by livery-men, stared at or eyed askance the charms which threw their own so completely into shade. By the time Lady Jean arrived at the bottom of the Lawn-market, that is to say, where it was partially closed up by the Tolbooth, she had in a great measure recovered her spirits, and found herself prepared to enjoy the sight of the public buildings, which were so thickly clustered together at this central part of the city. She was directed by Richard to pass along the narrow road which then led between the houses and the Tolbooth on the south, and which, being continued by a still narrower passage skirting the west end of St. Giles's church, formed the western approach to the Parliament Close. Obeying his guidance in this tortuous passage, she soon found herself at the opening of the square space, so styled on account of its being closed on more than one side by the meeting-place of the legislative assembly of Scotland. Here a splendid scene awaited her. The whole square was filled with the members of the Scottish Parliament, barons and commons, who had just left the house in which they sat together,—with ladies, who on days of unusual ceremony were allowed to attend the house,—and with horses richly-caparisoned, and covered with gold embroidered foot-cloths, some of which were mounted by their owners, while others were held in readiness by footmen. All was bustle and magnificence. Noblemen and gentlemen in splendid attire threaded the crowd in search of their horses; ladies tripped after them with timid and careful steps, endeavouring, by all in their power, to avoid contact with such objects as were calculated to injure their fineries; grooms strode heavily about, and more nimble lacqueys jumped everywhere, here and there, some of them as drunk as the Parliament Close claret could make them, but all intent on doing the duties of attendance and respect to their masters. Some smart and well-dressed young gentlemen were arranging their cloaks and swords, and preparing to leave the square on foot, by the passage which had given entry to Master Richard and Lady Jean.

At sight of our heroine, most of these gallants stood still in admiration, and one of them, with the trained assurance of a rake, observing her to be beautiful, a stranger, and not too well protected, accosted her in a strain of language which caused her at once to blush and tremble. Richard's brow reddened with anger, as he hesitated not a moment in stepping up and telling the offender to leave the lady alone, on pain of certain consequences which might not prove agreeable. "And who are you, my brave fellow?" said the youth, with bold assurance. "Sirrah!" exclaimed Richard, so indignant as to forget himself, "I am that lady's husband—her servant, I mean;" and here he stopped short in some confusion "Admirable!" exclaimed the other. "Ha! ha! ha! ha! Here, Sirs, is a lady lacquey, who does not know whether he is his mistress's servant or her husband. Let us give him up to the Town-guard to see whether the black-hole will make him remember the real state of the case. So saying, he attempted to push Richard aside and take hold of the lady. But he had not time to touch her garments with so much as a finger, before her protector had a rapier flourishing in his eyes, and threatened him with instant death, unless he desisted from his profane purpose. At sight of the bright steel, he stepped back one or two paces, drew his own sword, and was preparing to fight, when one of his more grave associates called out, "For shame, Rollo!—with a lady's lacquey, too, and in the presence of the Duke and Duchess! I see their Royal Highnesses, already alarmed, are inquiring the cause of the disturbance." It was even as this gentleman said, and presently came up to the scene of contention some of the most distinguished personages in the crowd, one of whom demanded from the parties an explanation of so disgraceful an occurrence. "Why, here is a fellow, my lord," answered Rollo, "who says he is the husband of a lady whom he attends as a liveryman, and a lady, too, the bonniest, I dare say, that has been seen in Scotland since the days of Queen Magdalen!"—"And what matters it to you," said the inquirer, who seemed to be a Judge of the Session, "in what relation this man stands to his lady? Let the parties both come forward, and tell their ain tale. May it please your Royal Highness," he continued, addressing a very grave dignitary who sat on horseback behind him, as stiff and formal as a sign-post, "to hear the *declaratur* of thir twa strange incomers—But see—see—what is the matter with Lord Wigton?" he added, pointing to an aged personage on horseback, who had just pushed forward, and seemed about to faint, and fall from his horse The person alluded to, at sight of his daughter in this unexpected place, was, in reality, confounded, and it was some time before he mastered voice enough to ejaculate, "O, Jean, Jean! what's this ye've been about? or what has brocht you to Edinburgh?"—"And Lord have a care o' us!" exclaimed at this juncture another venerable peer, who had just come up, "what has brocht my sonsie son, Ritchie Livingstone, to Edinburgh, when he should have been fechtin the Dutch by this time in Pennsylvania?" The two lovers, thus recognized by their respective parents, stood with downcast looks, and perfectly silent, while all was buzz and confusion in the brilliant circle around them; for the parties concerned were not more surprised at the aspect of their affairs, than were all the rest at the beauty of the far-famed, but hitherto unseen, Lady Jean Fleming The Earl of Linlithgow, Richard's father, was the first to speak aloud, after the general astonishment had for some time subsided; and this he did in a laconic though important query, which he couched in the simple words, "Are you married, bairns?" "Yes, dearest father," said his son, gathering courage, and coming close up to his saddle-bow; "and I beseech you to extricate Lady Jean and me from this crowd, and I shall tell you all when we are alone."—"A pretty man ye are, truly," said the old man, who never took any thing very seriously to heart, "to be staying at hame, and getting yourself married, all the time you should have been abroad, winning honour and wealth, as your gallant grand-uncle did wi' Gustavus i' the threttie! Hooever, since better mayna be, I maun try and console my Lord Wigton, who, I doot, has the worst o' the bargain, ye ne'er-do-weel!" He then went up to Lady Jean's father, shook him by the hand, and said, "that though they had been made relations against their wills, he hoped they would continue good friends. The young people," he observed, "are no that ill-matched; and it is not the first time that the Flemings and the Livingstones have melled together, as witness the blythe marriage of the Queen's Marie to Lord Fleming, in the feifteen-saxty five. At any rate, my lord, let us put a good face on the matter, afore they glowring gentles, and whipper-snapper Duchesses. I'll get horses for the two, and they'll join the ridin' down the street; and de'il ha'e me, if Lady Jean disna outshine them, the hale o' them!"—"My Lord Linlithgow," responded the graver and more implacable Earl of Wigton, "it may set you to take this matter blythely; but, let me tell you, it's a muckle mair serious affair for me. What think ye am I to do wi' Kate and Grizzy noo."—"Hoot, toot, my Lord," said Linlithgow, with a sly smile, "their chance is as gude as ever it was, I assure you, and sae will every body think that kens them. I *maun* ca' horses though, or the young folk will be ridden ower, afore ever they do mair gude, by thae rampaugin young men." So saying, and taking Lord Wigton's moody silence for assent, he proceeded to cry to his servants for the best pair of horses they could get; and these being speedily procured, Lord Richard and his bride were requested to mount; after which they were formally introduced to the gracious notice of the Duke and Duchess of York, and the Princess Anne, who happened to attend Parliament on this the last day of its session, when it was customary for all the members to ride both to and from the House in an orderly cavalcade The order was now given to proceed, and the lovers were soon relieved, in a great measure, from the embarrassing notice of the crowd, by assuming a particular place in the procession, and finding themselves confounded with more than three hundred equally splendid figures. As the pageant, however, moved down the High Street, in a continuous and open line, it was impossible not to distinguish the singular loveliness of Lady Jean, and the gallant carriage of her husband, from all the rest. Accordingly, the very trained bands and city guard, who lined the street, and who were, in general, quite as insensible to the splendours of *the Riding*, as are the musicians in a modern orchestra to the wonders of a melo-drama in its fortieth night,—even *they* perceived and admired the graces of the young couple, whom they could not help gazing after with a stupid and lingering delight. From the windows, too, and the *stair-heads*, their beauty was well observed, and amply conjectured and commented on; while many a young cavalier endeavoured, by all sorts of pretences, to find occasion to break the order of the cavalcade, and get himself haply placed nearer to the exquisite figure, of which he had got just one killing glance in the square. Slowly and majestically the brilliant train paced down the great street of Edinburgh,—the acclamations of the multitude ceaselessly expressing the delight which the people of Scotland felt in this sensible type and emblem of their ancient independence. At length they reached the court-yard of Holyrood-house, where the Duke and Duchess invited the whole assemblage to a ball, which they designed to give that evening in the hall of the palace; after which, all departed to their respective residences throughout the town, Lords Wigton and Linlithgow taking their young friends under their immediate protection, and seeking the residence of the former nobleman, a little way up the Canongate. In riding thither, the lovers had leisure to explain to their parents the singular circumstances of their union, and address enough to obtain unqualified forgiveness for their imprudence. On alighting at Lord Wigton's house, Lady Jean found her sisters confined to their rooms with headachs, or some such serious indisposition, and in the utmost dejection on account of having been thereby withheld from the Riding of the Parliament. Their spirits, as may be supposed, were not much elevated, when, on coming forth in dishabille to welcome their sister, they found she had had the good fortune to be married before them Their ill luck was, however, irremediable; and so, making a merit of submitting to it, they condescended to be rather agreeable during the dinner and the afternoon. It was not long before all parties were perfectly reconciled to what had taken place; and by the time it was necessary to dress for the ball, the elder young ladies declared themselves so much recovered as to be able to accompany their happy sister. The Earl of Linlithgow and his son then sent a servant for proper dresses, and prepared themselves for the occasion without leaving the house. When all were ready, a number of chairs were called to transport their dainty persons down the street The news of Lady Jean's arrival, and of her marriage, having now spread abroad, the court in front of the house, the alley, and even the open street, were crowded with people of all ranks, anxious to catch a passing glimpse of the heroine of so strange a tale. As her chair was carried along, a buzz of admiration from all who were so happy as to be near it, marked its progress. Happy, too, was the gentleman who had the good luck to be near her chair as it was set down at the palace gate, and assist her in stepping from it upon the lighted pavement From the outer gate, along the piazza of the inner court, and all the way up the broad staircase to the illuminated hall, two rows of noblemen and gentlemen formed a brilliant avenue, as she passed along, while an hundred plumed caps were doffed in honour of so much beauty, and as many youthful eyes glanced bright with satisfaction at beholding it. The object of all this attention tripped modestly along in the hand of the Earl of Linlithgow, acknowledging, with many a graceful flexure and undulation of person, the compliments of the spectators. At length the company entered the spacious and splendid room in which the ball was to be held. At the extremity opposite to the entry, upon an elevated platform, sat the three royal personages, all of whom, on Lady Jean's introduction, rose and came forward to welcome her and her husband to the entertainments of Holyrood, and to hope that her ladyship would often adorn their circle. In a short time the dancing commenced; and amidst all the ladies who exhibited their charms and their magnificent attire in that captivating exercise, who was, either in person or dress, half so brilliant as Lady Jean?

A Derbyshire Tale.—About twenty or thirty years since, a gentleman named Webster, who lived in the Woodlands, a wild uncultivated barren range of hills in Derbyshire, bordering upon the confines of Yorkshire, had occasion to go from home. The family, besides himself, consisted of the servant man, a young girl, and the housekeeper At his departure he gave his man a strict charge to remain in the house, along with the females, and not on any account to absent himself at night, until his return. This the man promised to do; and Mr. Webster proceeded on his journey. At night, however, the man went out, notwithstanding all the earnest entreaties and remonstrances of the housekeeper to the contrary, and not coming in, she and the servant girl at the usual time went to bed. Sometime in the night, they were awakened by a loud knocking at the door. The housekeeper got up, went down stairs, and inquired who was there, and what was their business? She was informed that a friend of Mr. Webster being benighted, and the night wet and stormy, requested a night's lodging. She forthwith gave him admittance, roused up the fire, led his horse into the stable, and then returned to provide something to eat for her guest, of which he partook, and was then shown to his chamber. On returning to the kitchen, she took up his greatcoat in order to dry it, when perceiving it to be, as she thought, very heavy, curiosity prompted her to examine the pockets, in which she found a brace of loaded pistols, and their own large carving knife! Thunderstruck by this discovery, she immediately perceived what sort of a guest she had to deal with, and his intentions. However, summoning up all her courage and resolution, she proceeded softly up stairs, and, with a rope, fastened, as well as she could, the door of the room in which the villain was; then went down, and in great perturbation of mind awaited the event. Shortly after a man came to the window, and in a low, but distinct tone of voice, said, "are you ready?" She grasped one of the pistols with a desperate resolution—presented it to his face—and fired! The report of the pistol alarmed the villain above, who attempted to get out of the room, but was stayed in his purpose by her saying, "Villain, if you open the door, you are a dead man." She then sent the servant girl for assistance, while she remained, with the other pistol in her hand, guarding the chamber door. When help arrived, the villain was taken into custody; and, on searching without, they found the servant man shot dead Another villain who was taken shortly after, met with his deserts; and the housekeeper, who had acted with such fidelity and such unparalleled intrepidity, was soon after united to Mr. Webster.

BIOGRAPHIC SKETCHES.

JAMES FERGUSON.

In the first number of the Journal, I presented a sketch of the life and character of our late distinguished townsman, Dr. Adam, in whom *genius* was early manifested, and ultimately rewarded. I may now offer a similar biographic sketch of our illustrious countryman, James Ferguson, the Astronomer. These, I hold up to my juvenile friends as patterns truly worthy of their imitation; and fully impressed with the conviction that such sketches may be found beneficial, I shall, in the language of the author of a work entitled "the Pursuit of Knowledge under Difficulties," continue to select, from the records of philosophy, literature, and art, in all ages and countries, a body of examples, to shew how the most unpropitious circumstances have been unable to conquer an ardent desire for the acquisition of knowledge. Every man has difficulties to encounter in this pursuit; and, therefore, every man is interested in learning what are the real hindrances which have opposed themselves to the progress of some of the most distinguished persons, and how those obstacles have been surmounted. The love of knowledge will, of itself, do a great deal towards its acquisition; and if it exist with that force and constancy which it exhibits in the characters of all truly great men, it will induce that ardent but humble spirit of observation and inquiry, without which there can be no success.

"Among self-educated men there are few who claim more of our admiration than the celebrated James Ferguson. If ever any one was literally his own instructor in the very elements of knowledge, it was he. Acquisitions that have scarcely in any other case, and, probably, never by one so young, been made without the assistance either of books or a living teacher, were the discoveries of his solitary and almost illiterate boyhood. There are

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few more interesting narratives in any language than the account which Ferguson himself has given of his early history. He was born in the year 1710, a few miles from the village of Keith, in Banffshire; his parents, as he tells us, being in the humblest condition of life, (for his father was merely a day-labourer), but religious and honest. It was his father's practice to teach his children himself to read and write, as they successively reached what he deemed the proper age; but James was too impatient to wait till his regular turn came. While his father was teaching one of his elder brothers, James was secretly occupied in listening to what was going on; and, as soon as he was left alone, used to get hold of the book, and work hard in endeavouring to master the lesson which he had thus heard gone over. Being ashamed, as he says, to let his father know what he was about, he was wont to apply to an old woman who lived in a neighbouring cottage to solve the difficulties. In this way he actually learned to read tolerably well before his father had any suspicion that he knew his letters. His father, at last, very much to his surprise, detected him one day reading by himself, and thus found out his secret.

"When he was about seven or eight years of age, a simple incident occurred which seems to have given his mind its first bias to what became afterwards its favourite kind of pursuit. The roof of the cottage having partially fallen in, his father, in order to raise it again, applied to it a beam, resting on a prop in the manner of a lever, and was thus enabled, with comparative ease, to produce what seemed to his son quite a stupendous effect. The circumstance set our young philosopher thinking; and, after a while, it struck him that his father, in using the beam, had applied his strength to its extremity, and this, he immediately concluded, was, probably, an important circumstance in the matter. He proceeded to verify his notion by experiment; and having made several levers, which he called bars, soon not only found that he was right in his conjecture, as to the importance of applying the moving force at the point most distant from the fulcrum, but discovered the rule, or law of the machine, namely, that the effect of any form or weight made to bear upon it is always exactly proportioned to the distance of the point on which it rests from the fulcrum. 'I then,' says he, 'thought that it was a great pity that by means of this bar, a weight could be raised but a very little way. On this, I soon imagined that, by pulling round a wheel, the weight might be raised to any height, by tying a rope to the weight, and winding the rope round the axle of the wheel; and that the power gained must be just as great as the wheel was broader than the axle was thick; and found it to be exactly so, by hanging one weight to a rope put round the wheel, and another to the rope that coiled round the axle.' The child had thus, it will be observed, actually discovered two of the most important elementary truths in mechanics,—the lever, and the wheel and axle; he afterwards hit upon others; and, all the while, he had not only possessed neither book nor teacher to assist him, but was without any other tools than a simple turning lathe of his father's, and a little knife wherewith to fashion his blocks and wheels, and the other contrivances he needed for his experiments. After having made his discoveries, however, he next, he tells up, proceeded to write an account of them; thinking his little work, which contained sketches of the different machines drawn with a pen, to be the first treatise ever composed of the sort. When, some time after, a gentleman shewed him the whole in a printed book, although he found that he had been anticipated in his inventions, he was much pleased, as he was well entitled to be, on thus perceiving that his unaided genius had already carried him so far into what was acknowledged to be the region of true philosophy.

"It is a ludicrous blunder that the French astronomer, Lalande, makes, in speaking of Ferguson, when he designates him, as '*Berger au Roi d'Angleterre en Ecosse*;' the King of England's Shepherd for Scotland. He had no claim to this pompous title; but it is true that he spent some of his early years as a keeper of sheep, though in the employment not of the state, but of a small farmer in the neighbourhood of his native place. He was sent to this occupation, he tells us, as being of weak body; and while his flock was feeding around him, he used to busy himself in making models of mills, spinning-wheels, &c., during the day, and in studying the stars at night like his predecessors of Chaldea. When a little older, he went into the service of another farmer, a respectable man called James Glashan, whose name well deserves to be remembered. After the labours of the day, young Ferguson used to go at night to the fields, with a blanket about him, and a lighted candle, and there, laying himself down on his back, pursued, for long hours, his observations on the heavenly bodies. 'I used to stretch,' says he, 'a thread, with small beads on it, at arm's length, between my eye and the stars, sliding the beads upon it, till they hid such and such stars from my eye, in order to take their apparent distances from one another; and then laying the thread down on a paper, I marked the stars thereon by the beads.' 'My master,' he adds, 'at first laughed at me; but when I explained my meaning to him, he encouraged me to go on; and, that I might make fair copies in the day-time of what I had done in the night, he often worked for me himself. I shall always have a respect for the memory of that man. Having been employed by his master to carry a message to Mr. Gilchrist, the minister of Keith, he took with him the drawings he had been making, and shewed them to that gentleman. Mr. Gilchrist, upon this, put a map into his hands, and having supplied him with compasses, ruler, pens, ink, and paper, desired him to take it home with him, and bring back a copy of it. 'For this pleasant employment,' says he, 'my master gave me more time than I could reasonably expect, and often took the threshing-flail out of my hands, and worked himself, while I sat by him in the barn, busy with my compasses, ruler, and pen.' This is a beautiful, we may well say, and even a touching picture,—the good man so generously appreciating the worth of knowledge and genius, that, although the master, he voluntarily exchanges situations with his servant, and insists upon doing the work that must be done, himself, in order that the latter may give his more precious talents to their more appropriate vocation. We know not that there is on record an act of homage to science and learning more honourable to the author.

"Having finished his map, Ferguson carried it to Mr. Gilchrist's, and there he met Mr. Grant of Achoynamey, who offered to take him into his house, and make his butler give him lessons. 'I told Squire Grant,' says he, 'that I should rejoice to be at his house, as soon as the time was expired for which I was engaged with my present master. He very politely offered to put one in my place, but this I declined.' When the period in question arrived, accordingly, he went to Mr. Grant's, being now in his twentieth year. Here he found both a good friend and a very extraordinary man in Cantley, the butler, who had first fixed his attention, by a sun-dial which he happened to be engaged in painting on the village schoolhouse, as Ferguson was passing along the road, on his second visit to Mr. Gilchrist. Dialling, however, was only one of the many accomplishments of this learned butler, who, Ferguson assures us, was profoundly conversant both with arithmetic and mathematics; played on every known musical instrument except the harp; understood Latin, French, and Greek; and could let blood, and prescribe for diseases. These multifarious attainments he owed, we are told, entirely to himself and to nature; on which account, Ferguson designates him 'God Almighty's scholar.'

"From this person Ferguson received instructions in Decimal Fractions and Algebra, having already made himself master of Vulgar Arithmetic, by the assistance of books. Just as he was about, however, to begin Geometry, Cantley left his place for another in the establishment of the Earl of Fife, and his pupil thereupon determined to return home to his father.

"Cantley, on parting with him, had made him a present of a copy of Gorton's Geographical Grammar. The book contains a description of an artificial globe, which is not, however, illustrated by any figure. Nevertheless, 'from this description,' says Ferguson, 'I made a globe in three weeks at my father's, having turned the ball thereof out of a piece of wood; which ball I covered with paper, and delineated a map of the world upon it; made the meridian ring and horizon of wood, covered them with paper and graduated them; and was happy to find that, by my globe, (which was the first I ever saw,) could solve the problems.'

"For some time after this, he was very unfortunate. Finding that it would not do to remain idle at home, he engaged in the service of a miller in the neighbourhood, who, feeling, probably, that he could trust to the honesty and capacity of his servant, soon began to spend all his own time in the alehouse, and to leave poor Ferguson at home, not only with every thing to do, but with very frequently, nothing to eat. A little oatmeal, mixed with cold water, was often, he tells us, all he was allowed. Yet in this situation he remained a year, and then returned to his father's very much the weaker for his fasting. His next master was a Dr. Young, who having induced him to enter his service by a promise to instruct him in medicine, not only broke his engagement as to this point, but used him in other respects so tyrannically, that, although engaged for half a year, he found he could not remain beyond the first quarter; at the expiration of which, accordingly, he came away without receiving any wages, having 'wrought for the last fortnight,' says he, 'as much as possible with one hand and arm, when I could not lift the other from my side.' This was in consequence of a severe hurt he had received, which the doctor was too busy to look to, and by which he was confined to his bed for two months after his return home.

"Reduced as he was, however, by exhaustion and actual pain, he could not be idle. 'In order,' says he to amuse myself in this low state, I made a wooden clock, the frame of which was also of wood, and it kept time pretty well. The bell on which the hammer struck the hours, was the neck of a broken bottle.' A short time after this, when he had recovered his health, he gave a still more extraordinary proof of his ingenuity, and the fertility of his resources for mechanical invention, by actually constructing a timepiece, or watch, moved by a spring. But we must allow him to give the history of this matter in his own words.

"'Having, then,' he says, 'no idea how any timepiece could go but by a weight and a line, I wondered how a watch could go in all positions; and was sorry that I had never thought of asking Mr. Cantley, who could very easily have informed me. But happening one day to see a gentleman ride by my father's house, (which was close by a public road,) I asked him what o'clock it then was? He looked at his watch and told me. As he did that with so much good nature, I begged of him to shew me the inside of his watch; and, though he was an entire stranger, he immediately opened the watch, and put it into my hands. I saw the spring-box with part of the chain round it; and asked him what it was that made the box turn round. He told me that it was turned round by a steel spring within it. Having, then, never seen any other spring than that of my father's gun-lock, I asked how a spring within a box could turn the box so often round as to wind all the chain upon it? He answered, that the spring was long and thin; that one end of it was fastened to the axis of the box, and the other end to the inside of the box; that the axis was fixed, and the box was loose upon it. I told him that I did not yet thoroughly understand the matter. "Well, my lad," says he, "take a long thin piece of whalebone, hold one end of it fast between your finger and thumb, and wind it round your finger; it will then endeavour to unwind itself; and if you fix the other end of it to the inside of a small hoop, and leave it to itself, it will turn the hoop round and round, and wind up a thread tied to the outside of the hoop." I thanked the gentleman, and told him that I understood the thing very well. I then tried to make a watch with wooden wheels and made the spring of whalebone; but found that I could not make the wheel go when the balance was put on, because the teeth of the wheels were rather too weak to bear the force of a spring sufficient to move the balance, although the wheels would run fast enough when the balance was taken off. I enclosed the whole in a wooden case, very little bigger than a breakfast tea-cup; but a clumsy neighbour one day looking at my watch, happened to let it fall, and, turning hastily about to pick it up, set his foot upon it, and crushed it all to pieces; which so provoked my father, that he was almost ready to beat the man, and discouraged me so much that I never attempted to make such another machine again, especially as I was thoroughly convinced I could never make one that would be of any real use.'

"What a vivid picture is this of an ingenious mind thirsting for knowledge! and who is there, too, that does not envy the pleasure that must have been felt by the courteous and intelligent stranger by whom the young mechanician was carried over his first great difficulty, if he ever chanced to learn how greatly his unknown questioner had profited from their brief interview! That stranger might probably have read the above narrative, as given to the world by Ferguson, after the talents which this little incident probably contributed to develop, had raised him from his obscurity to a distinguished place among the philosophers of his age; and if he did know this, he must have felt that encouragement in well-doing which a benevolent man may always gather, either from the positive effects of acts of kindness upon others, or their influence upon his own heart. Civility, charity, generosity, may sometimes meet an ill return, but one person *must* be benefited by their exercise: the kind heart has its own abundant reward, whatever be the gratitude of others. The case of Ferguson shews that the seed does not always fall on stony ground. It may appear somewhat absurd to dwell upon the benefit of a slight civility, which cost, at most, but a few minutes of attention; but it is really important that those who are easy in the world—who have all the advantages of wealth and knowledge at their command—should feel of how much value is the slightest encouragement and assistance to those who are toiling up the steep of emulation. Too often 'the scoff of pride' is superadded to the 'bar of poverty;' and thus it is that many a one of the best talents and the most generous feelings

Has sunk into the grave, unpitied and unknown,

because the wealthy and powerful have never understood the value of a helping hand to him who is struggling with fortune."—*Library of Entertaining Knowledge.*

[Such is the history of Ferguson's struggles in the early part of his life. He afterwards applied himself, apparently without the least effort, to the business of portrait-painting, by which he subsisted for several years in Edinburgh and London; till finally his philosophical powers obtained the notice and patronage which they deserved, and he stood forth one of the first men of the age. His numerous publications are well known, and have been translated into most of the European languages. He died in 1776, having, for some years, enjoyed a pension from George III., whose beneficence to men of science has conferred great lustre upon his reign as well as upon his own private character.]

A SEA FIGHT BETWEEN THE BRITISH AND FRENCH.

On the 30th of December, 1794, the British twelve-pounder, thirty-two gun frigate, Blanche, Captain Robert Faulknor, cruising off the island of Désirade, one of the dependencies of Guadeloupe, and in French possession, chased a large French armed schooner, under the fort at the bottom of the bay. This being accomplished, "the Blanche, at about 6, P. M., steered straight for Pointe-à-Pitre, and, on arriving within four miles of the port, lay to for the night. On the next day, the 4th, at daybreak, the Blanche discovered the Pique lying at anchor just outside of the harbour. At about 8 h. 30 m. the Blanche made sail to meet the French ship and schooner, until nearly within gunshot of Fort Fleur-d'Epée; when finding the Pique apparently disinclined to come out from the batteries, the Blanche, who had hove to, made sail to board a schooner running down along Grande-terre. At this time Pointe-à-Pitre bore from the Blanche northwest, distant two leagues, and the French frigate north-north-west, distant three miles.

At half-past noon, the Pique filled and made sail towards the Blanche. At 2, P. M. the Pique crossed the Blanche on the oppsite tack, and, hoisting French colours, fired four shots at her. This challenge, as it might be considered, the British frigate answered, by firing a shot to windward. The battery at Gosier also fired two shots; but they, like those of the frigate, fell short. At 2 h. 30 m. P.M., finding that the Pique had tacked, and was standing towards her, the Blanche shortened sail for the French frigate to come up; but at 3 h. 30 m. P. M., the latter tacked and stood away.

"In hope to induce the Pique to follow her, the Blanche, under top sails and courses, stood towards Marie-Galante. At 7, P. M., observing the Pique still under Grande-terre, Captain Faulknor took out the American crew from the

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schooner, and sent on board a petty officer and party of men The Blanche then wore, and stood towards the island of Dominique, with the schooner in tow At about 8, P.M., the French frigate was descried astern, about two leagues distant, standing after the Blanche. The latter immediately cast off the schooner, and, tacking, made all sail in chase.

"At about a quarter past midnight, the Blanche, on the starboard tack, passed under the lee of the Pique on the larboard tack, and returned the distant broadside which the Pique had fired at her. At half-past midnight, having got nearly in the wake of her opponent, the Blanche tacked, and, at a few minutes before 1, A.M., on the 5th, just as she had arrived within musket-shot upon the starboard quarter of the Pique, the latter wore, with the intention of crossing her opponent's hawse, and raking her ahead. To frustrate this manœuvre, the Blanche wore also; and the two frigates became closely engaged, broadside to broadside.

"At about 2 h. 30 m. A.M., the Blanche, having shot ahead, was in the act of luffing up to port, to rake the Pique ahead, when the former's wounded mizen and main-masts, in succession, fell over the side. Almost immediately after this, the Pique ran foul of the Blanche on her larboard quarter, and made several attempts to board. These attempts the British crew successfully resisted; and the larboard quarter-deck guns, and such of the main-deck ones as would bear, were fired with destructive effect into the Pique's starboard bow; she returning the fire from her tops, as well as from some of her quarter-deck guns, run in amidships fore and aft. At a few minutes before 3, A.M., while assisting his second lieutenant, Mr. David Milne, and one or two others of his crew, in lashing, with such ropes as were handy, the bowsprit of the Pique to the capstan of the Blanche, preparatory to a more secure fastening, by means of a hawser, which was getting up from below, the young and gallant Captain Faulknor fell by a musket ball through his heart.

"At this moment, or very soon afterwards, the lashings broke loose; and the Pique, crossing the stern of the Blanche, who had now begun to pay off for the want of after-sail, fell on board the latter, a second time, upon the starboard quarter. In an instant, the British crew, with the hawser which just had before been got on deck, lashed the bowsprit of the Pique to the stump of their own main-mast. In this manner, the Blanche, commanded now by Lieutenant Frederick Watkins, towed before the wind her resolute opponent, whose repeated attempts to cut away this second lashing, were defeated by the quick and well-directed fire of the British marines. In the meanwhile, the constant stream of musketry poured upon the quarter-deck of the Blanche, from the forecastle and tops of the Pique, and a well directed fire from the latter's quarter-deck guns, pointed forward, gave great annoyance to the former; particularly as, having, like many other ships in the British navy at this period, no stern-ports on the main deck, the cannonade on the part of the Blanche was confined to two quarter-deck six-pounders The carpenters having in vain tried to cut down the upper transom beam, no alternative remained, but to blow away a part of it on each side. As soon, therefore, as the firemen, with their buckets, were assembled in the cabin, the two after-guns were pointed against the stern-frame. The discharge made a clear breach on both sides, and the activity of the bucket-men quickly extinguished the fire it had occasioned in the wood-work. The two twelve-pounders of the Blanche, thus brought into use, soon played havoc upon the Pique's decks.

"At about 3 h. 15 m. A.M., the main mast of the French frigate (her fore and mizen-masts having previously come down) fell over the side. In this utterly defenceless state, without a gun which, on account of the wreck of her masts, she could now bring to bear, the Pique sustained the raking fire of the Blanche until 5 h. 15m. A.M.; when some of the French crew, from the bowsprit end, called aloud for quarter. The Blanche immediately ceased her fire; and every boat in both vessels having been destroyed by shot, Lieutenant Milne, followed by ten seamen, endeavoured to reach the prize by means of the hawser that still held her; but their weight bringing the bight of the rope down in the water, they had to swim a part of the distance.

"The Blanche, besides her 32 long 12 and 6-pounders, mounted six 18-pounder carronades, total, 38 guns; and, having sent away in prizes two master's mates and 12 seamen, she had on board no more than 198 men and boys. Of these, the Blanche lost her commander, one midshipman, five seamen, and one private marine killed; one midshipman, two quarter-masters, the armourer, one serjeant of marines, twelve seamen, and four private marines, wounded: total, eight killed, and twenty-one wounded.

"The Pique was armed with two carriage-guns, 6-pounders, less than her establishment, or 38 in all; but she mounted, along her gunwale on each side, several brass swivels. Respecting the number composing the crew of the Pique, the accounts are very contradictory. Lieutenant Watkins, in his official letter, states the number at 360; and Vice-Admiral Caldwell, at Martinique, when enclosing that letter to the Admiralty, says, 'many more than 360' On the other hand, the three French officers, examined before the surrogate of the Colonial Vice-Admiralty Court, subsequently deposed, two of them, to 'between 260 and 270 men,' and the third, to 'about 270 men,' as the total number on board their ship when the action commenced. Upon these certificates, head-money was paid for 265 men; but, according to the documents transmitted along with those certificates, the actual number of men on board was 279."—*James' Naval History.*

EMIGRATION.

"I have said nothing," continues Mr. Fergusson, "hitherto of the price or value of land in Canada, and it is extremely difficult, in the settled parts of either province, to ascertain any thing like a fair average rate. Prices are perpetually fluctuating, and must be regulated by the circumstances of the seller; one man being willing to sell his farm for five dollars an acre, under a strong desire to commence anew upon a forest tract, or labouring under necessity, while his next neighbour may probably refuse to part with similar land for less than ten or twelve dollars per acre Of this, however, there is no doubt, that very eligible and advantageous purchases may, at all times, be made by a prudent capitalist, and that land is every year increasing in value, wherever it is desirable to possess it. Great bargains are sometimes obtained at public sales, by warrant of the sheriff, for payment of land taxes Land thus sold is subject, for a certain short period, to be redeemed by the individual, or his heirs, who originally obtained the grant; but, as it seldom exceeds, at a sheriff sale, 6d. or 7d. per acre, it is well worthy of a trial. Steam navigation may be said to have been created for America, and it is difficult to estimate the advances which the States and the Canadas will soon make under its influence. To emigrants it not only affords a safe, cheap, and agreeable conveyance; but from the large concourse of passengers, a fund of valuable local information may always be procured, and useful acquaintances formed; while it is impossible to overlook the silent but important effects, in clearing the forest, which the consumption of fuel on board the steam-boats is destined to accomplish. Perhaps it is not fanciful to assert, that the woods of America are now actually clearing by means of steam.

"York, the capital of Upper Canada, and seat of government, is a very desirable station for a settler to choose as head-quarters, in looking about for a purchase. He is sure, at this place, to meet with numerous offers of farms, regarding which he will do well to act with caution; and he will be able to inspect the plans of public lands in the government land-office, under the superintendence of Mr. P. Robinson, a gentleman able and willing to afford him every facility. The *rich* and *heavy* land of Upper Canada is not to be found, in general, upon the immediate banks of the lakes and rivers. It lies, for the most part, from twelve to twenty miles back, and thus compensates the enterprising settler for plunging into the forest. Government have still, I believe, about four millions and a half of acres to dispose of, besides seven or eight millions more, beyond the lines of what has been surveyed. No land is now granted to individuals without payment, the price varying according to situation and quality, and subject to the regulation of clearing and fencing five acres within two years, erecting a house 16 feet by 20, and also clearing half of the road in front.

"Another land-office, highly interesting to emigrants, is likewise to be found in York. It is here that the commissioners of the Canada Company reside, and have their principal establishment. This company, as is well known, purchased from government two and a half millions of acres in the Upper Province, with the view of disposing of it in lots to settlers, at an advanced price. The company is yet too much in its infancy to speculate upon results; but no reasonable doubt can be entertained that it must operate favourably in procuring settlers.

"A great progress has been made in the formation of roads, bridges, mills, &c., which government would not, and private individuals could not, have effected in the short period which has elapsed since the establishment of the company; and, although a feeling inimical to their measures shewed itself in some quarters, I confess myself unable to discover, for that jealousy, any reasonable cause. I had very full discussions with the commissioners and agents, from which, as well as from their published proposals, I feel satisfied that emigrants of every class may commit themselves to the Canada Company, in perfect assurance of experiencing the most kind, honourable, and liberal treatment. Circumstances dependent upon the state of a new country may delay the execution of plans beyond the promised period; but there can be no doubt of the company fulfilling all their engagements as speedily as possible. The prices of land vary from 7*s.* 6*d.* to 15*s.* per acre. I was much impressed with a favourable opinion of the Great Huron Tract, from the fact that many steady Dutch settlers, in the possession of old productive farms near York, were, at the period of my visit, disposing of their property and removing to Goderich,—a change which the calculating Dutchmen would not have rashly adopted, without pretty reasonable prospects of bettering himself to a considerable amount. 'The township of Goderich contains about 400 inhabitants already, and several Dutch families from the neighbourhood of York have sold, or are endeavouring to sell, their cultivated and valuable farms, and have purchased lands from the company in the Huron tract. About 6000 acres have been sold them in the neighbourhood of Goderich within the last six months. In Guelph a very valuable mill has lately been erected, and one in Goderich is now in progress.'

"In a young and thinly-settled country such as Canada, every accession of an industrious family, or individual, tends to the welfare of all; and it is therefore natural to suppose that such a corporation as the Canada Company would be fully awake to this principle. We find, accordingly, that in forming arrangements for forwarding emigrants to their own lands, they have offered very favourable proposals to emigrants at large. They state, that 'all persons depositing 20*l.* with the Canada Company's agents in Quebec and Montreal, will be forwarded to the head of Lake Ontario by steam-boats, free of expense, and have liberty to select land in any part of the province, at the current price charged by the company, when the whole amount of their deposit will be placed to their credit on account of their land. But, should they prefer purchasing from individuals, and not the company, then the expense of their conveyance will be deducted from the amount deposited, and the balance paid over to them Persons depositing a sum equal to their conveyance, with their families and luggage, from Quebec to the head of the lake, may avail themselves of the company's contracts with the forwarders; and should they, within three months after arrival, select land in Guelph, and pay one-fifth of the purchase-money, then the amount of their deposit in Quebec will also be placed to their credit, and they, their families, &c., be thus conveyed from Quebec free of expense.'"—*Agricultural Journal.*

(To be continued.)

NEW SOUTH WALES.

From an interesting parliamentary paper, it appears that the average expense of transporting a convict to New South Wales, which was in 1827, 24*l.* 1*s.* 6*d.*, is now considerably under 20*l*; and that the average expense of actually maintaining and clothing a male convict there was, in 1821, 22*l.* 9*s.* 8*d.*, but that now it does not exceed 7*l.* 3*d.* The total number of male convicts in the colony on the 1st November, 1828, including those assigned to individuals, and those allowed to provide for themselves by ticket of leave, was 14,155

The total number of female convicts under the same circumstances, was . . 1,513

Total . 15,668

The total expenditure of the government of the colony in the year 1829, is stated to be £306,439 8 0

Of which was contributed by the colonial revenue . . 99,933 15 0

Leaving to be borne by the government a total of . . £206,505 13 0

which sum, divided by the number of convicts maintained in the colony, gives 11*l.* 5*s.* 6*d.* as the expense of each. It should, however, be remarked, that in the expenditure for the year 1829, are included two sums of 78,493*l.* and 20,000*l.*, the former for the "provisions, clothing, fuel, and the necessaries provided in the colony for the use and maintenance of the convicts;" the latter for the estimated costs of stores sent from England, and amount of expenses incurred but not yet brought to account. The year 1829 was the last of a series of four years of drought and scarcity, and a great proportion of the wheat consumed in the colony during that year was imported from Van Dieman's Land; in consequence of this the average price was not less than 10*s.* per bushel, more than double the price of 1831. The price of maize during the same year was not lower in proportion than that of wheat, and animal food was also from 50 to 75 per cent. higher than it has since become; this leaves no doubt that the maintenance of the same number of convicts, which in 1829 cost 78,493*l.*, would not in 1831, or any future year, cost more than 50,000*l.* The estimate for stores, materials, &c., required from England during the present year, does not exceed 7,000*l.*; but, on the other hand, an increase may have taken place under the head of "police, gaols, &c.," to the amount of probably 5,000*l.* It will consequently follow, that, supposing (as is pretty near the truth) the number of convicts maintained by the crown in ordinary service, at penal settlements, in gaols, hospitals, &c., will be the same in 1831 as it was in 1829, the demands upon the English Treasury will be reduced from 2 6,505*l.* to 170,000*l.*, or 9*l.* 15*s.* for each convict. The aggregate of this estimate includes a sum of 64,000*l.* for the maintenance of troops in the protection of the colony, as well as in the control of the convicts, and all other charges to which the mother country is subjected on account of the colony.

According to a statement in a pamphlet published by Mr. Potter Macqueen, M.P. for Bedfordshire, the average expense of a culprit in the Hulks in the years 1818-19-20-21, was £34 0 0

Ditto at Milbank Penitentiary . 56 15 0

The lowest estimate (that of Worcester Gaol) in a list of 11 Penitentiaries and Gaols . 28 2 4

The average of the whole 11 . . 38 7 2

The expense of sending a convict to New South Wales is, in round numbers, say . . 20 0 0

Annual average expense of maintenance, say 12 0 0

If, therefore, a convict is five months on his voyage, which costs 20*l.*, and seven months in the colony at 1*l.* per month, there will be a saving to the nation, in the lowest estimate of Mr. P. Macqueen, of 1*l.* 2*s.* 4*d.* for each convict in the first year of his quitting England. This clearly shews the advantages derived from transporting convicts by the mother country, where labour is so plentiful, that the punishment of the criminals interferes with the employment of the half-starved pauper.

Negro Doctor.—Of the thirteen months which Dampier spent in Virginia he has left no record: but from another portion of his memoirs, it may be gathered that he suffered from sickness during most of the time. His disease was not more singular than was the mode of cure practised by a negro Esculapius, whose appropriate fee was a white cock. The disease is what is called the *Guinea-worm.* "These worms," says our navigator, "are no bigger than a large brown thread, but (as I have heard) five or six yards long, and if it break in drawing out, that part which remains in the flesh will putrify, and endanger the patient's life, and be very painful. I was in great torment before it came out. My leg and ankle swelled, and looked very red and angry, and I kept a plaster to it to bring it to a head. Drawing off my plaster, out came about three inches of the worm, and my pain abated presently Till then I was ignorant of my malady, and the gentlewoman at whose house I lodged took it (the worm) for a nerve; but I knew well enough what it was, and presently rolled it upon a small stick. After that I opened it every morning and evening, and strained it out gently, about two inches at a time, not without pain. The negro doctor first stroked the place affected, then applied some rough powder to it, like tobacco leaves crumbled, next muttered a spell, blew upon the part three times, waved his hands as often, and said that in three days it would be well. It proved so, and the stipulated fee of the white cock was gladly paid.—*Edinburgh Cabinet Library*

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COLUMN FOR THE BOYS.

AGREEABLY to the plan upon which I set out, I now commence a series of amusing articles for the perusal of my juvenile readers In the execution of this willing duty, I am wonderfully assisted by a recently published volume, entitled, "THE BOYS' OWN BOOK, *or a complete Encyclopedia of all the Diversions, athletic, scientific, and recreative, of Boyhood and Youth*," published by Vizetelly, Branston, and Co., Fleet-street, London, 1830 Exceedingly few of my young Scottish readers can have possibly seen this delightful production, which is written with great taste and judgment. "We heartily trust that our young readers," says the author, "will commence the perusal of our pages with pleasure equal to that which we feel in sitting down to write them, and that we shall go pleasantly together through our work. The description of these Minor Sports, most especially, will, we are convinced, be an agreeable pastime to us, and call up, from time to time, welcome reminiscences of those days of our boyhood, when we were a hero at 'Ring-taw,' and by no means a contemptible adversary even to the most accomplished youthful players at 'Fives.' It will remind us of our happy holidays and favourite schoolfellows;—of feats of agility performed at 'Follow my Leader,' and trophies borne off in triumph at 'Peg in the ring;'—of those merry mornings, when the first glance of the sun awakened us to snatch an additional half-hour for the play-ground, without encroaching on the allotted times for study;—when, during 'winter's surly reign,' we joined the active few, who, instead of moping in great coats, or shivering round a fire, sallied forth into the clear, cold, invigorating air, and marking out goals and bounds in the crisp hoar frost that mantled the ground, sought after, and found, warmth and high spirits in a game of 'Prisoner's Base,'—or made the brows glow at lofty 'Leap-frog,'—or defied the frost by briskly plying the whip-top with eel-skin, and came in with glad hearts, ruddy cheeks, perfect willingness, and the best of appetites, to our morning repast, and subsequent studies. It will bring to our recollection, also, those smooth and shady spots, where, when the noontide sun was midway in the heavens in the sultry month of August, we alternately perused pleasant and instructive books, and played with our class-mates at 'Increase-pound,' or set up a pyramid of marbles for them to shoot at, or shot at one erected by one of them. It will carry us back in imagination to the hills and downs, where we flew our kites—the loftiest soarers for miles around;—of mishaps, through breaking of strings, and long races of rivalry after our falling favourites;—to that cheerful parlour, in which, during the winter vacation, when mince-meat, plum-puddings, and young parties, were most abundant, on Christmas eve, or mirthful Twelfth-night, most especially,—we bore a part in the exhilarating and harmless fire-side sports of the season;—to that dilapidated ruin,—the court of that mouldering castle, with a tall and stately elm rising from one of its corners, and ivy, apparently ages old, the constant home and nestling-place of innumerable birds, which bedecked and supported the outward side of its walls,—the scenes of our chief exploits at Fives;—to the garden walk, where our school-swing was erected, between two gigantic sister pear-trees;—and, in brief, to all those places where we played the games which were the delight of our holidays; when a sportive bout at 'Saddle my Nag,' was in itself an ample recompense for the past two hours of study, employed in working an intricate question in arithmetic—composing a theme on some difficult subject—rendering a portion of the Iliad into Latin hexameters, or a passage of Pope into French prose We conceive that we are bringing no disgrace on our boyhood, by avowing that we deeply enjoyed the sports of the play-ground. The line of a talented writer, 'A dunce at syntax, but a dab at taw, has, by a thoughtless few, been converted into a proverb, and those who were most eminent for their activity and love of the usual amusements of youth out of school, have thus been unjustly stigmatised as inattentive students. The reverse we have generally found to be the fact; for, we have often remarked, that the lads who led the sports in the play-ground, stood high in their classes in the schoolroom. 'There is a time for all things,' is a trite, but, in this case, an applicable observation; the scholastic discipline wisely allots certain hours in the day for recreation; they should be employed in healthful and agreeable pastime, so as to render the boy prepared to return with mental vigour to his books;—study should give a relish to sport, and sport to study. But while we recommend that the schoolroom should not be forgotten on the play-ground, we wish to impress on our young readers the necessity of their forgetting the play-ground in the schoolroom."

Passing over what are called the *Minor Sports*, which, it is presumed, are too well understood by boys to require description, I proceed to the article on *Archery*.

In this island, Archery was greatly encouraged in former times, and many statutes were made for its regulation. The artillery company of London, though they have long disused the weapon, are the remains of the ancient fraternity of bowmen or archers. As to the time when shooting with the long bow first began amongst the English, there appears no certain account Richard I. was killed by an arrow in 1199. After this time, we read nothing of archery, till that of Edward III., when an order was issued to the sheriffs of most of the English counties, to provide five hundred white bows, and five hundred bundles of arrows, for the then intended war against France. The famous battle of Cressy was fought four years afterward, in which it is stated that we had about two thousand archers, opposed to about the same number of French. In the fifth year of the reign of Edward IV., an act was passed, that every Englishman, and Irishman dwelling with Englishmen, should have an English bow of his own height, which is directed to be made of yew, wych hazel, ash, or awburne, or any other reasonable tree, according to their power. The next chapter also directed, that butts should be made in every township, which the inhabitants were obliged to shoot at, every feast day, under penalty of one halfpenny, when they should omit this exercise During the reign of Henry VIII., several statutes were made for the promotion of archery. An act of parliament, in Elizabeth's reign, regulated the price of bows. Charles I. is said to have been an archer; and, in the eighth year of his reign, he issued a commission to prevent the fields near London being so enclosed as "to interrupt the necessary and profitable exercise of shooting." So lately as the year 1753, targets were erected in the Finsbury fields, during the Easter and Whitsuntide holidays, when the best shooter was styled "Captain," for the ensuing year, and the second "Lieutenant." Edward VI in his Journal, says, that one hundred archers of his guard shot, before him, two arrows each, and afterward, altogether; and that they shot at an inch board, which some pierced quite through with the heads of their arrows, the board being well-seasoned timber. The distance of the mark is not mentioned. As a pastime, there is none, perhaps, superior to this; it is now, and for years past has been, highly popular in this country. In fact, judging from the past and the present, we may venture to predict, that—

> The archer's sport will never be extinct,
> Until the memory of Robin Hood,
> Of Cressy's well-fought field, and Chevy Chase,
> Be blotted from the tablet of our minds.

The Bow.—The young Archer should, in the first place, select a bow that is fit and proper for his own size and strength. It is not probable that, let him be ever so skilful, he will be able to achieve such an exploit, as the construction of a good bow himself; bow-making being a trade which requires many years' practice and much attention. In fact, there are few persons, now-a-days, although there are many bowyers, who can manufacture bows of a superior description. [Mr. Muir, Archers' Hall, Edinburgh, is, doubtless, the most skilful bowyer of the day; and to him we recommend our young friends to apply, if they have any inclination to equip themselves in proper style, for the enjoyment of the noble pastime of Archery.]

The back of the bow is the flat outside, and the belly the round inside part of it. The round inside part is bent inward: if the bow be pulled the reverse way, it will break; therefore, however a bow may be bent when unstrung, it is invariably to be strung with the round part inward.

Arrows.—Arrows should be delicately proportioned in length and weight to the bow for which they are intended. They are used blunt or sharp, and varying in their thickness, according to the fancy of the Archer. Some are made so as to taper gradually from the feathers to the pile, and some *vice versa*; others, again, are thickest in the centre. All arrows should have their nocks or notches cased with horn, and the nocks should be of such a size, as to fit the string with exactness, and be neither too tight nor too loose. Three goose or turkey feathers are affixed to arrows; one of these, denominated the cock feather, is of a different colour from the other two; and this is always to be placed appermost

The Tassel.—This is very necessary to the Archer, for the purpose of cleaning the arrow from such dirt as generally adheres to it, if it enter the ground. This dirt, if suffered to remain, will impede the arrow in its flight, and also render its course untrue. The tassel is suspended on the left side of the Archers, and is thus always at hand for use.

The Glove.—The glove consists of places for three fingers, a back thong, and a wrist strap to fasten it. The finger stalls should neither project far over the tops, nor be drawn back to cover the first joint. The glove is used for the purpose of protecting the fingers from being hurt by the string.

The Brace.—The brace is worn on the bow arm, to save it from being injured by the string, which, without this protection, would, in all probability, incapacitate the Archer from shooting long at a time. It is made of stout leather, with a very smooth surface, so that the string may glide over it without impediment —*To be continued.*

ON THE STUDY OF NATURAL PHILOSOPHY.

(1). THE situation of man on the globe he inhabits, and over which he has obtained the control, is, in many respects, exceedingly remarkable. Compared with its other denizens, he seems, if we regard only his physical constitution, in almost every respect their inferior, and equally unprovided for the supply of his natural wants and his defence against the innumerable enemies which surround him. No other animal passes so large a portion of its existence in a state of absolute helplessness, or falls in old age into such protracted and lamentable imbecility. To no other warm-blooded animal has nature denied that indispensable covering, without which the vicissitudes of a temperate, and the rigours of a cold climate are equally insupportable: and to scarcely any has she been so sparing in external weapons whether for attack or defence. Destitute alike of speed to avoid, and of arms to repel the aggressions of his voracious foes; tenderly susceptible of atmospheric influences, and unfitted for the coarse aliments which the earth affords spontaneously, during at least two-thirds of the year, even in temperate climates,—man, if abandoned to mere instinct, would be of all creatures the most destitute and miserable Distracted by terror, and goaded by famine; driven to the most abject expedients for concealment from his enemies, and to the most cowardly devices for the seizure and destruction of his nobler prey, his existence would be one continued subterfuge or stratagem;—his dwelling would be in dens of the earth, in clefts of rocks, or in the hollow of trees; his food worms, and the lower reptiles, or such few and crude productions of the soil, as his organs could be brought to assimilate, varied with occasional relics, mangled by more powerful beasts of prey, or contemned by their more pampered choice Remarkable only for the absence of those powers and qualities which obtain for other animals a degree of security and respect, he would be disregarded by some, and hunted down by others, till after a few generations his species would become altogether extinct, or, at best, would be restricted to a few islands in tropical regions, where the warmth of the climate, the paucity of enemies, and the abundance of vegetable food, might permit it to linger.

(2). Yet man is the undisputed lord of the creation. The strongest and fiercest of his fellow-creatures,—the whale, the elephant, the eagle, and the tiger, are slaughtered by him to supply his most capricious wants, or tamed to do him service, or imprisoned to make him sport The spoils of all nature are in daily requisition for his most common uses, yielded with more or less readiness, or wrested with reluctance, from the mine, the forest, the ocean, and the air Such are the first fruits of reason. Were they the only or the principal ones, were the mere acquisition of power over the materials, and the less gifted animals which surround us, and the consequent increase of our external comforts, and our means of preservation and sensual enjoyment, the sum of the privileges which the possession of this faculty conferred, we should, after all, have little to plume ourselves upon. But this is so far from being the case, that every one who passes his life in tolerable ease and comfort, or rather, whose whole time is not anxiously consumed in providing the absolute necessaries of existence, is conscious of wants and cravings in which the senses have no part, of a series of pains and pleasures totally distinct in kind from any which the infliction of bodily misery, or the gratification of bodily appetites, has ever afforded him; and if he has experienced these pleasures and these pains in any degree of intensity, he will readily admit them to hold a much higher rank, and to deserve much more attention, than the former class. Independent of the pleasures of fancy and imagination, and social converse, man is constituted a speculative being; he contemplates the world, and the objects around him, not with a passive indifferent gaze, as a set of phenomena in which he has no farther interest, than as they affect his immediate situation, and can be rendered subservient to his comfort, but as a system disposed with order and design. He approves, and feels the highest admiration for the harmony of its parts, the skill and efficiency of its contrivances. Some of these which he can best trace and understand, he attempts to imitate, and finds that, to a certain extent, though rudely and imperfectly, he can succeed,—in others, that although he can comprehend the nature of the contrivance, he is totally destitute of all means of imitation; while in others, again, and those evidently the most important, though he sees the effect produced, yet the means by which it is done, are alike beyond his knowledge and his control. Thus he is led to the conception of a Power and an Intelligence superior to his own, and adequate to the production and maintenance of all that he sees in nature,—a Power and Intelligence to which he may well apply the term infinite, since he not only sees no actual limit to the instances in which they are manifested, but finds, on the contrary, that the farther he inquires, and the wider his sphere of observation extends, they continually open upon him in increasing abundance; and that, as the study of one prepares him to understand and appreciate another, refinement follows on refinement, wonder on wonder, till his faculties become bewildered in admiration, and his intellect falls back on itself, in utter hopelessness of arriving at an end.

(3). When from external objects he turns his view upon himself—on his own vital and intellectual faculties, he finds that he possesses a power of examining and analyzing his own nature to a certain extent, but no farther. In his corporeal frame he is sensible of a power to communicate a certain moderate amount of motion to himself and other objects; that this power depends on his will, and that its exertion can be suspended or increased at pleasure within certain limits; but how his will acts on his limbs he has no consciousness; and whence he derives the power he thus exercises, there is nothing to assure him, however he may long to know. His senses, too, inform him of a multitude of particulars respecting the external world, and he perceives an apparatus by which impressions from without may be transmitted, as a sort of signals, to the interior of his person, and ultimately to his brain, wherein he is obscurely sensible that the thinking, feeling, reasoning being he calls *himself*, more especially resides; but by what means he becomes conscious of these impressions, and what is the nature of the immediate communication between that inward sentient being, and that machinery, his outward man, he has not the slightest conception.

(4). Again, when he contemplates still more attentively the thoughts, acts, and passions of this his sentient intelligent self, he finds, indeed, that he can remember, and by the aid of memory, can compare and discriminate, can judge and resolve, and, above all, that he is irresistibly impelled, from the perception of any phenomenon without or within him, to infer the existence of something prior which stands to it in the relation of a *cause*, without which it would not be, and that this knowledge of causes and their consequences is what, in almost every instance, determines his choice and will, in cases where he is nevertheless conscious of perfect freedom to act or not to act. He finds, too, that it is in his power to acquire more or less knowledge of causes and effects according to the degree of attention he bestows upon them, which attention is again in great measure a voluntary act; and often when his choice has been decided on imperfect knowledge or insufficient attention, he finds reason to correct his judgment, though perhaps too late to influence his decision by after consideration. A world within him is thus opened to his intellectual view, abounding with phenomena and relations, and of the highest immediate interest But while he cannot help perceiving that the insight he is enabled to obtain into this internal sphere of thought and feeling is in reality the source of all his power—the very fountain of his predominance over external nature—he yet feels himself capable of entering only very imperfectly into these recesses of his

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own bosom, and analyzing the operations of his mind,—in this as in all other things, in short, "*a being darkly wise*;" seeing that all the longest life and most vigorous intellect can give him power to discover by his own research, or time to know by availing himself of that of others, serves only to place him on the very frontier of knowledge, and afford a distant glimpse of boundless realms beyond, where no human thought has penetrated, but which yet he is sure must be no less familiarly known to that Intelligence which he traces throughout creation, than the most obvious truths which he himself daily applies to his most trifling purposes. Is it wonderful that a being so constituted should first encourage a hope, and by degress acknowledge an assurance, that his intellectual existence will not terminate with the dissolution of his corporeal frame, but rather that in a future state of being, disencumbered of a thousand obstructions, which his present situation throws in his way, endowed with acuter senses, and higher faculties, he shall drink deep at that fountain of beneficent wisdom for which the slight taste obtained on earth has given him so keen a relish?—HERSCHEL. *Lardner's Cyclopædia.*

To be continued.

ODE TO POVERTY.

I formerly announced that no poetry should be admitted into the Edinburgh Journal. This, I find, has occasioned regret among some very respectable persons. Poetry, they say, is a branch of the Belles Lettres, tending to polish, soften, and humanize. I therefore have resolved to admit occasionally short poems—only of such a nature, however, as are really calculated to have any effect in improving the minds or hearts of my readers. Of such a nature I judge the following composition, which appeared in Blackwood's Magazine, for April, 1830. It is the production of a humble Scottish rustic—William Park—who acts as farm servant, or "*minister's man*," to the Rev. Mr. Brown of Eskdale-Muir. That sentiments so refined, and thoughts so profound should reside in a peasant, whose opportunities of improving his mind are probably of the most limited nature, is in itself most wonderful, and proves, if proof were wanting, how highly the rural people of Scotland are exalted in the scale of intellect. It also proves a far more important thing—that there is no lot so mean but it may be ennobled by virtuous feeling, and the triumphs of inborn genius.

Hail! mighty power! who o'er my lot
Presidest uncontroll'd and free;
Sole ruler of the rural cot,
I bid thee hail, dread Poverty!
Thine aid I crave to guide my strain,
Nor shall I supplicate in vain.

When on this world of woe and toil,
A helpless stranger I was cast,
Like mariner on desert isle,
The sport and victim of the blast,
Thy russet robe was o'er me flung,
And to thy cold, lean hand I clung.

In youth I felt thy guardian care,
Each saving, self-denying rule,
Awful for those of fortune spare,
I learnt and practised in thy school;
And of my lengthen'd life at large,
Thou still hast taken special charge,

Much have I seen—much more I've heard,
Of chance and change in this vain world;
The low to high estate preferr'd—
From high estate the haughty hurl'd;
But chance or change ne'er pass'd o'er me—
I'm still thy subject, Poverty!

(Oh how unwise are they who scorn
Thy homely garb and homely fare;
Who scale the tropic's burning bourne,
Ideal happiness to share;
They tread the wild, and plough the wave,
In quest of gold—but find a grave.)

There are who know thee but by name,
Who spurn thy salutary laws,
And count thy badge a mark of shame,
And hold it sin to own thy cause.
Fools that they are! they never knew
Thy guiltless pride—thy spirit true.

Full oft in danger's darkest day
Thy sons have proved their country's shield,
When wealth's effeminate array
Appear'd not on the battle field:—
'Twas theirs to grasp the patriot brand,
That dropp'd from luxury's nerveless hand.

Full oft, where wealth-engender'd crime
Roll'd o'er the lands its whelming tide,
Their fervent faith and hope sublime
Have stable proved, though sorely tried:
In virtue's heavenward path they trode,
When Pleasure's sons forsook their God.

And yet nor stone, nor poet's strain,
Records their honours undefil'd;
Even poesy would weave in vain
The laurel wreath for penury's child:
Should fashion sneer, or fortune frown,
'Twould wither ere the sun went down.

But greater, happier far is he,
More ample his reward of praise,—
Though he should misery's kinsman be,
Though hardships cloud his early days,—
Who triumphs in temptation's hour,
Than he who wins the warlike tower.

What though he may not write his name
On history's ever living page!
What though the thrilling trump of fame
Echo it not from age to age!
'Tis blazoned bright in realms on high,
Enroll'd in records of the sky.

What though the hireling bard be mute,
When humble worth for notice calls,
There wants not voice of harp or lute
To hymn it high in heavenly halls:
Around the cell where virtue weeps,
His nightly watch the seraph keeps.

If peace of mind your thoughts employ,
Ye restless murmuring sons of earth!
Ah! shun the splendid haunts of joy,
Peace dwells not with unholy mirth;
But oft amidst a crowd of woes,
As in the desert blooms the rose.

Thick fly the hostile shafts of fate,
And wreck and ruin mark their course,
But the pure spirit, firm, sedate,
Nor feels their flight, nor fears its force;
So storms the ocean's surface sweep,
While calm below the waters sleep.

O! may eternal peace be mine,
Though outward woes urge on their war,
And Hope do thou my path define,
And light it with thy radiant star.
Thou, Hope! who through the shades of sorrow,
Couldst trace the dawn of joy's bright morrow.

LION HUNTING.—Ten or twelve colonists, mounted and armed with their large guns, go out, and having, with the assistance of their dogs and Hottentots, ascertained where the spoiler lies, approach within a moderate distance, and then alighting, make fast the horses to each other by their bridles and halters. They then advance to within about thirty paces, backing the horses before them, knowing to within what distance, and being aware, from his aspect and motions, whether he is likely to anticipate their attack. As they advance, the lion at first surveys them calmly, and wags his tail as in a pleased or playful humour; but when they approach nearer, he begins to growl, and draws his hind parts under his breast till almost nothing of him is seen, except his bushy, bristling mane, and his eyes of living fire gleaming fiercely from the midst of it. He is now fully enraged, and only measuring his distance in act to spring upon his audacious assailants. This is the critical moment, and the signal for half the party to fire. If they are not successful in killing him at the first volley, he springs like a thunderbolt upon the horses. The rest of the party then pour in their fire upon him, which seldom fails to finish his career, though, perhaps, with the loss of one or more horses; and sometimes, though more rarely, some even of the huntsmen are destroyed in these dangerous encounters. —*Thomson's Travels in Africa.*

THE HUMMING BIRD.—Frequently as the humming bird has been described since it was seen by Dumpier, his account of this the most delicate and lovely of the feathered tribe, is as fresh and beautiful as when the young seaman, charmed with its loveliness, first entered a description of it in his rude journal:—"The humming bird is a pretty little feathered creature, no bigger than a great overgrown wasp; with a black bill no bigger than a small needle, and with legs and feet in proportion to its body. This creature does not wave its wings like other birds when it flies, but keeps them in a continued quick motion, like bees or other insects; and like them makes a continued humming noise as it flies. It is very quick in motion, and haunts about flowers and fruit like a bee gathering honey; making many addresses to its delightful objects, by visiting them on all sides, and yet still keeps in motion, sometimes on one side, sometimes on the other, as often rebounding a foot or two back on a sudden, and as quickly returns again, keeping thus about one flower five or six minutes or more."—*Edinburgh Cabinet Library.*

THE NATURE AND PROPERTIES OF MILK.—The chemical properties of this secretion differ somewhat in different animals. The milk of the cow has been most attentively examined, and it has the following properties:—"1. It is nearly opaque; white, or slightly yellow; of an agreeable sweetish taste, and a peculiar smell. Its specific gravity varies from 10.18 to 10.20. It boils at a temperature a little above that of water, and freezes at 32 deg. When allowed to remain a few hours at rest, a thick unctuous liquid collects upon its surface, called cream; the colour of the remaining milk becomes bluish white, and when heated to about 100 degrees, with a little rennet, it readily separates into a coagulum, or curd, and a serum, or whey. In this way, the three principal constituents of milk are separable from each other. 2. By the process of churning, cream is separated into butter and buttermilk; the latter being the whey united to a portion of curd. Butter may be considered as an animal oil, containing a small portion of curd and whey. 3. The curd of milk has the leading properties of coagulated albumen. Curd, in combination with various proportions of butter, constitutes the varieties of cheese. That containing the largest quantity of oil becomes semi-fluid when heated; it is prone to decomposition, and a large quantity of ammonia is then formed in it; whereas bad cheese, which consists of little else than curd or albumen, shrinks and dies when heated, curling up like a piece of horn. 4. Whey is a transparent fluid, of a pale yellow colour, and a sweetish flavour; by evaporation, it affords a minute quantity of saline matter, and a considerable proportion of sugar of milk."—*Library of Agricultural and Horticultural Knowledge.*

WILLIE COSSAR PINS.—The large pins which the common people at present denominate *Willie Cossars*, were formerly called *bodle preens*, on account of their price, only four of them being given by the chapman for a halfpenny. The change of their name is said in the south country to have been occasioned by a remarkable circumstance. There was once a wandering madman, named Willie Cossar, who bore a terrible character everywhere for his rabid disposition. This personage one day walking along an unfrequented road, met a poor woman, who did not know his person. He asked her if she were not afraid to walk abroad by herself, considering the numerous dangers which beset solitary, and especially female travellers. She answered that she never dreaded any thing in her journeys, except the chance of encountering a wild man of the name of Willie Cossar. Willie was so enraged at this, that, out of revenge, he picked out her eyes with a large bodle pin. That species of pins thenceforward received his name. This circumstance occurred within the last seventy or eighty years.

NIGHT-FALL IN ITALY In Mr. Bell's observations on Italy, the night-fall is thus powerfully described:—The serenity of the approach of night in these fine climates is most soothing; yet so sudden is the fall of evening, that while we are just beginning to trace the rising stars, day is gone. But how beautiful—how grand is the contemplation of nature at this hour! how splendid the spangled sky! how soft the milky-way, clearly defined in its long course, as it lies spread out in the heavens! while, perhaps, from light clouds in the distant horizon, the harmless lightning plays, as if to mock the fire-fly, which, rising from every spot, deepened, soars and plies its busy wings, filling the air with incessant bright alternations of light and shade, and seeming to give life to the silence and stillness of the night.

ACCOUNT OF THE PHŒNIX.—Professor Rennie, in a recent lecture at the King's College, gave an elaborate account of the far-famed Phœnix, which ought to prove not a little interesting to individuals trading under the name of this bird in insurance offices, iron companies, engine factories, stage coachs, steam packets, race horses, coal wharfs, coffee houses, and innumerable other heterogeneous things—imagined, it may be supposed, to derive a mysterious influence from the name of Phœnix The earliest account of the Phœnix is given by Herodotus, the father of history; and this has been copied with additions, (a story seldom loses in its transmission,) by Pliny, Tacitus, Pomponius, Mela, Horapolla, Mariana, and other writers. Among the rest, our old English writer Bartholomew Glantville, as translated by Trevisor, and printed in black letter by Wynkyn de Worde, in 1498, says:—St. Ambrose, in Exameron, sayth: of the humoure or ashes of fœnix ariseth a newe byrde and wexeth, and, in space of tyme, he is clothed with fethers and wyngis, and restored into the kind of a byrde, and is the most fairest byrde that is—most like to the pecock in fethers, and loveth wilderness, and gadereth his meate of cleane greenes and fruites. Alanus speketh of this byrde, and saith, that whan the hyghest byshop Onyas had buylded a temple in the citie of Helyopolys in Egypt, to the lykeness of the temple of Jherusalem, and the fyrste daye of Easter, whaune he hadde gathered moch sweete smellyng wood, and sette it on fyre uppon the altar to offer sacrifyce, to all mennes syghte suche a byrde came sodaynely, and fell into the myddel of the fyre and was brente anone to ashes in the fyre of the sacrifyce; and the ashes abode there, and was besely kept and saved by the commandemente of the preeste; and within three days, of these ashes was bred a lyttel worme, that took the shape of a byrde atte the laste, and flew into the wyldernesse." This account, Mr. Rennie remarked, "of a worm being generated out of the ashes of a sacrifice, and afterwards becoming a bird, is precisely of a piece with the methods given by Virgil and Columella for the generation of bees from dead carcasses, which originated in an imperfect knowledge of the natural history of insects, as I have explained at length in *Insect Transformations*; while the appearance of a bird alighting on the altar must have obviously arisen from some eagle or vulture pouncing upon the carcass of the animal sacrificed,—a circumstance, I should imagine, of occasional occurrence when altars were situated in the open air, and which in Greece or Rome, instead of the bird's being considered a phœnix, would have been hailed as an *avatar* (if I may borrow the braminical term) of Jupiter himself. That such were the circumstances, which in process of time were worked up into the fabulous and fanciful stories of the phœnix, I have no doubt; and it appears to me, that this is the only plausible and rational explanation which can be given; though a vast deal of learning, and no little ingenuity has been expended in other views." This account is strongly corroborated by an anecdote given by Bruce the traveller, of an eagle (*gypaetus barbatus*, Storr,) in the very country where the phœnix was said to appear, darting down while his party were dining in the open air, and carrying off a part of their dinner. It is farther remarkable, that Bruce says of this genuine phœnix, as we may call it, that "the feathers of the belly and breast were of a gold colour," which might almost pass for a translation of Pliny's description of the ancient phœnix. Mr. Rennie exhibited a specimen of this bird to a numerous audience, whom the curiosity of the subject had attracted to the lecture.

PUBLIC LIBRARIES OF EUROPE.—We are enabled to state the exact number of these useful establishments, though, on a superficial enumeration, they cannot amount to fewer than between seven and eight hundred; the contents of which have been estimated by Malthus at 19,847,000 volumes Of these contents, there are preserved in

The Austrian states,	2,220,000 vols
Prussian,	997,000
Remaining states of Germany	3,524,500
The whole of Germany	6,651,500
France	6,427,0 0
Great Britain	1,533,0.0
Russian Empire	880,000
Italy	2,139,000

The six most considerable, and, at the same time, most valuable libraries in Europe, are the following:—

	Vols.	MSS.
Royal Library, Paris	450,000	76,000
Bodleian, Oxford,	420,000	30,000
Royal Central, Munich	400,000	9,000
Vatican, Rome,	100,000	40,000
University, Gottingen,	300,000	5.000
British Museum, London,	300,000	

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FALLACIES OF THE YOUNG.

"FATHERS HAVE FLINTY HEARTS."

I ONLY quote this popular expression from a very popular play, in order to warn my juvenile friends against being too much impressed by it. It is a fatal error running through nearly the whole mass of our fictitious literature, that parents are represented as invariably adverse, through their own cruel and selfish views, to the inclinations of their children: either the glowing ambition and high spirit of the boy is repressed by the cold calculations of his father, who wishes him to become a mere creature of the counting-room and shop like himself; or the romantic attachment of the girl to some elegant Orlando, procures her a confinement to her chamber, with no other alternative than that of marrying a detestable suitor, whom her father prefers to all others on account of his wealth. Then, the boy always runs away from his father's house, and, by following his own inclinations, acquires fortune and fame; while the girl as invariably leaps a three-pair-of-stairs window, and is happy for life with the man of her choice. The same dangerous system pervades the stage, where, I am sorry to remark, every vicious habit of society, and every impropriety in manners and speech is always sure to be latest abandoned.

I warn my juvenile readers most emphatically against the fallacy and delusion which prevails upon this subject. Fathers, as a class, have not flinty hearts, nor is it their wish or interest, in general, to impose a cruel restraint upon their children. Young people would do well to examine the circumstances in which they stand in regard to their parents and guardians, before believing in the reality of that schism which popular literature would represent as invariably existing between their own class and that of their natural protectors. The greater part, I am sure, of my young friends must have observed that, so long as they can remember, they have been indebted for every comfort, and for a thousand acts of kindness and marks of affection, to those endeared beings—*their father and mother*. The very dawning light of existence must have found them in the enjoyment of many blessings procured to them solely by those two individuals. From them must have been derived the food they ate, the bed they lay on, the learning at school which enabled their minds to appreciate all the transactions and all the wisdom of past times, and, greatest blessing of all, the habits of devotional exercise which admitted them to commune with their Almighty Creator. Surely it is not to be supposed that, at a certain time, the kindness and friendship of these two amiable persons is all at once converted into a malignant contrariety to the interests of their children. Is it not far more likely, my dear young friends, that they continue, as ever, to be your well-wishers and benefactors: and that the opposition which they seem to set up so ungraciously against your inclinations, is only caused by their sense of the dangers which threaten you in the event of your being indulged? It may appear to you that no such danger exists: that your parents are actuated by narrower and meaner views than your own, or that they do not allow for the feelings of youth. But they are in reality deeply concerned for the difference of *your* feelings from *theirs*; they sympathize with them in secret, from a recollection of what were their own at your period of life; but know, from that very experience of your feelings, and of their result, that it is not good for you that they should be indulged. You are, then, called upon—and I do so now in the name of your best feelings, and as you would wish for present or future happiness—to trust in the reality of that parental tenderness which has never, heretofore, known interruption, and in the superiority of that wisdom with which years and acquaintance with the world have invested your parents.

Perhaps, my young friends, you may have perceived, even in the midst of your childish frolics and careless happiness, that your parents were obliged to deny themselves many indulgences, and toil hard in their respective duties, in order to obtain for you the comforts which you enjoy. You may have perceived that your father, after he had returned home from his daily employment, could hardly be prevailed upon to enter, as you wished, into your sports, or to assist you with your lessons, but would sit, in silent and abstracted reflection, with a deep shade of care upon his brow. On these occasions, perhaps, your amiable and kind protector is considering how difficult it is, even with all his industry, and all his denial of indulgences to himself, to procure for you an exemption from that wretchedness in which you see thousands of other children every day involved. But though many are the cares which your parents experience, in the duty of rearing you to manhood, there is none so severe or so acute as that which comes upon them at the period of your entering into life. Heretofore, you were simple little children, with hardly a thought, beyond the family scene in which you have enjoyed so many comforts. Heretofore, with the exception of occasional rebukes from your parents, and trifling quarrels with your brothers and sisters, you have all been one family of love, eating at the same board, kneeling in one common prayer, loving one another, as the dearest of all friends. But now the scene becomes very different. You begin to feel, within yourselves, separate interests, and each thinks himself best qualified to judge for himself. At that moment, my young friends, the anxiety of your parents is a thousand times greater than it ever was before. Your father, probably, is a man of formed habits and character; he occupies a certain respectable station in the world; he has all his life been governed by certain principles, which he found to be conducive to his comfort and dignity. But, though he has been able to conduct himself through the world in this satisfactory manner, he is sensible, from the various, and perhaps altogether opposite characters, which nature has implanted in you, that you may go far wide of what have been his favourite objects, and perhaps be the means of impairing that respectability which he, as a single individual, has hitherto maintained. It is often observed in life, that children who have been reared by poor but virtuous parents, as if their minds had received in youth a horror for every attribute of poverty, exert themselves with such vigorous and consistent fortitude, as to end with fortune and dignity; while the children, perhaps, of these individuals, being brought up without the same acquaintance with want and hardship, are slothful through life, and soon bring back the family to its original condition. If you then have been reared in easy circumstances, you may believe what I now tell you, that your approach to manhood or womanhood will produce a degree of anxiety in the breasts of your parents, such as would, if you knew it, make your very heart bleed for their distress, and cause you to appear as monsters to yourselves if you were to act in any great degree differently from what they wished.

How much, then, is it your duty, my young friends, to treat the advices and wishes of your parents, at this period of life, with respect, knowing, as you do, that the future happiness of those dear and kind beings depends almost solely upon your conducting yourselves properly in your first steps into life. Should you be so unfortunate as to be beguiled into bad company, or to contract a disposition to indulgences which are the very bane of existence, and the ruin of reputation, what must be the agony of those individuals who have hitherto loved and cherished you, and indulged, perhaps, in very different anticipations! On the contrary, should you yield respect, as far as it is in your nature, to the maxims which your father has endeavoured to impress; with what delight does he look forward to your future success—with what happy confidence does he rely upon your virtuous principles! And may there be no happiness to *you*, in contemplating the happiness which you have given to *him*? Yes, much, I am sure, and of a purer kind than almost any which earthly things can confer upon you here below.

I have one word to add, and it is addressed to the female part of my juvenile readers. Exactly as parents feel a concern for the first appearance of their sons in the business of life, so do they experience many anxious and fearful thoughts respecting the disposal of their daughters in matrimony. Wedded life, I may inform them, is not the simple matter which it appears prospectively in early and single life. As it involves many serious duties and responsibilities, it must be entered upon with a due regard to the means—above all things, the pecuniary means—of discharging these in a style of respectability, such as may be sufficient to support the dignity of the various connexions of the parties. It is, therefore, necessary that no person of tender years (this is most frequently the lot of the female) should contract the obligations of matrimony, without, if possible, the entire sanction of parents or other protectors. The people of this country happen to entertain, upon this subject, notions of not so strict a kind as are prevalent in most other nations. In almost all continental and all eastern countries, the female is reared by her friends as the destined bride of a particular individual, and till her marriage she is allowed no opportunity of bestowing her affections upon any other. The custom is so ancient and so invariable, that it is submitted to without any feeling of hardship; and as prudence is the governing principle of the relations, the matches are generally as happy as if they were more free. Perhaps such a custom is inapplicable to this country, on account of our different system of domestic life; but I may instance it, to prove to my fair young readers, that the control of parents over their choice of a husband ought to be looked upon as a more tolerable and advantageous thing, than their inclinations might be disposed to allow, or our popular literature represents it to be.

FORMATION OF SCOTTISH SOCIETY.

Continued.

THE Somervilles are amongst the most ancient families of note in Scotland. The first of the name in Britain was Gualter de Somerville, who accompanied William the Conqueror to England, and obtained from him estates in Staffordshire and Gloucestershire. He left several sons, and died at the commencement of the twelfth century. One of these

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sons named Gualter, inherited his estates in England, and the second attached himself to Earl David, when he came to Scotland. On arriving in this country, David conferred on him the manor of Carnwath, in Clydesdale, in reward for his attachment, and there have been Somervilles in this part of Scotland ever since.—There was at one time a family of the name of *Umphraville*, of considerable note in this country, the first of whom attached himself to Earl David. The family enjoyed various lands in Stirlingshire; but, after a residence in the country for about half a century, merged for lack of heirs. There are, in all probability, not many persons in Scotland who are aware of the origin of the name *Maxwell*. The first of this family, in this country, was also a follower of David, from whom he received a grant of land on the Tweed. The name of this person was *Maccus*, and his place of residence requiring the appropriate name of *Maccus-ville*, such a term was, in the course of time, shortened, and corrupted into *Maxwell*.—But of all these Anglo-Saxons who settled in Scotland, scarcely any that we hear of arrived at such eminence as that of *Sules*, or *Soulis*. The first of this line was Ranulph de Sules, who followed David from Northamptonshire into Scotland. The attachment of Ranulph was amply rewarded by a grant from him of Liddesdale, the manor of Nisbet, in Teviotdale, with some other lands, both in this district and in Lothian. In Liddesdale, where he thus settled before the middle of the twelfth century, he built a fortalice, called Hermitage Castle, which gave rise to the village of Castletown, and has been the subject of numberless popular traditions, some of which I shall perhaps, at an after period, detail. In 1271, William de Soulis was knighted at Haddington by Alexander III., and under the same monarch he became justiciary of Lothian. He was one of the *Magnates Scotiæ*, or principal men of the kingdom, who engaged in 1284 to support the succession of the Princess Margaret to her grandfather, Alexander III. In 1290, he was present with Sir John Soulis, in the celebrated parliament at Birgham—now a poor hamlet on the Tweed below Kelso—for betrothing the heiress of Scotland to the prince of England. This Sir John de Soulis was one of the ambassadors to France, for marrying Joletta, the daughter of the Count de Dreux, to Alexander III. In 1294 he again went to France—this will partly shew to the Scotch of the present day the species of intercourse that took place in former times betwixt the Scottish and French nations—to negotiate the marriage of Edward Baliol with a daughter of Charles, the French king's brother. In 1299 he was made *Custos Regni Scotiæ*—Keeper of the Scottish Kingdom—by John Baliol. In 1300 the same Sir John Soulis commanded at the siege of Stirling Castle, which was surrendered to him by the English. In 1303 he was one of the Scottish commissioners at Paris. At the capitulation of Strathurd, on the 9th of February, 1304, he was excepted by Edward I. from the ignominious conditions imposed on the vanquished, and it was provided that he should remain in exile for two years. When Robert Bruce entered on his active career, he was joined by Sir John Soulis, and for his services was rewarded with a grant of the baronies of Kirkandrews and Torthorwald, and the lands of Brettalach, in Dumfries-shire. Some years afterwards, he closed his gallant career as a soldier of Scotland. Following Edward Bruce to Ireland, he was slain with him in battle near Dundalk, on the 5th of October, 1318. These de Soulises had other two brothers; one named Sir Thomas de Soulis, of the county of Roxburgh, who swore fealty to Edward I. in 1296, and Sir Nicholas de Soulis. In 1300, Thomas was taken prisoner by the English in Galloway; and Edward I. ordered *fourpence a-day* to be paid as his allowance. This curious particular is learned from the Wardrobe accounts. It appears that in 1306, Alicia, the widow of Thomas de Soulis, did homage to Edward I. for lands in Scotland. It is a remarkable circumstance in the family history of the Soulises, that, among others, one of them laid claim to the crown of Scotland,—an event which overwhelmed and ruined the family altogether. The claimant was Nicholas de Soulis (supposed by some to have been the above Nicholas;) and the historian Prynne thus deduces the claim:—'Alexander II. left a bastard daughter, Margery, who married Allan Doorward, an active, ambitious baron, who died in 1275, leaving three daughters; one of these daughters, Ermingard—this beautiful female name was once common among the higher classes in Scotland—married a Soulis; and of this Soulis was Nicholas the competitor.' The seal of this ambitious man has been engraved by Astle, among the Scottish seals; but his armorial bearings are quite different from the arms of the Liddesdale family of Soulis, as set forth by Nisbet; from which circumstance there is reason to infer that there was some difference in the lineage. I leave better antiquaries and genealogists than myself, however, to clear up the obscurity. The next family I have to mention is that of *Avenel*; but here I stop for the present.

SKRYME.

Though popular narrative, when general and unvarying, is an authority by no means despicable; and though proverbial wisdom affirms that what all men say must be true; it cannot be denied that there are some common and general observations which bear all the marks of absurdity, and which to support, would argue utter credulity, or, what is worse, superstition. Most of my readers are acquainted with Skryme, the apothecary, who deals out doses of alarm for the mind, and confusion for the body, to the inhabitants of Little Britain, in the *Sketch Book*. This venerable gentleman has, in Scotland, many disciples and apostles, male and female, who entertain all sorts of strange and dark beliefs, and, in fact, form a part of the public entirely beyond the reach of the intelligence which is perpetually emanating in one shape or other from the press. Skryme's apostles assert, for instance, in defiance of all experience, that, if a culprit about to be hanged can get the appointed hour past, he may laugh at executioner, bailies, and all, and walk away a free man; also, that, if the rope breaks, he cannot be hung up again.* They believe, too, that Friday makes a point of being always the best or the worst day of the week; that men have one rib less than women, on Adam's account; and that the dove has no gall, in consequence of its sacred emblematical character, and its services at the Flood. They are dead-certain that the half of the people that die come alive again in the grave, and turn themselves round in their coffins. They believe, that horses, on account of the convexity of their eyes, think men larger than themselves, and otherwise would not submit to human government. They tell children, by way of encouraging an industrious disposition, that every member of the Royal Family is taught some trade, that he may be able to support himself by his hands should the craft of kingship fail him. George III. according to the Skrymists, was bred a shoemaker. They believe that cats see best in the dark; that bats have wings made of leather; that to take much salt, tends to make one dark-complexioned; that the man in the moon is a real man, who was put up there for gathering sticks on the Sabbath-day; and they are convinced that beasts have a language among themselves.

Among the natural objects which the disciples of Skryme have invested with supernatural attributes, rats are not the least distinguished. Rats, it is true, are a peculiar people; while the ignorance which generally prevails regarding them, gives a good deal of scope for the imagination. Rats, say the Skrymists, sometimes remove in whole nations. The old aboriginal rat of this country is now totally extirpated, or removed, and the present race is of German extraction, who came in soon after the accession of the House of Brunswick. They also remove in whole cities, occasionally in whole streets, or still more frequently in housefuls. It has been known in Edinburgh, that a whole street has all at once been evacuated, and a neighbouring one at the same instant taken possession of. One particular street in the New Town was last year announced to be completely hollowed out below, like a honeycomb, by rats, in consequence of which, the proprietors can tell that the houses have all been, this year, by a sort of poetical justice, very much underrated, in the way of rent. Rats are a sort of fair-weather friends in their way, always departing from a house when misfortune is about to befall it; and from a ship before the last fatal voyage.

It is very remarkable, that almost every town in Scotland has a street called the Rotten-Row: and, still more so, that with all the Rotten-Rows is associated some Skrymism upon the subject of these mysterious animals. There is a Rotten-Row at Dunfermline; and I shall relate the Skrymism connected with it:—On the day before the great fire in Dunfermline, in 1622, when almost every house was destroyed, the whole of the rats of the town gathered themselves together, and were observed to go out to the country in a leisurely and orderly manner by this narrow lane; the blind according to the established custom of rats, being led by their companions with straws in their mouths! Whatever credit may be given to it, the fact is attempted to be established by another equally incredible, but which several living witnesses remain to attest. On the day before a great inundation of the Dean Burn, which runs through Dunfermline, many rats were observed to leave their place of abode, near the banks of that stream, and climb, with their young, up a tall tree. By this means, they escaped the deluge that would otherwise have drowned them in their dens, and were enabled to look down with an air of cool contempt upon the two-footed people below, who, for want of the same providence, were exposed with their property to the raging fury of the flood.

THE RUSSIAN COURT.

At ten I called, in coach-and-four, upon Needham, to take him to the Court, at the Annishkoff Palace. The Court is like all other Courts. Here we remained with chamberlains, masters of ceremonies, grand chamberlains, generals, colonels, captains, &c., until about eleven, when we were presented in a circle to the Emperor. His imperial Majesty is a remarkably fine-looking man, of upwards of six feet in height. His countenance is open and ingenuous, his manner frank, but a little inclining to *brusque*. If I were to see such a man in a crowd, I should say "that man is born to be an emperor." He is thirty-six years of age, and is represented by all those who have access to his person, and who are well acquainted with his character, to be the model of a prince and of a man. His fine physiognomy is expressive of benignity, magnanimity, and intelligence. He received us in private audience, and, as we stood in a sort of semicircle, he went round and addressed something kind and pertinent to our professions and nation, to each of us. He asked me if I had ever seen in India anything of the cholera; to which I replied, that I had never served in India, but that I had had the complaint, commonly called the cholera morbus, twice in my life—once at Buenos Ayres, in South America, and once at Constantinople. His Majesty seemed surprised, and asked me how I was treated for it; to which I replied, the first time simply with barley-water made very sweet, and the second time with syrup of orjeat and water. I remarked, likewise, that the Arabs, who were well acquainted with the cholera, treated it with rice-water and sugar. "Ah!" said his Imperial Majesty, "you have not had the oriental cholera, but its first cousin; but," said he, "your remedy is deserving of notice." He observed, that he trusted that the measures he had caused to be taken, of quarantine and *cordon sanitaire*, would check the progress of the disorder; but, he added, it is very difficult in Russia to make the people pay obedience to sanitary regulations. "You, in England," said he, "respect and obey the law, and enforce the quarantine rigorously." I replied, that I hoped the excellent example set by himself, in performing fourteen days of quarantine, on his return from Moscow, would be productive of good effects.—*Frankland's Russia.*

* P.S I have since observed, in the ancient code of laws, known by the name of the *Regiam Majestatem*, that such was once the fact.

MAJOR WEIR.

The following account of this notorious sorcerer is from Fraser's *Divine Providences*, MS. Advocates' Library. It is the most minute and curious which the Editor of the Journal has ever met with, and possesses additional value, as the narrative of a contemporary. Fraser was a minister of the reign of Charles II.

"One Thomas Weir, whom I saw at Edinburgh, anno 1660, commonly called Captain Weir, was born in Clydesdale, near to Lanark, anno 1607, the son of one John Weir, first a peugh-maker and afterwards a farmer. About the year 1639, he took on with a Captain Young for Ireland, where, about the year of the massacre of that kingdom, he was made sergeant, and about the 45 (1645) turned lieutenant. In the 48 he came to Scotland; and Edinburgh being the metropolitan and centre of the kingdom, Thomas Weir made acquaintance with many, and not the worst, personating a deal of gravity and mistification, and frequenting sermons frequently, till, in the end, he went under the notice, and got the repute of a singular professor. At length, he got a charge over the waiters at the ports of the city, being a check to them. About the year 1650, he got the place of major in the town guard, and so was ever after called Major Weir. His garb was still a cloak, and somewhat dark, and he never went without his staff. He was a tall black man, and ordinarily looked down to the ground—a grim countenance and a big nose. At length he became so notourly regarded among the presbyterian strict sect, that, if four met together, be sure Major Weir was one. At private meetings, he prayed to admiration, which made many of that stamp court his converse. He never married, but lived in a private lodging with his sister, Grizel Weir. Many resorted to his house to hear him pray, and join with him; but it was observed, that he could not officiate in any holy duty without the black staff, or rod in his hand, and leaning upon it, which made those who heard him pray admire his flood in prayer, his ready extemporary expression, his heavenly gesture; so that he was thought more angel than man, and was termed by some of the holy sisters ordinarily *Angelical Thomas*. And yet, how wonderful it is, this vile counterfeit was a devil and a varlet, and was in compact with the devil, upwards of fifty years in his service, from whom he got the gift of utterance and this enchanted staff, for by it he was enabled to pray and to commit sins not fit to be named.

* * * * *

"By the use of this staff he was enabled to conciliate the favour of many, to reconcile neighbours, even husband and wife when at variance, which purchased him veneration with all, and brought him vast gain and profit. * *

* * In short, this villain lived all his time in horrid wickedness, especially the years that he abode at Edinburgh. At length, like the wild ass, [he] was found in his mouth. Coming one day, as his custom was, to view the waiters, he found them drinking and neglecting their charge. After a gentle reproach, one of them replied, that some of their number being upon duty, the rest had retired to drink with their old friend and acquaintance Mr. Burn; at which word Major Weir started back, and, casting an eye upon him, repeated the word *burn* four or five times, and going home, came not abroad again for a long time after. It was

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bserved by some, that going to Libberton sometim s, he hunned to step over that brook ordinarily called Libberton Burn, but went about to shun it. By this men have conjectured, and not amiss, that he had been advised to beware of burn, or some other thing which this equivocal word might signify, as *burn in a fire*. If so, he hath forseen his day approached nigh. A year before he discovered his imposture, he took a sore sickness, during which time he spake to all that visited him like an angel, and he came frequently abroad again. A while after this, he took some dreadful tortures of conscience, and, the terrors of the Almighty being upon his spirit, he called in several neighbours to his house, to whom he confessed, and that most willingly, the particular sins he was guilty of, with sad aggravations, which bred amazement to all persons, coming from a man of such repute of religion and piety. He ended with this remarkable expression, 'Before God,' says he, 'I have not told the hundredth part of that I could tell, and am guilty of.' These same very abominations he confessed before the judges likeways: but after this he would never, to his dying hour, confess any more which might have been to the glorifying of God and edification of others, but remained stupid and heavy, having no confidence to look any man in the face, or to open his eyes. When two of the magistrates of Edinburgh came to his house in the night time, to carry him to prison, they asked if he had any money to secure. He said none. His sister said there was. Whereupon, there was found in parcels here and there to the value of five dollars, which they took up. His sister advised the magistrates to secure his staff especially, which they did. Thereafter, he and his sister were both carried away and secured in the Tolbooth. The bailies returning home, went into a tavern at the West Bow, near to Weir's house, the money was put into a bag, and the clouts thrown into the fire, which, after an unusual manner, made a circling and dancing in the fire. There was another clout found with some hard thing in it, which also they threw into the fire. It looked like a root, which curled and sparked like gunpowder, and, passing up the funnel of the chimney, it gave a crack like a little cannon, to the amazement of all who were present. The foresaid money was taken by one of the bailies to his own house, and laid by in his closet. After family worship, he retired to the said closet, during which time his wife and the rest of the family were affrighted with a terrible noise within the study, like the falling of a house, three times successively. His wife, knocking, gave a fearful cry, saying, 'My dear, are you alive?' The bailie came out unaffraid, and said he heard nothing. Whether he concealed this upon the account that his wife was with child, or otherwise, is uncertain. The money was presently sent away to the other bailie's house, where was also heard some terrible disturbance, but in broken expression.

"During the time of his imprisonment, he was never willing to be spoken to; and when the ministers of the city offered to pray for him, he would cry out in fury, 'Torment me no more, for I am tormented already.' One minister asking if he would pray for him, he answered, 'Not at all!' The man, in a zealous anger, said, 'I will pray for you in spite of your teeth, and the devil, your master, too.' So he prayed in his hearing, and the witnesses observed that Weir stared wildly, and was senseless as a brute all the while. Another asked him if he thought there was a God; he said, 'I know not.' The other replied, 'O man! the argument that moves me to think there is a God, is thyself, for what else moveth thee to inform the world of thy wicked life.' But Weir answered, 'Let me alone.' When he peremptorily forbad one of his parish ministers to pray, one demanded if he would have one of the presbyterian persuasion to pray. He answered, 'Sir, you are now all alike to me.'—'Then,' said the minister to him, 'I will pray with you.' 'Do it not,' said he, 'upon your peril,' looking up to the beams of the house. But prayer was made so much the more heartily, because the company present expected some vision. It is observable, that in things common he was pertinent enough; but when any thing about Almighty God, and his soul's condition, came about, he would scraugh, and strike his breast, crying, 'Torment me not before the time.'

"At length, he was sentenced to be burnt; and when the account of this was given him, he stood mute and stupid. When he was at the stake to be burnt, the city ministers called to a cunning man there looking on, a presbyterian, (of which persuasion Weir was formerly deemed to be,) to speak to him; but no sooner had he opened his mouth than the vile wretch made a sign with his hand and his head to be silent. When the rope was about his neck, to prepare him for the fire, he was bid say, 'Lord be merciful to me!' but he answered, 'Let me alone. I will not. I have lived as a beast, and I must die as a beast' The fire being kindled, he dropped a little after into the flames—a sad spectacle to behold; and, shortly after, his black staff was cast into the fire with him. Whatever incantation was in it, the persons present aver that it gave rare turnings, and was long a burning, as also himself.

"Major Weir was brought to his dreadful, desperate, and yet deserved death, April 14, 1670, at the Gallow Lee, between Leith and Edinburgh."

THE RUNAWAY.

AN ENGLISH TALE, BY MISS MITFORD.

One of the most retired-looking spots in our thickly-peopled neighbourhood, is the pretty little nook called Sandleford Green; a small, very small patch of green sward, formed by a casual receding of the fields at a place where two narrow shady lanes cross each other, leaving just room enough, in one angle, for a clear mirror-like pond, with glorious old thorns dipping into it from the surrounding hedges; whilst a village pond, enclosing a noble oak, occupies another corner; and a third is completely overshadowed by two large horse-chestnut trees, standing like sentinels on either side of a gate, which leads through a short deep lane to the only dwelling within sight or hearing. No spot is, apparently, so entirely out of the way and out of the world as Sandleford Green! And yet the well-beaten footpaths, two or three of which, striking in different directions across the fields, met in this spot as a common centre, intimated that the little Green was a place of some resort—as indeed it actually was—not so much as a thoroughfare, but from its own independent attraction. The one solitary and unostentatious tenement of which it boasted, being famous all through the county for its home-brewed ale: the fine Sandleford beer, most emphatically called strong, holding so high a rank amongst the consumers of that formidable beverage, that people sent for it far and near; and the liveried groom of two or three neighbouring squires might often be seen galloping on their thorough-bred hunters to seek this only liquor worthy to wash down their master's Stilton, at the same moment that poor Dame Wheeler's little girl was crossing the stile for her sick grandmother's daily half-pint; and half the rustics in the parish pouring in to enjoy, in Joseph Dobson's own tap-room, or beneath his honeysuckled-porch, their own less moderate potations. "First come first served," was Joseph's motto; and although, on the whole, a man of impartiality, it is doubtful whether he had not some pleasure in keeping the lacqueys in attendance, and the grandees whom they served in expectation, whilst he administered to the wants of his humbler and more sociable customers. A chuckling, bustling, merry knave was our landlord, and a freespoken: had a vote for the county, which he regularly bestowed on the opposition candidate, be the ministers whom they might. Joseph thought no honest man could ever vote for the ministry—that was his creed: owed no one a shilling, and was too confident in the power of his ale to have any dread of the magistrates and the license act:—"Old Sir Thomas can't finish his dinner without a glass of my beer," thought Joseph; "and I may be as saucy and independent as I please."

Whatever might be the merits of the Sandleford ale, there could be no question as the beauty and picturesqueness of Joseph's habitation. It was a high, narrow, tower-like house, with chimneys like turrets, and every sort of gable end and inequality of which a building is capable, harmonised and enriched by an old vine, which, after creeping up one side of the house, nearly covered the roof, garlanding the very chimneys, and wreathing its luxuriant abundance of leaf, and fruit, and tendril, wherever a shoot could find place, until it fairly hung over on the other side—until its rich festoons nearly met the branchy honeysuckle, (Milton's "twisted eglantine,") which, climbling up, shaded a rude but fanciful and airy porch, such as is often seen in Wouverman's pictures, adding grace and lightness even to them. Nor was the garden, which reached, on one side, to a small meandering brook, the large garden, full of beds of vegetables and berry bushes, almost hidden by wide flower-borders, very nicely kept; or the long strip of beautiful green sward, the meadow, orchard, or pleasure-ground, (for it might pass for either of these,) with its fine grove of old fruit-trees—pear plum, cherry, and apple—terminated by its smooth bowling-green and goodly arbour, at all unworthy of the picturesque dwelling to which they were appended. The territory behind, a miniature farm-yard, with stabling for two, cart-room for one, a commodious cow-shed, and pigsties, goose-houses, and hen-houses, out of number, its populous duck-pond, and its abundance of noises—horses neighing, cows lowing, calves bleating, pigs grunting, geese gabbling, ducks quacking, cocks crowing, hens cackling, and doves cooing—was also a lively stirring scene, especially when animated by the presence of mine host, portly, sturdy, and comely, an excellent representative of his own brown stout, with twenty pigeons fluttering about him, (for Joseph amongst other fancies, was a great pigeon-fancier,) and two or three pet tumblers or fantails perched on his shoulder. In short, every thing about the place, from the two rosy smiling lasses, his daughters, down to the fat yard-dog and sleek tabby cat, seemed emblems of rural plenty and English independence; meet appendages to the sign of the Foaming Tankard, which swung in creaking magnificence from a post in front of the dwelling.

By far the most interesting inmate of this small village hostelry, was one, whose whole appearance formed the strongest possible contrast to the rest of that flourishing establishment. Mary Walker, the only child of the good landlord's only sister, was a tall thin young woman, with a pale, mild, serious countenance, great simplicity of dress and manner, and a general delicacy both of look and demeanour, belonging partly, perhaps, to ill health, but so much connected with a natural elegance of mind, that it hushed even her boisterous uncle and his boisterous customers into something like gentleness; just as the presence of a born gentlewoman might have done, if it were possible to fancy a born gentlewoman seated in the tap-room of the Foaming Tankard.

To say truth, the tap-room was a place that Mary seldom visited. The noise, the talking, the singing, the smell of tobacco, or even the odour of the famous Sandleford beer, would have kept her from that well-frequented resort of the thirsty souls of the village, even if the dread of encountering some of her many lovers had not been sufficient to hinder her from putting her foot across the threshold.

The cause of Mary Walker's many conquests might be found, perhaps, (at least *she* certainly thought so,) in the circumstance of her being a rustic heiress, having just so many hundreds of pounds as made her a great match in her own degree; the cause of her being, at two-and-twenty, unwedded, and unlikely to wed, will take rather more telling, although the story be short enough, and common enough too.

Joseph Dobson had had a son, called William, as unlike his father as possible; a gay, lively, mercurial spirit, too quick, or, as his poor mother used to say, too clever to learn—too ready at many trades to stick steadily to one; and so full of varying schemes and changeful resources, that every body, except that doting mother, felt convinced, that, in spite of William's acknowledged talent, his destiny would prove unprosperous.

The only chance for its being otherwise, lay in his strong affection for his fair cousin, Mary Walker. Her influence over him, especially after the death of his fond but misjudging mother, who had fostered his wild and expensive habits, by supplying him with money for their indulgence, formed the only counteraction to his natural and acquired unsteadiness of character. Even his father, although knowing him best and fearing him most, looked forward, with some degree of hope, to the period when he should be quietly married to Mary; and she herself—(how strange it is, that the mildest and most reflective woman should be so often carried off her feet by the giddiest wild-goose of a man!) she herself idolised him; overturned all the disinterested objections of her uncle and guardian, to risking her money and her happiness with so flighty a swain; and even laid aside much of her own timidity, to hasten, as far as her natural modesty would permit, the proposed union.

On the very evening before the intended marriage, William, who, amongst his other caprices, was frequently subject to the fury of jealousy, was seized with a violent fit of that amiable passion, the object being no other than George Bailey, my Lord's gamekeeper, as good-natured a fellow as ever lived, and a constant visitor at the sign of the Foaming Tankard. He had brought two tame pheasants, a cock, and a hen, as a present to Mary, who was known to be fond of pet poultry; "a wedding present," as he had whispered at parting, and Mary, unluckily, had admired the beauty of the birds.

"You like the birds for the sake of the giver, Mary," said William, chafed at the warmth with which George had shaken hands with her in the moment of departure, and the mingled blush and smile with which she had received his whispered farewell; "you are thinking of the master's good looks, of his gay plumage, and not of the birds."

"The master thinks little of me, or I of him. You are quite mistaken as to both of us," replied Mary.

"You admire the beauty of the donor," pursued William, pertinaciously; "you talk of the pheasants, but you are thinking of him."

"Not I indeed!" exclaimed Mary.

"But you are, I say, madam," resumed William, with increasing violence. "George Bailey is the beau of the parish, as you are the belle. We all know that; and for my poor part, I think it a great pity that you should be separated."

"If *you* think so, William," said poor Mary, and then, unable to finish the sentence, burst into tears.

"Well, madam, if I think so"—

"Then—oh William! William! how cruel this is, when you know that I love you, and nobody but you, in this wide world."

"If I think so, madam, then—pray finish what you were going to say. There is nothing I hate so much as these sort of scenes."

"Then," said Mary, resuming her firmness, "we had better part."

"Certainly, madam, we had better part; I agree with you perfectly," said the intended bridegroom, walking out of the house, without listening to the threats of his father, the remonstrances of his sisters, or even the gentle assurances of Mary herself, that neither George Bailey nor she had ever thought of each other.

Joseph Dobson stormed, his little daughters fretted and wondered, and poor Mary cried; but all fully expected that that night at supper-time, or, at latest, by peep of dawn, William would re-appear, repent, and be forgiven; for a temper "which carried anger as the flint doth fire," had the redeeming grace of being eminently sweet and sunshiny, especially after one of these sudden storms; so that Mary, after feeling the exceeding delight of reconciliation, used sometimes to wonder whether she should like William as well, if he were always quiet and civil like other people. Mary cried, expecting to be comforted; but the comforter whom she expected did not arrive. The evening passed away—the night—the next morning, that which would have been the bridal morning!—the day—the intended wedding-day!—and still no tidings of William. His father traced him to London; and then came a report that he was gone on board ship—he had had such a fancy in his boyhood, engendered by reading Robinson Crusoe; and then came rumours of shipwreck, at first doubtfully listened to, but gradually believed, as month after month, and year after year, glided by, without any tidings arriving of the unhappy fugitive. Surely if he had been alive he would have written, was the secret thought and feeling of all.

In his own home, long absence had produced its usual effect; and things had returned to their ordinary course, with little reference to the life or death of the young man. His father, first immoderately angry, then intemperately grieved, had resumed his former jovial temper and bustling habits; his light-hearted sisters had ceased to hope or fear, or lament; and his old companions had well nigh forgotten that he had ever existed. Forgotten, indeed, he was by every body except poor Mary, who cherished his memory with the gentle sadness of a young widow, and turned from love and lovers with the fond fidelity of a turtle dove that has lost its mate. Never was heart more devoted and true; as Ben Brown, the fat exciseman, and Aaron Keep, the lean shoemaker, and tall Jem Ward, the blacksmith, and little Bob Wheatley, the carpenter, besides at least a score more of rejected suitors, could testify—George Bailey being nearly the only young man in the parish who had never made Mary Walker an offer, having, within three months of the pheasant present, brought home a very sufficient reason for not doing so, in the shape of an exceeding pretty black-eyed wife. Poor Mary! she would have done wisely in following the example of the rest of the world, and forgetting William Dobson; but, as she used to say, when urged on the subject, she could not.

Meanwhile time rolled on, and it was now some years

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since any thing had been heard of him. May was drawing towards its close—that loveliest month, which joins the spring flowers with the summer leaves. The country was in its prime of beauty; and Sandleford Green, with its pearly bunches of hawthorn overhanging and reflected in the clear bright pond, the horse-chestnuts covered with their pyramidal flowers, the golden broom skirting round the meadows where the young lambs were at play, the orchard one glow of blossom, the lilacs and laburnums scenting the arbour, and the honeysuckle perfuming the porch. Sandleford was the sweetest and prettiest of all country places; and Mary was standing under the honeysuckle, looking at the blue sky, and the green grass, and the flowery fruit-trees so gay in the sunshine, and thinking how wrong it was in her not to be happy, when all on a sudden the good landlord advanced from the farm-yard with a troubled countenance, calling for Mary, and Bessy, and Kate, a mess of milk, a jug of ale, and a bottle of brandy. "There's a man lying dead or dying in the cart-house, added he; "make haste, lasses! make haste!"

Mary, catching at the hope of life, hurried into the house to despatch some messenger for medical assistance; his daughters flew to his assistance, and half the customers in the tap-room followed with instinctive curiosity to the cart-house.

The man was not dead; and mine host and little Kate were administering, or rather offering, (for he seemed incapable either of speaking or swallowing,) their various remedies.

"Who can he be, father?" said Kate; "what can have brought him here?"

"How should I know, child?" replied the man of the Tankard; "'tis a poor ragged famished wretch, as you see who, I suppose, could crawl no farther. But I think he'll live! He's looking about him! and he seems likely to come to. Get your cousin's smelling-bottle, Bessy; and don't crowd round him so, good folks! Why, even Neptune has crept up to him, and is half smothering the poor wretch. That looks as if it was somebody the dog knew."

And the poor creature, the sick, famished, ragged creature writhed on his straw, and groaned and gasped as if for speech.

"Where are Mary's suits, girls? See how Neptune's licking the poor wretch's hands! Where is Mary?"

And at that instant Mary entered; the sick man half rose up, and she knew him! "William! gracious God! 'tis William!" And instantly she was kneeling at his side, and supporting him in her arms, aided, as it happened, by our old friend the keeper, who had been taking his morning draught in the tap. Poor William looked from one to the other—

"Are ye married?" said he, with a strong effort.

"Yes," said George; "no," said Mary; both in a breath.

"To think of my not knowing my own son!" exclaimed the father, bending over him, the tears running over his rough cheeks. "But his very mother could not have known him so fond of him as she used to be! Nobody would, but Mary Welcome home, my boy! We'll soon set thee up again. Welcome, my own dear boy!"

"Welcome home, dear William!" echoed the sobbing sisters.

But William listened to none of them, "Are you married!" was again his question.

"Yes!" said George, smiling.

"But not to me, William! not to me, dear William!" said Mary: and the poor runaway grasped her hand between his trembling ones (Neptune fondling them all the time,) and life, and health, and love, were in the pressure; and the toils, the wanderings, the miseries of his four years' absence, were all forgotten in that moment of bliss!—*Literary Souvenir*, 1832.

SKETCHES IN TOPOGRAPHY.

EDINBURGHSHIRE.

It is ascertained that, before the close of the eleventh century, agriculture had made some progress in the district of Mid-Lothian, though, at that period, and an epoch much later, the greater part of the shire continued to be covered by the aboriginal forests of the country. The district contiguous to the fortress of Edinburgh, now disposed in fertile lawns, was then covered by primeval forests of oaks, within whose boundaries royalty enjoyed the diversions of hunting; and if we may credit the legend, it was in the wood of Drumsheugh that David I. encountered the stag, under such miraculous circumstances as led to the erection of the religious house of Holyrood. The grants to different monasteries, shew that woods and shrubberies must have prevailed to a great extent, and been serviceable not only for fuel, but for yielding shelter, pasturage, and food, for numerous brood-mares, cattle, sheep, and swine. Edward III. did much to diminish the extent of the forests; but although, in his time and subsequently, the woods of Mid-Lothian suffered a sensible diminution, it is found that, as late as 1513, the Borough-moor, whereon James IV. mustered the army of the kingdom, before setting out for Flodden, was, according to Hawthornden, "a field spacious and delightful, by the shade of many stately and aged oaks. In the history of Edinburgh it is recorded that these "aged oaks" were rooted out as a public nuisance—all citizens who chose to cut wood being permitted, as a premium for their industry, to use it in extending their houses seven feet into the street. We may here notice, as indicating the aptness of the soil for this species of production, that the grounds still bear some of the largest trees in the country. During the last and the present century, much has been done in Mid-Lothian in the way of rearing plantations. At Dalkeith, Newbottle, (now and improperly called *Newbattle*; the word signifying "the new residence," from *botil*, a Saxon term,) Arniston, New Hailes, and Pipkie, there is some remarkably fine hard wood of a large size. At Newbottle, the trees, which are chiefly beech, are unrivalled in their exuberance and magnitude, seeming, from their gnarled branches, as aged as the days of the Abbot Radulphus, in the thirteenth century. Around every gentleman's seat in the country there are modern plantations, sometimes to a very large extent, which add beauty to the district, and give shelter to the fields. In the upland tract of country, stretching towards Peeblesshire, between the Pentland and Moorfoot Hills, a vast extent of territory has, of late years, been very judiciously planted by the family of Clerk of Penycuick. Rabbit warrens seem to have been common in Mid-Lothian in the days of the monks, but they are now entirely gone.

In old times, there were extensive pasturages for sheep on Gala Water, a district still principally devoted to such purposes; and, in old writings, often called *Wae-dale*, from the doleful events which had taken place in it: this term is, most probably, the original of the surname *Weddel*. The other parts of the country were farmed by the three great classes, the king, the abbots, and the barons, each of whom had extensive commons free to the flocks of their immediate vassals or neighbours. From such a primitive process of management, a system gradually arose in the county of landlords giving their vassals leases of farms with stock, which was rented as well as the land, and which the tenant was obliged to restore, when he delivered up the farm to its owner. Practices of this nature were copied from the example of the freeholders of England, and obtained, by the law of Scotland, the name of letting lands by *steel-bow*. In examining the early agricultural condition of Mid-Lothian, it is found that this part of Scotland, as well as Haddingtonshire, at one time abounded in the three good characteristics of a country—mills, kilns, and breweries; and, from the increase of these establishments, is inferred the progress of agriculture. Mid and East-Lothian were likewise noted, during the Scoto Saxon period, for their superior horticulture. The monks of Newbotle and Holyrood, like their brethren everywhere else in Scotland, not only employed much of their leisure time in the delightful amusement of gardening, but, by their example, fostered the arts of cultivating flowers and rearing fruit-trees. Near Edinburgh, there thus originated some pleasant gardens. It appears that David I. had a garden under the castle, now entirely gone, but the garden of Holyrood still remains, and attests, by its appearance, the culture it must have received from its religious attendants upwards of six hundred years since. During the reign of James III. even the poorest tenants in Mid Lothian had their gardens, which supplied them with *kail*; and before the accession of James VI. gardens were universal in the district.

Scotland owes the introduction of the use of coal to the monks of Newbotle, who had the merit of discovering this valuable substance. Till about the end of the twelfth century, the common fuel of the inhabitants was either wood or peat. Grants of *peataries* for fuel were exceedingly common at this and a later period. In their parish of Preston, in Haddingtonshire, the monks of Newbotle discovered and wrought coal, before the accession of Alexander II. of the year 1214. The practice of digging for coal spread from thence into Edinburgshire; and I find that, at the accession of James I., there were collieries at Duddingston, Gilmerton, Newbotle, and other places. The discovery of coal, nevertheless, did not, by any means, abolish the use of the ancient and more easily acquired fuel, as I find that in Edinburgh in 1584, the ordinary fuel was wood, heath, whins, broom, &c. Great stacks of these were piled up in the different lanes, for the use of the inhabitants, in the same manner as peat-stacks may still be seen in villages remote from coal. It happened that one of these piles was set on fire in the night, either intentionally or casually, which so much alarmed the inhabitants, that the Town Council immediately issued an order for removing the stacks to the side of the North Loch, and other waste ground around the city. The making of salt from the water of the Frith of Forth seems to have been known in the country at least a hundred years before the introduction of coal as fuel; indeed, the invention of manufacturing sea-salt in this way is so ancient, that it cannot be dated. [The small coal used in this manufacture is still, oddly enough, called *wood*.] Grants of salt-pans to abbeys were numerous in the thirteenth century. David I. granted a salt-pan to the monks of Holyrood in 1128. And I learn, from the chartularies of Newbotle, that that establishment had salt-pans on the Forth in the twelfth and thirteenth centuries. The mode of manufacturing this article was, however, very rude; but the French retinue of Queen Mary comprised some ingenious persons, who amended the process; and, in the ninth parliament of that princess, they obtained an act, conferring upon them the exclusive privilege of manufacturing this article. By an act of Parliament in the reign of Charles II., these, and all other saltworks, were declared to be free, and deemed public manufactures.

The roads of the country remained long in a bad condition, though in this they were not in any respect singular. The chief roads, anciently, were only those betwixt the different monasteries, and from thence to the metropolis. Under the reign of Alexander III. the term *regia via* is found applied, and hence the phrase, in our times, *king's* highway. There was a *regia via* betwixt Newbotle and Edinburgh. The first statutes, with regard to highways, are said to have been made under David II., but it was not till so late as 1714 that any turnpike act was applied to the county. For many years even after that period, the necessity of good roads was neither understood nor acted upon; and it may be said that here, as well as elsewhere, a perfect convenience of this kind was unknown till the age immediately past. The roads in the county of Edinburgh are now the best in Scotland, though sustained at a most enormous expense—(I believe 50,000*l.* a year). They possess the advantage—now by no means uncommon in Scotland—of having footpaths by the edge of the highway. It is mentioned as a remarkable fact in Robertson's Survey, that wheel-carriages were not used for purposes of husbandry in Mid-Lothian till the accession of George I., and this may give an idea of the general condition of Scotland at that recent period. Yet, it is a fact no less true, that wheeled carts and waggons, waggons, were used by the monks in husbandry five centuries and a half before the reign of the first George. To reconcile these conflicting statements, it may be presumed that, for a very long period, there was an age of misery in Scotland during which the troubles occasioned, in the first place, by English ambition, and, in the second, by religious contests and other difficulties, prevented the spirit of the nation from cultivating the arts which lead to increased comfort and extended means of supporting a population.—*Gazetteer of Scotland*. Thomas Ireland, Jun. Edinburgh, 1832.

To be continued.

American Musquitoes.—The musquitoes seldom annoyed us at mid-day; but when we wished to enjoy the refreshing coolness of a morning or evening's walk, they fastened on us with their infernal stings, against which we had no defence except leather. By smoking, we might indeed keep them at a civil distance from our noses and the parts thereunto adjacent; but this was a preventive which, if constantly practised, would have in a short time reduced our tobacco to a small quantity. The annoyance during our meals was worse. We were obliged to have an iron pot at each end of the table, filled with saw-dust or rotten wood; which substance, when ignited, produced a quantity of thick smoke without flame. It effectually drove them away; but it was a desperate remedy; for during the process of mastication we were nearly suffocated from the dense clouds of vapour by which we were enveloped. In the mean time our tormentors hovered about the doors and windows, watching the gradual dispersion of the smoke; and the moment the atmosphere became sufficiently clear, they charged in from all directions on our heads, necks, ears, faces, and hands, from whence it was impossible to dislodge them, until a fresh supply of saw-dust, thrown over the dying embers, put them once more to flight. The horses also suffered severely from these insects and the horse flies. We caused several fires of rotten wood to be made in the prairie in which they were grazing, and round which they instinctively congregated to avail themselves of the protection afforded by the smoke. Those which had short tails and cropped manes suffered more than the others; for with these weapons of nature (of which, in America, at all events, it is cruel to deprive them) they could whisk off great numbers of the enemy; while the cropped horses, having no such defence, often had their hoofs and legs severely burned by standing in the fires to avoid the stings of their assailants. I have often observed the poor animals, when the smoke began to evaporate, gallop up to the fort, and neigh in the most significant manner for a fresh supply of damp fuel; and on perceiving the men appointed for that purpose proceed to the different fires, they followed them, and waited with the most sagacious patience until the smoke began to descend and disperse their tormentors.—*Cox's Columbia River.*

EMIGRATION.

The editor has been favoured with the perusal of a letter, written by a young Edinburgh lawyer, from the United States of America, whither he had gone to prosecute his professional pursuits. The following extract will, doubtless, be esteemed of value by many readers of the Journal:

"*Rochester, Monroe County, N. Y.*

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"Before I proceed with my promised observations, I must give you some information about my own proceedings since I came to Rochester. Since I came hither I have been in three different offices, and have now as good prospects as any young man of my profession in the place. You are, perhaps, aware that seven years is the period of clerkship necessary to be gone through before being admitted to the bar of the Supreme Court of this State, but that four years' classical studies are received in lieu of legal education. The term of clerkship is fixed by one of the judges of the Supreme Court. I had to produce all the certificates from the different professors, and the length of the terms of the universities of Scotland. The Chief Justice before whom my case came, at the term of the court of Albany in July last, stated that he could allow nothing whatever for the period of my clerkship or legal studies in Scotland, and that even an admission in the Supreme Court there, or any other foreign court, would avail me nothing. He stretched the rule of court, however, as far as possible, and fixed my period of probation, or clerkship, at three years, after which, on examination, I can be admitted to practise as attorney and *counsellor* in any Court of Common Pleas in any county in this State, and as attorney in the Supreme Court. The Courts of Common Pleas are, in themselves, as important as the Supreme Court, only their jurisdiction is confined to a particular county, and an appeal lies from their decision to the Supreme Court. I am quite satisfied with the period of clerkship assigned to me by the court; for, during my probation, I am, of course, strengthening my interest here, and preparing myself for the great arena of legal disputation on which I shall ultimately appear, and when I shall have to cope with very different men from the county writers of Scotland. I have, besides, much to study; for really my legal education in Scotland will be of exceedingly little value here. You will understand that the English common law is in full force in this and most other States in the Union, unless where altered by special statute; and the courts of judicature in this State, although greatly improved in comparison with the English, are still essentially English in their operation. Now, there is scarcely a single step of the legal proceedings here that bears the least degree of similarity to the Scotch practice: every step, even to the backing of a paper, is entirely different. It has, accordingly, cost me, since I came to this place, some pretty hard study to comprehend the practice of the courts. I am now, however, fast acquiring such a knowledge, and I expect that, in a short time, I shall be as good a practitioner as my brethren. Perseverance will surmount all difficulties. What a noble field English jurisprudence

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opens to the mind! I feel every day more attached to the study. We read in it, not a collection of dry maxims and wise sayings, but a great system, every part of which is linked inseparably together, and the whole founded and interwoven with the great principles of civil liberty. Well may Britons claim it as their birthright, and well has Lord Coke described it as the perfection of human reason.

"This place is well adapted for making good lawyers. The justices' courts here form an excellent preparatory school for young men. The justices are elected by the people for four years, and have jurisdiction in personal property to the extent of 50 dollars—(nearly 2*l.* sterling.) Young law students are almost always employed by the litigants. The proceedings are conducted on the same model as the other courts, and with nearly the same solemnity. A jury is empannelled, if either party desires it; the case is opened by the counsel of the plaintiff; witnesses are then examined on each side; the counsel on each side address the jury, or the justice, after the case is closed, with all the eloquence and force of argument they are master of. The judge charges the jury; the jury retire, deliberate, and return their verdict; in short, the proceedings are exactly the same in these inferior tribunals as you see in the Jury Court in Edinburgh, and that although the sum in dispute be comparatively small. I have already been engaged in several of these suits, and have had the honour of addressing an American jury in a speech of half an hour's length in a justice court: I have also been complimented on my success. The fees which the young lawyers get for conducting a case of this kind, are about 10*s.* or 15*s.* sterling if in town, and about 1*l.* if in the country. My remuneration, at present, from my employer, goes to pay all my expenses. In a future letter I shall tell you something about the courts in this state, and the character and talent of our lawyers here; at present I may only say, that I have a high opinion of them generally."

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IRON BRIDGES.

The credit of having first suggested the practicability of constructing bridges of iron, has been claimed for Thomas Paine, who is said to have conceived the idea from contemplating the fabrication of a spider's web in America. Whatever may be thought of this assertion, it is certain that, in 1787, Paine presented to the academy of sciences at Paris the model of a bridge which he had invented; and it is equally a fact, that during the greater part of the year following he resided at Rotherham in Yorkshire, where a bridge, chiefly of wrought iron, was constructed under his direction, by the Messrs. Walker. What ever may have been the precise principle of this pattern bridge, it was taken to London; exhibited there for a time; returned again to Rotherham, and there broken up. Pieces of this fabric were not long since to be seen on the premises of Messrs. Walker; some of which pieces were occasionally carried away as curiosities, by persons preferring a fragment of the handy-work to a relic of the osseous system of the famous author of the "Rights of Man!" It appears, however, from designs now or lately in the possession of Mr. White of Devonshire Place, that Mr. Pritchard, an architect, of Eyton Turret, Shropshire, so early as the year 1773, suggested the practicability of constructing wide iron arches, capable of admitting the passage of the water of such a river as the Severn; and, in fact, the first practical exhibition of the plan, on a large scale, was the construction of the bridge at Colebrook Dale, chiefly in accordance with Mr. Pritchard's plans.

In 1790, Rowland Burdon conceived the idea of throwing an arch of cast iron over the river Wear, at Sunderland; for which, two years afterwards, and after surmounting some opposition, he obtained an act of Parliament. The use of iron had previously been introduced in the construction of the arch at Colebrook Dale, and in the bridges built by Paine. Mr. Burdon's plan consisted in retaining, together with the metallic material, the usual form and principles of the stone arch, by the subdivision of the iron into blocks, answering to the key stones of a common arch. These blocks were of cast iron, five feet in depth and four in thickness, connected together by bars and cottars of wrought iron. The entire structure consists of six ribs, each containing 105 of these blocks, abutting on each other like the voussoirs of a stone arch. The ribs are six feet distance from each other, braced together by hollow tubes and bridles of cast iron. The whole weight of the iron is 260 tons; 46 malleable, and 214 cast. The arch is the segment of a large circle, of which the chord or span is 236 feet. This magnificent structure, which was executed at the foundery of the Messrs. Walker of Rotherham, was completed within three years; Mr. Thomas Wilson, of Bishop Wearmouth, being the architect. This bridge was, at the time of its erection, considered to be the largest arch in the world; and being placed, too, at a considerable elevation above the river, it forms a remarkably picturesque object. The whole expense of the undertaking was 26,000*l.*, of which sum 22,000*l.* was subscribed by Mr. Burdon, the original projector. This famous bridge was, in October, 1816, disposed of by lottery, consisting of 6000 tickets; and 150 prizes, of the value of from 100*l.* to 5,000*l.*, to the total amount of 30,000*l.*

About 40 years afterwards, a still more stupendous achievement in cast iron was exhibited in the metropolis. This was the famous Southwark bridge of three arches, constructed over the River Thames, and which was likewise executed at the foundery at Rotherham, the first casting having been run on New year's day, 1815; the whole of the articles, including of course the models, occupying about two years in the execution. The engineer was John Rennie, Esq., who originally intended that the outer planting of the centre arch should have been divided into seven segments, instead of thirteen, its present number. The practical difficulty of casting such immense pieces, however, led to the adoption of the arrangement which the structure now exhibits. These plates being too large to be covered with boxes in the manner of other similar castings, were moulded in "open sand;" that is, the models, after being sufficiently impressed upon the sand, were removed, and the metal suffered to flow into its bed, the surface being merely formed by the level of the molten lake. The erection of this wonderful triumph of foundery ingenuity occupied about two years, and the bridge was opened to the public on the 25th of March, 1819. Its weight and dimensions are as follow:—

Span of the centre arch	240 feet.
Rise of the springing	24 feet.
Span of the two side arches	210 feet each.
Piers	24 feet thick.
Width of the roadway	28 feet.
Width of the footpaths	7 feet each.
Weight of metal in centre arch	1665 tons.
Weight in two side arches	2920 tons.
	4585 tons.

In 1827 Mr. Deeble, a metropolitan engineer, obtained a patent for an ingenious method of casting metal blocks for the purpose of forming caissons, jetties, piers, quays, embankments, lighthouses, foundations, walls, or other such erections. These blocks, which are hollow cases, so cast as to fit into each other by grooves and dovetails, and other contrivances, would form masses of exceeding strength in combination. There is, however, one fatal objection to their adoption in situations where they might be most useful: the sea water, by some unexplained process, so alters the nature of cast iron, that its cohesion appears to be quite destroyed. Cannon, which have been fished up after lying long in the sea, have been found converted through their substance into something resembling plumbago, and admitting of being cut with a knife.—*Lardner's Cyclopædia.*

BIOGRAPHIC SKETCHES.

DR. ALEXANDER MURRAY.

This was the son of a poor Galloway shepherd, who finally died professor of Oriental Languages in the College of Edinburgh, and author of various works in the *science of language*, which the world has declared to be more profoundly learned than almost any other that exist. The narrative which follows was written by himself, to satisfy the curiosity of a friend; and, as an account of the triumph of genius over difficulties, I can only compare it to that of Ferguson the astronomer.

"I was born on Sunday, the 22d of October, 1775, and baptized a fortnight after, on Tuesday, 7th November—stated in the register of baptisms to be the 27th, but the old style is understood (in the register). The place were my father then lived is called Dunkitterick, or commonly Kitterick; in Earse Dun-cheatharaiach,—the *know* of the cattle. It is on the burn of Palneur, on the south side about a quarter of a mile from the burn, and on a rivulet that flows from the high hill above on the south. The hills of Craigneilder, Milfore, and others, quite overshadow the spot, and hide it from the sun for three of the winter and spring months. The cottage has been in ruins for more than twenty years, as the farm is *herded* from the house of Tenotrie, the tenant of which holds both Tenotrie and Kitterick. This place, now laid open by a road, was, when my father lived there, in a completely wild glen, which was traversed by no strangers but smugglers. Patrick Heron's family, in Craigdews, were our next neighbours; and the black rocks of Craigdews were constantly in our sight. My father, Robert Murray, had been a shepherd all his days. He was born in autumn 1706, and remembered the time of the battle of Sheriffmuir. Our clan were, as he said, originally from the Highlands. My great grandfather, Alexander Murray, had been a tenant, I believe, of Barnkiln, near the present site of Newton Stewart, but he had retired into Minigaff village before his death. He had several sons. John, my grandfather, was all his life a shepherd. He married, when he was young, a woman of the name of Helen M'Caa. His *children* were—Patrick, father of old John Murray in Blackcraig, my father, (Robert born in Garlarg,) William, John, and Grisel. My grandfather herded almost all his married lifetime, the farm of Craigencallie, rented by old Patrick Heron, Esq., of Heron. My father married, about 1730, a woman of the name of Margaret M'Dowal, and had by her many children—Agnes, John, William, Robert, James, some of these are still alive,—very old people. All the boys became shepherds. My father lived chiefly in a place called Garrarie, on the river Dee, opposite to Craigencallie, and in the parish of Kells. His wife died, I think, about 1770. In December, 1774, or rather in January, 1775, he married my mother, whose name is Mary Cochrane. She was the daughter of a shepherd also, who came originally from the parish of Balmaghie, and whose forefathers had been small tenants on the estate of Woodhall. She was born August 13, 1739, and was more than thirty-five years old at the time of her marriage. My father was then in his sixty-ninth year, which he had completed before I was born. When I became of age to know him, except his very grey, or rather white, hair, I remember no symptoms of the influence of time about his person or in his appearance. He enjoyed *hale* good health till about a year before his death, which took place at Torwood, or Derwood, in the parish of Kells, in August, 1797.

"He had been taught to read English in a good style for his time; he wrote not badly, but exactly like the old men of the seventeenth century. He had a considerable share of acuteness or natural sagacity, a quality possessed by most of his clan. His temper was rather irritable, but not passionate. His moral character was habitually good, and I know from his way of talking in private about the thefts and rogueries of other persons, that he actually detested these vices. He was very religious in private; but in company he was merry, fond of old stories, and of singing. Patrick Heron, your elder, if alive, will give you a better account of him than I can. He was no fanatic in religious matters, and always respected the established clergy, whose servants he never, like many other people, criticised, at least in my hearing. My brother James, his youngest son by the first marriage, died of a fever in 1781 or 1782. His death, which happened at some distance from home, was reported to my father early on a Sunday morning, and I, then a child, could not conceive why my father wept and prayed all that day.

"Sometime in autumn, 1781, he bought a catechism for me, and began to teach me the alphabet. As it was too good a book for me to handle at all times, it was generally locked up, and he throughout the winter drew the figures of the letters to me in his *written* hand on the board of an old *wool-card* with the black end of an extinguished heather stem or root snatched from the fire. I soon learned all the alphabet in this form, and became *writer* as well as *reader*. I wrought with the *board* and *brand* continually. Then the catechism was presented, and in a month or two I could read the easier parts of it. I daily amused myself with copying, as above, the *printed* letters. In May 1782, he gave me a small psalm-book, for which I totally abandoned the catechism, which I did not like, and which I tore into two pieces, and concealed in a hole of a dike. I soon got many psalms by memory, and longed for a new book. Here difficulties arose. The Bible, *used every night* in the family, I was not permitted to open or touch. The rest of the books were put up in chests. I at length got a New Testament, and read the historical parts with great curiosity and ardour. But I longed to read the Bible, which seemed to me a much more pleasant book, and I actually went to where I knew an old loose-leaved Bible lay, and carried it away in piecemeal. I perfectly remember the strange pleasure I felt in reading the history of Abraham and of David. I liked mournful narratives, and greatly admired Jeremiah, Ezekiel, and the Lamentations. I pored on these pieces of the Bible in secret for many months, for I durst not shew them openly; and as I read constantly and remembered well, I soon astonished all our honest neighbours with the large passages of Scripture I repeated before them. I have forgot too much of my biblical *knowledge*; but I can still rehearse all the names of the patriarchs from Adam to Christ, and various other narratives seldom committed to memory.

"My father's whole property was only two or three scores of sheep, and four muirland cows, his reward for herding the farm of Kitterick for Mr Alexander Laidlaw in clatteranshaws, on the other side of the Dee. He had no debts, and *no money*. We lived in a wild glen, five or six miles from Minigaff and more from New Galloway. All his sons had been bred shepherds; he meant to employ me in that line; and he often blamed me for laziness and uselessness, because I was a bad and negligent *herd-boy*. The fact was, I was always a weakly child, not unhealthy, but not stout. I was short-sighted, a defect he did not know; and which was often the occasion of blunders when I was sent to look for cattle. I was sedentary, indolent, and given to books, and writing on boards with coals. In 1783, my fame for wondrous reading, and *a great memory*, was the discourse of the whole glen. But my father could not pay the expenses of lodging and wages for me at any school. In harvest 1783, William Cochrane, a brother of my mother, returned from England, where he had made a few hundred pounds as a travelling merchant. He came to visit our family, and being informed of my *genius* as they called it, undertook to place me next spring at New Galloway school, and to lodge me in the house of Alexander Cochrane, my grandfather, then alive, and dwelling about a mile from New Galloway. This simple expedient might have occurred to my parents, but I never heard them propose it; the idea of school wages frightened them from employing it. I was brought to New Galloway about the 2*l* th of May, 1784, and for a month made a very awkward figure in the school, then taught by Mr. William Gordon: he read English well, and had many scholars. Mr. Gillespie, who is almost my equal in years, being born 1775 or 1776, was then reading the Rudiments of Latin. My pronunciation of words was laughed at, and my whole speech was a subject of fun. But I soon gained impudence, and before the vacation in August I often stood *dux* of the Bible class. I was in the meantime taught to write copies, and use paper and ink. But I both wrote and printed, that is, imitated printed letters when out of school. My morals did not equally improve. My grandfather was an old man, and could not superintend my proceedings. I learned, therefore, to swear, lie, and to do bad tricks, all which practices I have ever since detested. I was fourteen days, or thereby, at this school after the vacation had terminated. But in the beginning of November, 1784, I was seized with a bad eruption on the skin, and an illness, which obliged me to leave school, which I saw no more for four years.

"In spring 1785, my health grew a little better. I was put to assist as a shepherd boy the rest of the family. I was still attached to reading, printing of words, and getting by heart ballads, of which I procured several. I had seen the ballad of Chevy chase at New Galloway, and was quite enraptured with it. About this time, and for years after, I spent every sixpence that friends or strangers gave me on ballads and penny histories. I carried bundles of these in my pockets, and read them when sent to look for cattle on the banks of *Loch Greanoch*, and on the wild hills in its neighbourhood. These ballads that I liked most were Chevy Chase, Sir James the Rose (by Michael Bruce,) Jamie and Nancy, and all heroic and sorrowful ditties. This course of life continued through 1785, 1786, and 1787. In that time I had read, or rather studied daily, Sir David Lindsay, Sir William Wallace, the Cloud of Witnesses, the Hind let Lose, and all the books of piety in the place. My fame for reading, and *a memory*, was loud, and several said I was 'a living miracle.' I puzzled the honest elders of the Church with recitals of Scripture, and discourses about Jerusalem, &c. &c. In 1787 and 1788 I borrowed from John Kellie, then in Tenotrie, and still residing, I believe, in Minigaff, Salmon's Geographical Grammar, and L'Estrange's version of Josephus. I got *immense* benefit from Salmon's book. It gave me an idea of geography and universal history, and I actually recollect at this day almost every thing it contains. I learned to copy its maps, but I did not understand the *scale*. In 1788, or early in 1789, Basil, Lord Daer, came to attend a committee

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of the gentlemen on the line of road between New Galloway and Newton-Stewart. He had made a map of the whole valley of Palneur from Dee to Cree, which map he lost on the moors near Kitterick. It was found and given to me, and I practised drawing plans of the glen of Palneur, correcting and printing the names of places, according to my own fancy.

"As I could read and write, I was engaged by the *heads* of two families in Kirkowen parish to teach their children. The name of the one was Robert Milligan, and the other a Alexander Milroy, laird of Morfad, an old and singular man who had young grandchildren. I taught these pupils during the winter of 1787-8, but got acquainted with few books. I received copies of the numeration and multiplication tables from one M'William, a boy of my own age, and a brother teacher. I returned home in March, 1788. My fees were fifteen or sixteen shillings. Part of this I laid out on books, one of which was the History of the Twelve Cæsars, translated from Suetonius; another, Cocker's Arithmetic, the plainest of all books, from which in two or three months, I learned the four principal rules of arithmetic, and even advanced to the rule of three, with no additional assistance, except the use of an old copy-book of examples, made by some boy at school, and a few verbal directions from my brother Robert, the only one of all my father's sons, by his first marriage, that remained with us. He was then a cattle-dealer on a small scale. In June, 1788, I made a visit to Minigaff, and got from old John Simpson, a cartwright, and a great reader, the loan of several volumes of Ruddiman's Weekly or Monthly Magazine during 1773, 1774, and 1775, and an old, ill-written, and superstitious history of the Four Monarchies, of the Popes, the Kings of England, &c. My memory now contained a very large mass of historical facts and ballad poetry, which I repeated with pleasure to myself, and the astonished approbation of the peasants around me. On the 26th of May, 1789, my father and his family left Kitterick, and came to herd in a place called Drigmorn, on Palkill Burn, four miles from Minigaff. He was engaged by Mr. Ebenezer Wilson, now residing in Barncauchla. A prospect now opened of my attending Minigaff school. I set out by myself, and arrived in Minigaff village, where my friend, John Simpson, lived, and where Mr. Cramond, schoolmaster of Minigaff, dwelt. I think he lodged in Simpson's house. Mr. Cramond received me, and I travelled every day from Drigmorn to Minigaff. I read some English, but applied chiefly to writing and arithmetic. In the course of the summer I ran over Dilworth's arithmetic. But I was not in stout health; and the distance from school was great, and I generally attended only three days in the week. My teacher allowed this. I made the most of these days; I came about an hour before the school met, I pored on my arithmetic, in which I am still a proficient, and I regularly opened and read all the English books, such as the Spectator, World, &c. brought by the children to school. I seldom joined in any play at the usual hour, but read constantly. It occurred to me that I might get qualified for a merchant's clerk. I, therefore, cast a sharp look towards the method of book-keeping, and got some idea of its forms by reading Hutton in the school, and by glancing at the books of other scholars. When the vacation came on I was obliged to quit school. At Martinmas, 1789, I was engaged by three families in the moors of Kells and Minigaff to teach their children. I bought Mair's book-keeping, having sent to Edinburgh for it by a man who rode as *post* between Wigton and Edinburgh. The families, one of which belonged to my eldest brother, resided at great distances one from another. My brother lived in the Backhill of Garrarie—another family lived in Buchan, on Loch Trool,—a third on the Dee, near Garrarie. I migrated about, remaining six weeks in each family. Among these mountains I found several books,—Walker's Arithmetic,—a History of England,—a volume of Langhorne's Plutarch, having the Lives of Eumenes, Pompey, Scipio, &c.,—and Burns' Poems, all which I read with perpetual and close attention. I was fond of verse of all kinds. In 1787, before leaving Kitterick, I made a *scoffing ballad* on a neighbour shepherd and girl of my acquaintance. This was my original sin as to verse. In 1789, the whole moorlands of Ayrshire and Galloway were engaged in discussing the doctrines of a book written by Dr. Macgill, one of the ministers of Ayr. I entered with much zeal and little knowledge into the feelings of the people, and declaimed against Socinianism and various religious opinions, which I certainly was not of an age to understand.

"A little before Whitsunday, 1790, I returned home to Drigmorn. My father had been engaged to herd in Barncauchla, a farm within two miles of Minigaff village, to which farm we removed on the 26th May, 1790. I had now easy access to school, and went regularly. As I now understood writing, and accounts, in imitation of other lads in the country, I wished to add to these a little French. These were the sum total of qualifications deemed necessary for a clerk intending to go to the West Indies or America.

"I had, in 1787 and 1788, often admired and mused on the specimens of the Lord's Prayer in every language found in Salmon's grammar. I had read in the magazines and Spectator that Homer, Virgil, Milton, Shakspeare, and Newton, were the greatest of mankind. I had been early informed that Hebrew was the first language, by some *elders* and good religious people. In 1789, at Drigmorn, an old woman who lived near, showed me her psalm-book, which was printed with a large type, had notes on each page, and likewise what I discovered to be the Hebrew alphabet, marked letter after letter in the 119th psalm. I took a copy of these letters, by *printing* them off in my old way, and kept them.

"I borrowed from one Jack M'Bride at Bridgend of Cree, Chambaud's Rudiments of French Grammar. About the 30th of May, 1790, I set to work on it. My indulgent master gave me whole pages of lessons, and in less than a fortnight I began to read lessons in the second volume of the Diable Boiteux, a book which he gave me. Robert Kerr, a son of William Kerr in Risque, was my friend and companion. He, in preparation for Grenada, whither he soon went, had for some time read French. His grammar was Boyer's, and the book which he had in, an old French New Testament. There was another grammar in the school, read by Robert Cooper, son of Mr. Cooper, late tenant in Clarie. In the middle of the days I sat in the school and compared the nouns, verbs, &c. in all these books; and as I knew much of the New Testament by memory, I was able to explain whole pages of the French to Kerr, who was not diligent in study. About the 15th of June, Kerr told me that he had once learned Latin for a fortnight, but had not liked it, and still had the 'Rudiments' beside him. I said 'Do lend me them; I wish to see what the nouns and verbs are like, and whether they resemble our French.' He gave me the book, I examined it for four or five days, and found that the nouns had changes on the last syllable, and looked very singular. I used to repeat a lesson from the French Rudiments every forenoon in school. On the morning of the midsummer fair of Newton-Stewart, I set out for school, and accidentally put into my pocket the Latin grammar instead of the thin French rudiments. On an ordinary day Mr. Cramond would have chid me for this, but on that festive morning he was *mellow* and in excellent spirits—a state not good for a teacher, but always desired in him by me, for he was then very communicative. With great glee he replied, when I told him my mistake, and showed the rudiments, 'Gad, Sandy, I shall try thee with Latin,' and accordingly read over to me no less than two of the declensions. It was his custom with me to permit me to get as long lessons as I pleased, and never to fetter me by joining me to a class. There was at that time in the school a class of four boys advanced as far as the pronouns in Latin grammar. They ridiculed my separated condition. But before the vacation in August, I had reached the end of the rudiments, knew a good deal more than they, by reading at home the notes on the foot of each page, and was so greatly improved in French that I could read almost any French book at opening of it. I compared French and Latin, and rivetted the words of both in my memory by this practice. When proceeding with the Latin verbs, I often sat in the school all midday, and pored on the first pages of Robert Cooper's Greek grammar, the only one I had ever seen. He was then reading Livy, and learning Greek. By help of his book I mastered the letters, but I saw the sense of the Latin rules in a very indistinct manner. Some boy lent me an old Corderius, and a friend made me a present of Eutropius. I got a common vocabulary from my companion Kerr. I read to my teacher a number of colloquies; and before the end of July was permitted to take lessons in Eutropius. There was a copy of Eutropius in the school that had a literal translation. I studied this last with great attention, and compared the English and Latin. When my lesson was prepared, I always made an excursion into the rest of every book, and my books were not like those of other school-boys, opened only in one place, and where the lesson lay. The school was dissolved in the harvest. After the vacation, I returned to it a week or two to read Eutropius. A few days before the vacation, I purchased from an old man, named William Shaw, a very bulky and aged edition of Ainsworth's Dictionary. This was an invaluable acquisition to me. It had all the Latin words and the corresponding Greek and Hebrew, likewise a plan of ancient Rome, and a dictionary of proper names. I had it for eighteen-pence, a very low price. With these books I went off, about Martinmas, to teach the children of Robert Kerr, tenant in Garlarg, English reading, writing, arithmetic and *Latin*. In his house I found several more books—Ruddiman's Grammar, the most *obscure* of all works that ever were offered to children for their instruction, a book on which I laboured much to no great purpose,—Cæsar an Ovid. I employed every moment in pondering over these books. I literally read the dictionary throughout. My method was to revolve the leaves of the letter A, to notice all the principal words, and their Greek synonimes, not omitting a glance at the Hebrew; to do the same by B, and so on through the book. I then returned from X and Z to A, and in these winter months I amassed a large stock of Latin and Greek vocables. From this exercise I took to Eutropius, Ovid, and Cæsar, or at times to Ruddiman's Grammar. The inverted order often perplexed me, and I frequently mistook, but also frequently discerned, the sense. The wild fictions of Ovid have had charms for me ever since. I was not a judge of simple and elegant composition, but when any passage contained wild, sublime, pathetic, or singular expressions, I both felt and tenaciously remembered them. Here I got another book, which, from that time, has influenced and inflamed my imagination. This was "Paradise Lost," of which I had heard, and which I was eager to see. It was lent me by Jean Macmillan, at present residing in Minigaff village, then housekeeper in Garlarg, and afterwards married to Robert Murray, my brother's son. I cannot describe to you the ardour or various feelings with which I read, studied, and admired this *first-rate* work. I found it as difficult to understand as Latin, and soon saw that it required to be *parsed* like that language. I had the use of this copy for a year, and replaced it with one of my own. I account my first acquaintance with Paradise Lost an era in my reading."
—*Murray's Literary History of Galloway. Second Edition.*

(To be continued.)

WOURALI POISON.

Waterton, an intrepid traveller in South America, gives the following interesting account of the method pursued by the Indians in making wourali poison, a species of matter of the most powerful action on animal life, but which destroys life so gently, that the victim appears to be in no pain whatever; and probably, says he, were the truth known, it feels none, saving the momentary smart at the time the arrow enters. A day or two before the Macoushi Indian prepares his poison, he goes into the forest in quest of the ingredients. A vine grows in these wilds which is called wourali, and it is from this that the poison takes its name, and it is the principal ingredient. When he has procured enough of this, he digs up a root of a very bitter taste, ties them together, and then looks about for two kinds of bulbous plants, which contain a green and glutinous juice. He fills a little vessel, which he carries on his back, with the stalks of these, and lastly, ranges up and down till he finds two species of ants: one of them is very large and black, and so venomous that its sting produces a fever. It is most commonly to be met with on the ground. The other is a little red ant, which stings like a nettle, and generally has its nest under the leaf of a shrub. After obtaining these, he has no more need to range the forest. A quantity of the strongest Indian pepper is used; but this he has already planted round his hut. The pounded fangs of the Labarri snake, and those of the Counacouchi, are likewise added. These he commonly has in store; for, when he kills a snake, he generally extracts the fangs and keeps them by him. Having thus found the necessary ingredients, he scrapes the wourali vine and bitter root into thin shavings, and puts them into a kind of colander made of leaves; this he holds over an earthen pot, and pours water on the shavings; the liquor which comes through has the appearance of coffee. When a sufficient quantity has been procured, the shavings are thrown aside. He then bruises the bulbous stalks, and squeezes a proportionate quantity of their juice through his hands into the pot. Lastly, the snake's fangs, ants, and pepper, are bruised and thrown into it. It is then placed on a slow fire, and as it boils, more of the juice of the wourali is added, according as it may be found necessary, and the scum is taken off with a leaf. It remains on the fire till reduced to a thick scum of a deep brown colour. As soon as it has arrived at this state, a few arrows are poisoned with it to try its strength. If it answer the expectations, it is poured out into a calabash, or little pot of Indian manufacture, which is carefully covered with a couple of leaves, and over them a piece of deer's skin, tied round with a cord. They keep it in the most dry part of the hut, and from time to time suspend it over the fire to counteract the effects of dampness. Among the instances adduced of the extraordinary effects of the wourali poison, Waterton mentions the following:—A large well-fed ox, from nine hundred to a thousand pounds weight, was led to a stake by a rope sufficiently strong to allow him to move to and fro. In order to bring him down, three poisoned arrows were put into him; one was sent into each thigh, just above the hock, in order to avoid wounding a vital part, and a third was shot traversely into the extremity of the nostril. The poison seemed to take effect in four minutes. Conscious as though he would fall, the ox set himself firmly on his legs, and remained quite still in the same place, till about the fourteenth minute, when he smelled the ground, and appeared as if inclined to walk. He advanced a pace or two, staggered and fell, and remained extended on his side, with his head on the ground. His eye, a few minutes ago so bright and lively, now became fixed and dim; and though you put your hand close to it as if to give him a blow there, he never closed his eyelid. His legs were convulsed, and his head from time to time started involuntarily; but he never showed the least desire to raise it from the ground. He breathed hard, and emitted foam from his mouth. The startings, or subsaltus tendinum, now became gradually weaker and weaker; his hinder parts were fixed in death; and in a minute or two more his head and fore-leg ceased to stir. Nothing now remained to show that life was still within him, except that his heart faintly beat and fluttered at intervals. In five-and-twenty minutes from the time of his being wounded he was quite dead. His flesh was very sweet and savoury at dinner.

Number of Stars.—Of the stars in the British catalogue, there are many only visible through a telescope, *nor does the eye ever see more than a thousand at the same time in the clearest heaven*; yet the number is probably infinite. From the *first* to the *sixth* magnitude, inclusive, the total number of stars is 3,128.

Vatican.—Perhaps nothing can exceed the noble grandeur of the galleries and courts of the Vatican. Unlike the sombre aspect generally characterizing libraries, museums, and similar resorts of the studious and the antiquary, it is as a world of exquisite beauty, vast, splendid, filled with the most admired works of art, and the most precious marbles. The lengthened vista, the varied perspective changing at each advancing step, the noble architectural proportions still preserved in every new form or dimension of apartment, the lofty iron gates, the beautiful fountains adorning the courts, and cooling the air with the play of their fresh running waters, the white balustrades, the pillars and magnificent columns, composed of giall' antique, and every richest marble, almost produce the idea of enchantment; and the eye wanders around in eager curiosity, with amazement and delight. Light is beautiful; and here it is seen, bright and sparkling, reflected from pure and precious marbles; while from the wide spreading windows the most delightful views of Rome, rich with her cupolas, spires, and obelisks, in every varied form of architecture, with her sea-green Campagna, bounded by the dark grey mountains fading in the distance, are presented to the eye. It is the noblest national possession in the world, and should ever be sacred. The mind of man is, I trust, now so well informed, that no barbarous conqueror will ever again dare to touch it with a profane hand.—*Bell's Italy.*

TWO USEFUL RECEIPTS.

Fumigating Mixture.—Two ounces of *salt* dried, two ditto of *nitre*. Mix and put to them in a stoneware basin or plate, a half-ounce of water, and the same quantity of good *sulphuric acid*. Remove all polished-metal articles from the room, as the vapour would rust them, and close all doors and windows. To procure more advantage, when the process appears to cease, place the basin on hot sand.

Cheap Stew-soup.—Two pounds of beef, four onions, ten turnips, half a pound of rice, a large handful of parsley, thyme, and savoury; some pepper and salt; eight quarts of water. Cut the beef in slices, and after it has boiled some time, cut it still smaller. The whole should boil gently about two hours on a slow fire. If fuel be scarce, it may be stewed all night in an oven, and warmed up next day. You may add oatmeal and potatoes. Grey pease will be a great addition.—*Mrs. Hannah More.*

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Column for the Boys

ARCHERY.—*Concluded.*

The String.—The part of the string which receives the nock of the arrow is whipped with sewing silk to prevent the string being rubbed and weakened. If the silk should come off the string, it ought to be re-whipped without delay, otherwise it will be in danger of breaking; and this is not the only mischief, for from the breaking of a string oftentimes ensues the snapping of a bow. It is also advisable to whip the noose and eye of the string, although many Archers do not trouble themselves to do so. At one end of the bow-string an eye is made; it is left for the Archer himself, bows being of different lengths, to make the other; this to a young Archer will be found rather difficult; his best plan will be to inspect the mode of making the noose on an old string. The young Archer will do well, if any of the threads of his string break to throw it by and use another. He should never, if possible, permit the string to become twisted or ravelled; should such an occurrence take place, before it is put on again, it ought to be retwisted and waxed. A bow, five feet long when braced, should never have the string more than five inches from its centre. This rule will be a guide to the young Archer in stringing his bow; whatever be its length, he will, of course, adjust the distance in the same proportion, according to the admeasurement.

The Quiver.—The quiver is for the reception of the arrows, but is never constantly worn, except in roving; it is now usually made of tin, although it is occasionally constructed, as was indeed universally the case formerly, of wood or leather.

The Belt, Pouch, and Grease-box.—The belt is buckled round the waist; the grease box is suspended from the middle, and the pouch, or bucket, on the right side of it. A composition for greasing the finger of the shooting-glove, and the smooth side of the brace, when occasion may require, is kept in the box; the pouch holds the arrows for immediate use in target-shooting.

The Ascham.—This is a large case, fitted up with the necessary drawers and compartments for the reception of the bow, stock of arrows, strings, and all the necessary accoutrements of the Archer.

Butts.—The butt, generally speaking, is rather pyramidical in shape, but it may be fashioned according to the fancy of the Archer; for grown up persons, they are seven or eight feet wide, three or four feet thick at the top, and nearly seven feet in height at the middle. Butts are made of long plats of turf which are to be closely pressed down; a round piece of pasteboard is placed in the centre of the butt for a mark, which must be increased or decreased in size according to the distance at which the Archer shoots; for thirty yards, it should be four inches in diameter; for sixty yards, six inches; and so in proportion for a greater distance. The mark is fixed to the butt by a peg driven through its centre. Shots that take place outside the mark are not reckoned, and he who places most shots in the pasteboard during the play, is accounted the winner. Butts are frequently placed at different distances from each other; a set of butts is four, which are so contrived as not to prevent the players seeing them all at once. What is called a single end is shooting at one mark only; a double end is shooting to a mark, and back again from that mark to the one first shot from.

Targets.—Targets should be proportioned to the size and skill of the juvenile archer, and to the distance at which he stands from them. The facing is usually made of canvass, which is sown to the bass; the bass is made of straw, worked as a bee-hive. The facing has a gold centre and four circles; namely, the outer white edge with green and black, inner, white and red. Where it is not convenient to keep the targets fixed, it is better to use another kind, made of milled board, these being more portable, although by no means so durable, as targets made of the other materials we have mentioned. If one target only be shot at, a great deal of time is wasted in going to fetch the arrows, and again returning to the spot for shooting from; two targets are, therefore, generally used, and the archers shoot from one to the other. In archery matches, there are generally two prizes,—one for the greatest number of arrows shot in the target, the other for the shot nearest the gold centre. Hits in the target are sometimes reckoned all alike; but there is usually a distinction made. The gold centre is the mark, and the circle which approaches nearest to it, being less in size, and consequently more difficult to hit, and nearer the main mark itself, an arrow shot in that circle is deemed of more value, in reckoning for the prize, than if it were to take place in any of those outside of it, and so on in proportion with the others. A celebrated society of archery allows the following numbers for each circle. For the gold, nine; for the red, seven; for the inner white, five; for the black, three; and for the outer white, one. A writer on this subject, however, seems to think, that the outer circles are overrated, and if nine be allowed for the centre, only three should be scored for the red; two, for the inner white; and less, in proportion, for the two outer circles. When the sport terminates, the value of the number of hits, and not the hits themselves, should be reckoned; and he whose score is the largest, is, of course, the victor.

As ink is by no means a convenient thing to carry into the field, and marks made with the black lead pencil are liable to be rubbed out it is advisable to have a pin suspended from a card, properly divided for each archer's score, and to prick down the hits with it.

Stringing the Bow.—The bow is to be taken in the right hand, by the handle, with the flat part toward the person who is about to string it; his right arm should rest against his side; one lower end of the bow, which has always the shortest bone, should be placed against the inside of the right foot, which should be turned a little inward to prevent the bow from slipping; the left foot should at the same time be brought forward; the centre of the left hand wrist must be placed on the upper limb of the bow below the eye of the string, the forefinger knuckle upon one edge of the bow, and the top of the thumb on the other. The bow is now to be pulled vigorously, and the upper limb of it pressed down by the right hand, and the wrist of the left, which should at the same time slide upward until the eye of the bowstring is safely placed in the nock. The middle, the ring, and the little fingers, should all three be stretched out, as they are not wanted in this operation of stringing the bow; moreover, if this be not done, they are liable to be caught between the string and the bow, and thus become severely punished. The young Archer should take care that the eye is well placed in the nock before he removes his left hand. He should not become impatient in the action of stringing the bow, but perform it systematically as directed; if he do not succeed, let him lay it by for a few minutes, and when he is cool, make a second attempt. To unstring the bow, the short horn is to be placed on the ground, the palm of the left hand receiving the flat side of the upper limb; the string should be upward: the handle is then to be pressed with the right arm so as to slacken the string; when the latter becomes loose enough, the eye is to be brought out of the nock, by the thumb of the left hand.

Position.—The face is to be turned toward the mark, but no part of the body, which, if the mark be north, should be turned toward the east; the head should be rather inclined; the left hand, with the bow in it in a perpendicular position, is to be held out straight toward the mark; the arrow is to be brought well toward the ear and not the eye, on the left side of the bow and under the string; the forefinger of the left hand passes over it; by the other hand the nock is placed in the string at the proper place, with the cock feather uppermost; when this is done, the forefinger of the left hand is removed and placed round the bow. While the left hand is raising the bow, the right should be drawing the string with two or three fingers only and not the thumb; as soon as it reaches the head it should be let loose for fear of its breaking.

Great care should be taken to acquire a proper position, for bad attitudes in Archery appear extremely ridiculous.

Clout Shooting.—Clout shooting is mostly practised by those who cannot conveniently set up butts or targets near home. The clout, which is quite portable, is made of a round piece of pasteboard, thirty-six inches in circumference, fastened to a stick; or it may be made of white cloth, so contrived as to roll up on a stick that is run through it. In clout shooting, seven is the game, and all arrows tell that fall within three bows' length of the clout.

Roving.—This is a very pleasant pastime with the long bow; and is, indeed, by some, preferred even to target-shooting. The parties are not restricted to any particular place, but rove about from field to field for miles around, as they think fit. The mark is any clear and conspicuous object, such as a tree or a bush. The number of the game is, in general, as in flight and clout shooting, seven; but it may be increased or decreased according to the inclination of the parties. If there be more than six persons in a roving party, they should divide themselves into companies; and when the first company have shot to, and walked some distance from, the first mark, the second should shoot at it; and so on with those that follow. Arrows that reach within five bows' length of the mark tell; but those which reach nearest to it the others out. In measuring the distance, the archer does so with his own bow, from a point or spot in the mark. The archer may measure to what part of his arrow he pleases. He who shoots nearest has the privilege of indicating the next mark. It is better to use blunt-headed arrows, in roving, than sharp ones; as it not unfrequently happens that the latter are driven so firmly into the mark as to make it a matter of difficulty to extract them; should this occur, it is advisable to cut away the wood around the arrow, rather than endeavour to tug it out by violence. Every rover should carry at least a dozen arrows with him, in order to be prepared against accidents.

Flight-Shooting.—Flight-shooting was, at one time, much more frequently practised with the long bow than it is at present. The object in flight-shooting is simply to ascertain which of a party can shoot to the greatest distance; this must, of course, be very detrimental to bows, which are more frequently snapped in flight-shooting than at any other pastime with the long bow. No skill in aiming is requisite in flight-shooting; it is, therefore, by no means, improving to the young archer who wishes to excel as a marksman. The longest and lightest arrows that the bow will bear are used in flight-shooting; the game is generally seven.

Concluding Remarks.—We strongly recommend the young archer never to shoot with another person's bow; he may, very probably, break it; and in that case, a loss might ensue to the owner, which money could not remedy. When the grass is above the ancle, shoot only at a considerable elevation. After two or three arrows are shot, the archer should cease awhile, otherwise his aim will get unsteady. If he shoot point-blank at a mark, the arrow, if it miss, will strike along, and so bury itself in the grass as to defy the keenest eye, in many instances, for a very considerable time to discover it. This inconvenience may be remedied by shooting at a proper elevation, for then the arrow will descend in such a manner as to leave the feathers visible; they will also be saved from that injury which frequently occurs to them, by the moisture of the grass, or ground, when shot point-blank. Arrows should not be used of different lengths, nor should the young archer shoot alone; for in solitary shooting, he falls into habits of negligence and indifference; if he practice with others, he will strive to emulate his companions; and, instead of a careless, unskilful marksman, soon become an adept in other pleasant pastimes.

HYMN OF THE BRITISH PEASANT.

For the pride of our fields, for our garden-decked land,
For our valleys and rivers, the works of thy hand,
We praise thee, we bless thee, our Father, our God,
We praise thee, we bless thee, our Father, our God!

For the fragrance of morn, for the lark's early song,
That bids us from slumber awake and be strong:
For the dews, for the clouds, for the day's varied sight,
We praise thee we bless thee, the Fountain of Light.

For the sweets of our toil, for the oak's covert shade,
'Neath whose breathings at noontide our banquet is laid;
For the strength of our limbs, for our cheek's joyous glow,
We praise thee, who crownest the sweat of our brow.

For evening's calm hour, when our labour is done,
For the fond little crowds, from each cottage that run,
For their greetings of love, when around us they come,
We praise thee, we bless thee, who giv'st us our home.

For our Sabbaths and Churches, thy Spirit's abode,
Where the old and the young swell the chorus to God;
For each holy transport that kindles us there,
We praise thee, we bless thee, the quickener of prayer.

For the promise of Spring, for thy Summer's proud state,
For the glories of harvest, for Autumn's rich weight;
For the wood-fires of winter, so gladdening and clear,
We praise thee, we bless thee, who rulest the year.

For the kind British hearts, ever joying to give,
For the friends of the poor, amid whom we live,
We praise thee, we bless thee, our Father, our God,
We praise thee, we bless thee, our Father, our God!

TURKEY.—After some hours' stay we proceeded up the Dardanelles, Europe on one side and Asia on the other; and soon Turkey opened on us with its loveliest scenery. I do not know if I can convey a proper idea of it,—it is so different from that of Europe. What gives a peculiar beauty to the Turkish towns and villages, is their being so embosomed in trees. You always see these of the liveliest verdure, hanging over and shading the greatest part of the houses. The habitations are rather low, and built generally of wood, with gently sloping roofs; they are either of a red, white, or lead colour, with windows of framework of wood. The neat white minaret of the mosque rises eminent amidst every village. The country was rich in many parts with corn, which had been already cut; and a cool kiosque was seen, shaded with its luxuriance of wood. But all this only whetted my impatience to behold Stamboul, as the Turks call it; and night came down again to augment it. For the last few days the sky had become more beautiful, of a most delicate blue, bounded near the horizon by a ridge of white clouds: and the last day of our voyage was particularly fine, when a gentle breeze brought us towards the capital of the East. The first view rather disappoints you; the surrounding shores are not striking, and you are inclined to ask, where is the magnificence of Constantinople? But when you enter the canal, and turn the point where stands the seraglio, and the site of the city, being built on declivities, rises higher, so that houses appear to range on houses—and Pera and Galata, with the immense dark grove of cypress on the place of graves that crowns the hill, open to your view—you are struck with admiration. The houses of wood, of which the city is chiefly built, have indeed nothing grand in their appearance; three-fourths of the fronts are taken up with windows. But it is the novel and beautiful blending of trees and verdure with every part; the innumerable minarets, some with gilded tops that glitter in the sun; and the superior mosques, of a nobler appearance, and towering above all other buildings,—which impress the mind of a stranger with feelings unknown at the sight of any other European city. Our vessel being bound for Odessa, proceeded up the river to the village of Buyukdere, a few miles distant, celebrated for its beauty. This afforded an excellent opportunity to view the scenery; and few who have once done this can ever forget it. Each side of the river—a noble stream, of a mile, or sometimes half that in width—was thickly covered with habitations. In one part was a mosque of the purest white marble, most richly ornamented and gilded, and the dark cypress around it. On the left, a summer seraglio of the Sultan, with its small pleasure-ground, stretched along the shore. The hills on the European side, descending nearly close to the river, and prettily wooded, yet so small that they looked in miniature; and the little Turkish houses standing in the river, or hanging in parapets over it, or thrown back in a retiring wood,—put you in mind of what you had imagined of Chinese scenery and dwellings. My view often wandered with delight over the Asiatic side, as the scene of future pleasures. "At last," I said to myself, "my long-cherished hopes are accomplished; it is all oriental I see: but my expectations are surpassed."—*Carne's Letters from the East.*

USE OF CAT'S WHISKERS.—Every one has observed the whiskers of a cat; but few, perhaps, dream that they serve any valuable end. The following passage will prove the contrary:—Every one must have observed what are usually called the whiskers on a cat's upper lip. The use of these in a state of nature is very important. They are organs of touch. They are attached to a bed of close glands under the skin; and each of these long and stiff hairs is connected with the nerves of the lip. The slightest contact of these whiskers with any surrounding object, is thus felt most distinctly by the animal, although the hairs are themselves insensible. They stand out on each side in the lion, as well as in the common cat; so that, from point to point, they are equal to the width of the animal's body. If we imagine therefore, a lion stealing through a covert of wood, in an imperfect light, we shall at once see the use of these long hairs. They indicate to him, through the nicest feeling, any obstacle which may present itself to the passage of his body: they prevent the rustle of boughs and leaves, which would give warning to his prey, if he were to attempt to pass through too close a bush; and thus, in conjunction with the soft cushions of his feet, and the fur upon which he treads (the retractile claws never coming in contact with the ground,) they enable him to move towards his victim with a stillness greater even than that of the snake, who creeps along the grass, and is not perceived till he is coiled round his prey.—*Library of Useful Knowledge.*

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BEAR HUNTING.

After resting for about half an hour, says Lloyd, we again resumed the search for the bears, which we continued until near three o'clock, and until it was beginning to get dusk. At this time I was to the right of the line, which was proceeding in a westerly direction; when, in the distance to the northward, and in a part of the forest we had not yet beaten, I heard my old dog Paijas giving tongue; this he did in such a manner that I had more than a suspicion he had found what we had so long been in search of. I now lost not a moment, but leaving the people, ran as fast as the broken nature of the ground would permit, towards the spot where the dog was challenging, which might be at one hundred and fifty or two hundred paces distance. This was in a rather thick part of the forest; and in a clump of pines, around the foot of which, though at some paces distant—for he probably remembered the rough treatment he had received upon a former occasion—Paijas still kept furiously baying. Though the dog had found the bears, I did not at the first moment observe the entrance to their den, which was an excavation in the face of a little rising, situated between, and partly formed by the roots of the surrounding trees. But on discovering it, I at once sprang on to the top of the hillock; and though at that time immediately over the den, the bears still remained quiet. On my hallooing, they felt so little inclination to leave their quarters, that the old bear simply contented herself with partially projecting her snout. At this, from its being the only point exposed to my view, I levelled my rifle, which was then pointed in a perpendicular direction. On reflection, however, I refrained from firing, as I considered that, though I might have smashed the fore part of her head to pieces, there was little chance of my killing her outright. Instead, therefore, of firing whilst in that situation, I stepped (and it certainly was not "the most prudent step" a man ever took,) with my left foot in advance, directly over her, to the opposite side of the hole, when wheeling about on the instant, and having then a full view of her head, from which the muzzle of my gun was hardly two feet distant, and my left foot still less, for it was partially in the entrance of the den itself, I sent a bullet through her skull. I now called loudly to the people, none of whom, nor even the other dogs, which had been questing to some birds in another part of the forest, had as yet come up—for I was rather apprehensive the cubs might attempt to make their escape. To prevent this, I stood for a while over the den in readiness to give them a warm reception with the butt end of my rifle. But three or four minutes elapsed before Jan Finne, who was to the left of our line, Svensson, and the peasants, made their appearance; for, strange to say, though Paijas had been in Jann Finne's possession for several years, he either did not recognise his challenge, or he had not a suspicion it was to the bears; and in consequence neither he nor the people moved from where I had left them until they heard my shot. My apprehensions as to the cubs attempting to escape, were, however, groundless, for they still continued quiet; at first, indeed, we could see nothing of them, for the old bear, who, as is usual with those animals when they have young, was lying in the front of the den, and we, therefore, almost began to think we had hit upon a bear distinct from those of which we were in search. But on the people introducing a stake, and moving the old bear a little to the side, one of the cubs, and subsequently a second, and a third, exhibited themselves, all of which I despatched, either with my own or with Jan Finne's rifle. The work of death being at length completed, we drew the bears out of their den. This however was of such small dimensions, that it was the admiration of us all how they could have stowed themselves away in it. Bears usually prepare their winter-quarters during the autumnal months, and sometime previously to taking possession of them; but the animals of which I am now speaking, having been disturbed from their original lair at a time when the ground was hard frozen, and when it was, of course, much more difficult to imbed themselves in the earth, probably accounted for the small size of the excavation in which we found them. The old bear had attained her full growth; the cubs were nearly a year old, and of about the size of large dogs. The whole of them were in tolerably good condition.—*Lloyd's Field Sports of the North of Europe.*

Cheese Hoppers.—Those who have, from popular associations been accustomed to look with disgust at the little white larvæ common in cheese, well known under the name of hoppers, will be somewhat surprised to hear the illustrious Swammerdam say, "I can take upon me to affirm, that the limbs and other parts of this maggot are so uncommon and elegant, and contrived with so much art and design that it is impossible not to acknowledge them to be the work of infinite power and wisdom, from which nothing is hid, and to which nothing is impossible." The cheese fly (*Piophila Casei*, Fallen) is very small and black, with whitish wings warped with black. It was one of those experimented upon by Redi, to prove that insects, in the fabric of which so much art, order, and contrivance, and wisdom appear, could not be the production of chance, or rottenness, but the work of the same omnipotent hand which created the heavens and the earth. This tiny little fly is accordingly furnished with an admirable instrument for depositing its eggs, in an ovipositor, which it can thrust out and extend to a great length, so that it can penetrate to a considerable depth into the cracks of the cheese, where it lays its eggs, 256 in number. "I have seen them myself," says Swammerdam, "thrust out their tails for this purpose to an amazing length, and by that method bury the eggs in the deepest cavities. I found in a few days afterwards a number of maggots which had sprung from those eggs, perfectly resembling those of the first brood that had produced the mother-fly. I cannot but also take notice that the rottenness of cheese is really caused by these maggots; for they both crumble the substance of it into small particles and also moisten it with some sort of liquid, so that the decayed part readily spreads. I once observed a cheese, which I had purposely exposed to this kind of fly, grow moist in a short time in those parts of it where eggs had been deposited, and had afterwards been hatched into maggots: though, before, the cheese was perfectly sound and entire." The cheese-hopper is furnished with two horny claw-shaped mandibles, which it uses both for digging into the cheese and for moving itself, being destitute of feet. Its powers of leaping have been observed by every one; and Swammerdam says, "I have seen one, whose length did not exceed the fourth of an inch, leap out of a box six inches deep, that is, twenty-four times the length of its own body: others leap a great deal higher." For this purpose it first erects itself on its tail, which is furnished with two wart-like projections, to enable it to maintain its balance. It then bends itself into a circle, catches the skin near its tail with its hooked mandibles, and after strangely contracting itself from a circular into an oblong form, it throws itself with a jerk into a straight line, and thus makes the leap. One very surprising provision is remarkable in the breathing tubes of the cheese-maggot, which are not placed, as in caterpillars, along the side, but a pair near the head and another pair near the tail. Now, when burrowing in the moist cheese, these would be apt to be obstructed; but to prevent this it has the power of bringing over the front pair a fold of the skin, breathing in the meanwhile through the upper pair. Well may Swammerdam denominate these contrivances "surprising miracles of God's power and wisdom in this abject creature." Like other destructive insects, the multiplication of the cheese hopper is checked by some insect, whose history is not yet known.—*Library of Entertaining Knowledge.*

Vegetables.—In the early part of the reign of Henry VIII. not a cabbage, turnip, or other edible root, grew in England. Two or three centuries before, certainly, the monasteries had gardens with a variety of vegetables; but nearly all the gardens of the laity were destroyed in the wars between the houses of York and Lancaster. Harrison speaks of wheaten bread as being chiefly used by the gentry for their own tables; and adds, that the artificer and labourer are "driven to content themselves with horse-corne, beanes, peason, oats, tares, and lentils." There is no doubt that the average duration of human life was at that period not one half as long as at the present day. The constant use of salted meat, with little or no vegetable addition, doubtless contributed to the shortening of life, to say nothing of the large numbers constantly swept away by pestilence and famine. Till lemon juice was used as a remedy for scurvy amongst our seamen, who also are compelled to eat salted meat without green vegetables, the destruction of life in the navy was something incredible. Admiral Hosier buried his ship's companies twice during a West India voyage, in 1726, partly from the unhealthiness of the Spanish coast, but chiefly from the ravages of scurvy. Bad food and want of cleanliness swept away the people of the middle ages, by ravages upon their health that the limited medical skill of those days could never resist. Matthew Paris, a historian of that period, states that there were in his time twenty or thirty hospitals for lepers in Europe.—*Working Man's Companion, No. XIII.*

Effect of Light on Plants.—Vegetable physiology is indebted to Senebier, Saussur, De Candolle, and others, for numerous researches on this interesting subject. M. Glocker, in 1820, published at Breslaw a work, in which he has brought together all the facts known, and even the most plausible hypotheses. L. Leuchs has also lately added some interesting experiments on the same subject. It is known that the solar light, by favouring the assimilation of carbonic acid gas in plants, gives them the faculty of becoming green, and of forming the volatile and aromatic principles. These conditions are necessary to their flowering and fructification, insomuch that ripe seeds have never been obtained from plants kept in darkness. If, on the contrary, bleached plants are exposed to the sun for three, four, or five hours, they become as intensely green as if they had been reared in the sun. Vegetables reared in the open air become pale, and fade in two or three hours, if they are transported to a dark place; but those which, after growing in the shade, have been exposed for some time to the sun, can no longer support the privation of light; and water, impregnated with camphor or essential oil, which is highly favourable to vegetation in other circumstances, does not prevent them from fading and perishing. The entire privation of light is therefore very hurtful to plants. M. Leuchs concludes from this, that, without the light of the moon and stars, vegetables would be destroyed by the influence of the night. The light of a lamp is capable of replacing that of the sun, though in a very imperfect manner. The plant becomes green, and directs itself towards the lamp, as M. Leuchs has shown by a beautiful experiment. He has made comparative observations on the germination of seeds deposited in an open vessel, in another covered with a single leaf of paper, and in a third covered with two leaves. Those of the first vessel presented the least external development; but on being dried, they afforded the greatest quantity of solid parts. Those of the second vessel were much more developed, but their tissue was looser and more watery. This difference was still more decided in the plants of the third vessel. The length and wateriness of these plants, therefore increased in the ratio of the diminished action of light. The tissue of various plants seems to become more or less watery according to the nature of the plants themselves, when they are deprived of light. Proceeding from this fact, M. Leuchs is desirous that the influence of different quantities of light on vegetation be determined. He himself has observed, in a moist cellar lighted by a torch, that the plants placed nearest the flame also contain most solid parts on being dried. The results of the observations which he details are pretty uniform, and afford reason to hope that the law by which the action of different quantities of light on the vegetable is regulated may yet be determined. Lastly, according to experiments detailed in this memoir, the light reflected by mirrors has a very beneficial influence on plants. M. Leuchs explains by this how certain places are fertilized by the reverberation of the light on rocks in their neighbourhood.

Astronomy and Celestial Mechanics.—Astronomy, as a science of observation, is known to have made considerable progress among the ancients; indeed, it was the only branch of physical science which could be regarded as having been cultivated by them with any degree of assiduity or real success. The Chaldean and Egyptian records had furnished materials from which the motions of the sun and moon could be calculated with sufficient exactness for the prediction of eclipses; and some remarkable cycles, or periods of years in which the lunar eclipses return in very nearly the same order, had been ascertained by observation. Considering the extreme imperfection of their means of measuring time and space, this was, perhaps, as much as could have been expected at that early period, and it was followed up for a while in a philosophical spirit of just speculation, which, if continued, could hardly have failed to lead to sound and important conclusions. Unfortunately, however, the philosophy of Aristotle laid it down as a principle, that the celestial motions were regulated by laws proper to themselves, and bearing no affinity to those which prevail on earth. By thus drawing a broad and impassable line of separation between celestial and terrestrial mechanics, it placed the former altogether out of the pale of experimental research, while it at the same time impeded the progress of the latter by the assumption of principles respecting natural and unnatural motions, hastily adopted from the most superficial and cursory remark, undeserving even the name of observation. Astronomy, therefore, continued for ages a science of mere record, in which theory had no part, except in so far as it attempted to conciliate the inequalities of the celestial motions with that assumed law of uniform circular revolution, which was alone considered consistent with the perfection of the heavenly mechanism. Hence arose an unwieldy, if not self-contradictory, mass of hypothetical motions of sun, moon, and planets, in circles, whose centres were carried round in other circles, and these again in others without end,—"cycle on epicycle, orb on orb,"—till at length, as observation grew more exact, and fresh epicycles were continually added, the absurdity of so cumbrous a mechanism became too palpable to be borne. Doubts were expressed, to which the sarcasm of a monarch gave a currency they might not have obtained in a period when men scarcely dared trust themselves to think; and at length Copernicus, promulgating his own, or reviving the Pythagorean doctrine, which places the sun in the centre of our system, gave to astronomy a simplicity which, contrasted with the complication of the preceding views, at once commanded assent.—Herschel.

Wolves.—The following circumstance, showing the savage nature of the wolf, and interesting in more than one point of view, was related to me by a gentleman of rank attached to the embassy at St. Petersburg: it occurred in Russia some few years ago. A woman, accompanied by three of her children, were one day in a sledge, when they were pursued by a number of wolves. On this, she put the horse into a gallop, and drove towards her home, from which she was not far distant, with all possible speed. All, however, would not avail, or the ferocious animals gained upon her, and at last were on the point of rushing on the sledge. For the preservation of her own life and that of the remaining children, the poor frantic creature now took one of her babes and cast it a prey to her blood-thirsty pursuers. This stopped their career for a moment; but, after devouring the little innocent, they renewed the pursuit, and a second time came up with the vehicle. The mother, driven to desperation, resorted to the same horrible expedient, and threw her ferocious assailants another of her offspring. To cut short this melancholy story, her third child was sacrificed in a similar manner. Soon after this, the wretched being, whose feelings may more easily be conceived than described, reached her home in safety. Here she related what had happened, and endeavoured to palliate her own conduct, by describing the dreadful alternative to which she had been reduced. A peasant, however, who was among the bystanders, and heard the recital, took up an axe, and with one blow cleft her skull in two; saying, at the same time, that a mother who could thus sacrifice her children for the preservation of her own life, was no longer fit to live. This man was committed to prison, but the Emperor subsequently gave him a pardon.—*Lloyd's Field Sports of the North of Europe.*

Amsterdam.—This city has been formed since the third century. It derives its name from the river Amstit, on whose banks it is situated, and the enormous dam that opposes the inroads of the sea, on a country snatched from its lawful dominion. The whole town, which is nine miles in circumference, stands on piles driven into the mud. Under the townhouse alone are thirteen thousand, six hundred and ninety-five. Well might Erasmus say that he had reached a city whose inhabitants lived like crows on the tops of trees. Ninety small islands, united by two hundred and ninety bridges, form the site of the town, which contains a population of about two hundred and five thousand souls, of which one-tenth are Jews. Owing to the number of canals, and the quantity of stagnant water in the vicinity, the air would be still more prejudicially affected than it is, were it not for mills which are kept constantly at work to communicate an artificial motion to the water. Several of these are employed likewise to draw up the mud brought down by the Y to its junction with the Amstit, which, but for this precaution, would block up the passage of the river.—*Elliot's North of Europe.*

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